

GOD is never in a hurry but spends years with those He expects to greatly use. He never thinks the days of preparation too long or too dull.

... Mrs. Charles E. Cowman

*No. 1 Bestselling Christian Book:
Deeply Incisive, Highly Inspirational,
Extremely Motivational and Holy Spirit Filled*

WHAT IS LIFE?

*"Jesus Christ saith unto him, I am the Way,
the Truth and the Life"*

- John 14:6 -

*"For with Thee is the fountain of Life;
in thy Light we shall see Light."*

- Psalm 36:9 -

ECKOBIG CHIDIEBERE ANTHONY

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To everyone, God bless and keep all of you here on earth and hereafter in eternity.

Yours in Christ Jesus.

ECKOBIG ANTHONY

DEDICATION

This Book is heartily dedicated to the ALMIGHTY GOD,
The Resurrection and Life, The Way, The Truth and Life,
The Fountain of Life, The same yesterday, Today and
Forever. He Who Was, Who Is and Is To Come.

The Beginning and The End,
The Alpha and Omega,
The King of Kings,
The Lord of Lords,
The Sovereign God Almighty Who Rules In Heaven, On Earth,
And Underneath The Earth.

JESUS CHRIST - GOD OF THE UNIVERSE.

CONTENTS

24 Highlights to consider as we explore the Question “WHAT IS LIFE?”

1 - LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE	-	DARE IT!	1
2 - LIFE IS BEAUTY	-	ADMIRE IT!	11
3 - LIFE IS A CHALLENGE	-	MEET IT!	21
4 - LIFE IS A DRIVEWAY	-	BE CAREFUL!	31
5 - LIFE IS A DREAM	-	REALIZE IT!	37
6 - LIFE IS A DUTY	-	PERFORM IT!	47
7 - LIFE IS A FAITH	-	EXPRESS IT!	57
8 - LIFE IS A GIFT	-	ACCEPT IT!	71
9 - LIFE IS A GAME	-	PLAY IT!	89
10 - LIFE IS A GOAL	-	ACHIEVE IT!	95
11 - LIFE IS A JOURNEY	-	COMPLETE IT!	103
12 - LIFE IS A LESSON	-	LEARN IT!	113
13 - LIFE IS LOVE	-	SHOW IT!	125
14 - LIFE IS A MYSTERY	-	UNFOLD IT!	137
15 - LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY	-	TAKE IT!	149
16 - LIFE IS A PROMISE	-	FULFILL IT!	159
17 - LIFE IS A PUZZLE	-	SOLVE IT!	167
18 - LIFE IS A RACE	-	DON'T GIVE UP!	177
19 - LIFE IS A SONG	-	SING IT!	185
20 - LIFE IS A STRUGGLE	-	OVERCOME IT!	191
21 - LIFE IS A STORY	-	TELL IT!	201
22 - LIFE IS A TRAGEDY	-	FACE IT!	209
23 - LIFE IS A QUESTION	-	ANSWER IT!	221
24 - LIFE IS A WAR	-	FIGHT IT!	227

INTRODUCTION

WHAT IS LIFE?

Life is not merely physical existence. Spiritually, Life is far bigger than what many think it is. Which is why Jesus Christ say that **“He is the Resurrection and Life; and that whoever believes in Him, even though he dies, he shall live.”** What then is life if a man die and still lives as Christ promised, then it means that there is more to Life than mere physical existence. Spiritual life is what all Christians should strive for, it is eternal and ever fulfilling because it is rooted in God Who is Eternal and the very fountain of life. Any life therefore that is outside Jesus Christ is as good as dead. Real Eternal Life comes through faith in Jesus Christ alone (John 6:47).

To answer the question **“WHAT IS LIFE”** correctly, we should never forget that we are on a temporary visit on the planet earth. On that note, we should endeavour to weigh our actions and decisions in the light of our ultimate destiny not our immediate pleasure, enjoyment and comfort.

This Life is the short storey, Heaven is the unending one. Jesus answered, it is written, “man does not live by bread alone, but on every Word that comes from the mouth of God” (Matthew 4:4)

Jesus quoted this verse when the devil tempted Him to turn stones into bread. Many people think that life is based on satisfying their appetites, if they can earn enough money to dress, eat and play in high style, do tummy tucks, face lifts, liposuction, fame, fortune and personal pyramids.

Notwithstanding, they think they are living the good life. Forgetting that earthly suit isn't going to last forever. Such things as mentioned above cannot satisfy our deepest longings. In the end they leave us empty and dissatisfied.

REALITIES ABOUT LIFE IS THIS:

1. We may face many injustices.
2. We may not truly be appreciated by others for the love we show.
3. We may be falsely accused and misunderstood by friends and acquaintances.
4. Our ideas and talents may be ignored.

But God is to be praised, for He sees, and remembers all the good we do, and it is up to him to decide the timing and the appropriateness of our rewards. God wants to be number one in our lives, when He is not, things won't work out right for us. And the answer to the question **"WHAT IS LIFE?"** will become more complex and very difficult to get. Instead of asking God to bless our agenda, we should ask Him to give us an agenda He can bless. Now real life according to the Bible comes from Total Commitment to God and living by every WORD that comes from Him.

HOW CAN WE LIVE BY HIS WORD?

1. Recognise our need for it.
2. Agree that God alone can truly satisfy us.
3. Pray for God's presence, wisdom and direction as we read and study His Word.
4. Savour the relationship we have with Him through Christ Jesus (john 14:6)
5. Practice what He teaches us.

Jesus says, he is the only Way to God the Father, some people may agree that this is too narrow, in reality it is wide enough for the whole world, if the world chooses to accept it. Instead of worrying about how limited it sound to have only one way, we should be saying "THANK YOU" GOD, for providing a sure Way to get to You.

As the Way, Jesus is our path to the Father, as the Truth, He is the Reality of All God's promise. As the Life, He give and joins His divine Life to ours, both now and eternally (john 3:16).

In this life, when we want to fully understand and comprehend the question "**WHAT IS LIFE?**", we should endeavour to make the most of what God has given to us.

1. Life
2. Wealth
3. Time
4. Talents
5. Money, etc.

He promises three rewards, when we do that:

First: we will be given a commendation; well-done good and faithful servant.

Secondly: We will receive promotion; I will put you in charge of many things.

Thirdly: we will be honoured with celebration; Come and share your master's happiness (Matt. 25:21-23). Jesus is, in truth, the only living answer to WHAT IS LIFE? (John 1:4). In Him was life and that Life was the light of men. In Him the

question "WHAT IS LIFE?" is answered perfectly (John 3:15, Colossians 2:10).

Some people are repulsed by the idea of eternal life because their lives are miserable, but eternal life is not an extension of man's miserable, mortal life. Eternal life is God's life embodied in Christ, given to all believers now as a guarantee that they will live forever. In eternal life there is no death, sickness, enemy, evil or sin. When we don't know Christ, we make choices as though this life were all we had. In reality, this life is just the introduction to eternity. Receive this new life by faith and begin to evaluate all that happens from an eternal perspective. Life is short, no matter how long we live. Don't be deceived into thinking you have lots of time remaining to live for Christ, to enjoy your loved ones or to do what you know you should. Live for God today. Then no matter when your life ends, you would have fulfilled God's plan for your life.

Charles Chaplain died at the age of 88. He left U.S. Senate with 4 statement:

- 1) Nothing is eternal in this world, not even our problems.
- 2) I like to walk in the rain, because no one can see my tears.
- 3) The most wasted in life is the day we do not laugh.
- 4) The six best doctors in the world
 - i. Sun
 - ii. Rest
 - iii. Exercise
 - iv. Diet
 - v. Self-esteem
 - vi. Friends

Keep them at all stages of your life and enjoy a healthy life...
If you see the moon, you will see the beauty of God. If you see

the sun, you will see the power of God. If you see the mirror, you will see the best creation of God. So, believe it, we are all tourists, God is our travel agent who has already fixed our itineraries, reservations and destinations. Trust Him and enjoy Life!

Life is just a trip!
Start living and stop existing!!!
Share with people who are important to your life.

To understand it, you have to visit these 3 places:

- (1) The hospital
- (2) The prison
- (3) The cemetery

At the hospital, you will understand that nothing is more beautiful than health.

In prison, you will see that liberty is the most precious thing.

In cemetery, you will realize that life is worthless; the ground on which we walk today will be our roof tomorrow. Let us make the efforts to remain humble by having the fear of God and the respect of our neighbours. Please give to people in need no matter how small. You are God's treasure!

If one day, we all are allowed to put our problems on a table and exchange them, I'm sure that after five minutes, everyone would silently take back their own and leave the table.

There is no such thing like a perfect life, nobody has it all together. Just as our faces are different, so are our problems. Never be envious of what someone else has. You don't know

the price they paid to get it and the price they are paying to keep it. You don't own half of the problems in the world. While you are discreetly wishing to be like the other person, someone else is seriously praying for that life you take for granted.

Sometimes the people you envy are actually wishing they could have the life you live. Be contented and cherish what you have. You can be anything you want to be, just don't be ungrateful. If you don't get it, change your perception only then you will understand - **WHAT IS LIFE?**

01

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE ... DARE IT!

When God tells us to do something that seems difficult or unpleasant, he is not trying to make life hard or put us in a strait jacket often he is just getting us to a place where he can bless us.

“Oh, that their hearts would be included to fear me and keep all my commands always, so that it may go well with them and their children forever” (Deut. 5:29)

Anything God asks you to do, carry this thought with it, that it may go well with you. Hopefully, that will help you to start looking at things differently. Living in peace, instead of always going to pieces, it is easier when you learn to respond to God immediately. Don't hesitate, don't negotiate, don't rationalize, and whatever you do, do not run away from God. The only thing that is worse than running away from God is living with the painful aftermath. Your disobedience can take you all the way to the bottom. If you doubt that, stop and read the story of Jonah in the Bible. The truth is, sometimes you will have to sacrifice certain things to obey God. But it is better for you to do that than to ignore His voice, live stressed out, forfeit His blessings and end up getting nowhere. *“Finally, be strong in the Lord and in His mighty power” (Eph. 6:10).*

Don't be surprised when God calls you to step out in faith and do anymore, you don't feel qualified to do. That tends to be

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

His standards of operating procedure. He does it so that you will lean more on Him, and less on yourself. Does that mean you don't make mistakes? No, it means you probably will. But instead of being discouraged you will see them as part of the learning curve and go on to greater things. Often we look at a task and think "*there is no way I can do that*" hold it there, you are looking through the wrong end of the telescope. You are looking at yourself instead of God. When God called Joshua to take the place of Moses, he promised him. "*No one will be able to stand against you all the days of your life. As I was with moses, so I will be with you, I will never leave you nor forsake you*" (Joshua 1:5 NIV)

Now if God promises to be with you, and He does, then that is all you need. His strength is actually showcased in your weakness (2 Cor. 12:9). Whatever ingredient you lack in the natural realm, you can redraw from your account in the spiritual realm. Be strong in the Lord, be empowered through your union with Him; draw your strength from Him, that strength which His boundless might provides. What kind of might is available to your boundless might? And where do you draw it from? The ultimate source is God. You are empowered and equipped as you work with Him, so stop selling yourself short. Armed with His might, you are more capable than you think, and you are able to do a lot more than you have done in the past. So put your confidence in God and stop doubting yourself. It is time to stop debating and start moving, express your uncertainty with confidence. Never look at successful people and assume that single-handedly and with no hesitation they fearlessly navigated the current of uncertainty. No, they just understood that with each step, answers would be given. So instead of pretending to know more than you do, begin to encourage a culture of ideas. When you don't know,

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

just say I don't know. But I'll find out, consult others. King Solomon wrote more about seeking counsel than any other writer in the Bible. Do Kings need good input? Yes!, absolutely and only those with the humility to acknowledge it ever prosper. Measure your success by the score board not the play book. Every good coach goes into the game with a plan, but he is willing to change it in order to win. Pencil down your plans, but write your vision with ink. Good leaders like good coaches are often forced to abandon or amend some of their plans in order to deliver on a vision. The ones who do are the ones who reach their destination. When Israel entered the Promised Land, there were five kings with Armies determined to stop them, but God helped Joshua to defeat them and all the five kings ran and hid in a cave.

So, Joshua told his soldiers to bring them out and put their feet on each of their necks. That day God's word to His people was "Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged, be strong and courageous. This is what the Lord will do to all the enemies you are going to fight" (Joshua 10:25).

What a promise! Are the forces of fear trying to take up residence in your mind today? Are they causing you to think the worst instead of believing God for the best? Are they telling you that you are unworthy to receive what He has promised, that you will never fulfil your destiny? With God your victory is sure and assured. But you have a part to play in it, you must go into that cave, bring each of the king out, place your foot on them and put them to death. These five kings represent your five natural senses:

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

(i) Seeing (ii) Hearing (iii) Smelling (iv) Tasting (v) Touching

God doesn't want you to live according to their dictates. Your senses are susceptible to every negative thing going on around you but your faith can lift you above it and give you victory. But you can't just sit down and do nothing, your passivity give them power to rule you. They have no power over you, except the power you give them.

Upon entering the promised land and encountering five well-entrenched kings, God told Israel: **"Do not be afraid"** (Joshua 10:25 NIV). The word afraid implies being torn down by fear and falling apart. Today, satan wants to tear you down by robbing you down of your peace, your joy and confidence. He will keep intensifying on the pressure in hope that you will fall apart. That is, why God told Joshua to bring each king out of the cave and deal with them decisively on their neck and hanging them on a tree. Satan works through our five senses, but God have given us a sixth sense – FAITH. The Bible says: *"For we live by faith not by sight"* (2 Corinthians 5:7).

Faith says, in spite of what I see, in spite of what I hear, in spite of what I feel, in spite of what I taste, in spite of what I perceive, I believe everything is going to be alright because God is with me. Your senses are FAITH – KILLERS and unless you put them under your feet, they will steal your dreams, your confidence, and everything else God has promised you. Emotions are problem-driven, but FAITH is purpose-driven. If you allow your emotions to rule your life, you will be up one minute, and down the next. You say, but I thought life is supposed to be an upward experience, No! God's plan for you is to get down on your knee to pray, then get up in faith and

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

do what He has for you to do, being adventurous, because you are Limitless Dare It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Those who dare to fail miserably can achieve greatly.
... Robert F. Kennedy
2. Everything you want in life is on the other side of fear, step out and dare it.
... Eckobig Anthony
3. A genius is a person who has encroached into the boundary of impossibility, making it possible, one who took failure and turned it into success.
... Unknown
4. One willing man is more than a million winning men.
... Unknown
5. Unless you continually try to reach higher, go further, see over and grasp something greater than you know, you will never discover your full potential.
... Myles Monroe
6. I am not afraid of storms for I'm learning how to sail my ship.
... Louisa May Alcott
7. History has demonstrated that the most notable winners usually encountered heart breaking obstacles before they triumphed.
... T. S. Elliot

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

8. Don't fear failure so much that you refuse to try new things. The saddest summary of life contains three descriptions, could have, might have and should have.
... Lois Boone
9. Where the willingness is great the difficulties cannot be great.
... Niccolo Machiavelli
10. Every person who wins in any undertaking must be willing to burn his ship and cut all sources of retreat only by so doing can one be sure of maintaining that state of mind known as a burning desire to win, essential to success.
... Unknown
11. Never become a spectator in the grandstand of life, instead risk the arena of conflict to wear the crown of victory.
... Unknown
12. Desire is the starting point of all achievement the first step towards riches.
...Unknown
13. People who take risks, make mistakes and recover, often do better than people who learned not to make mistake because they are afraid of risk.
.... Robert Kiyosaki
14. Your glory lies buried, hidden in your path of greatest affordable risk.
... Unknown
15. Only those who dare to fail greatly can achieve greatly.

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

... *Robert Kennedy*

16. Always allow the motivating force of your faith to be higher than the pressure of giving up.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

17. Genius is one percent aspiration, and ninety-nine percent perspiration.

... *Thomas Edison*

18. When they say it can't be done, find a way to do it right. Never wait for things to happen, do your best to make them happen.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

19. Hope does not necessarily take the form of excessive confidence; rather it involves the simple willingness to take the next step.

... *Stanley Hauerwas*

20. Every new job is a challenge, without God it can be frightening; with God it can be a great adventure.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

21. If you want to be successful, know what you are doing, love what you are doing, and believe in what you are doing.

... *Will Rodgers*

22. You can accomplish more today, than you did yesterday, just be focused and be determined.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

23. Still round the corner, there may wait a new road or a secret gate.
-

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

... J. R. R. Torrey

24. What have we to expect? Anything! What have we to hope for? Everything! What have we to fear? Nothing!

... Edward B. Pulsy

25. Lift up your eyes, the heavenly Father waits to bless you - in inconceivable ways to make your life what you never dreamed it could be.

... Anne Ortlund

26. Let stars stand for those things which are ideal and radiant in life. If we seek sincerely and strive hard enough, it is not impossible to reach them, even though the goals seem distant at the onset. And how often do we shoot stars when we find them close by in the shining lives of great soul~ in the sparkling universe or humanity around us.

... Esther Baldwin York

27. The uncertainties of the present always give way to the enchanted possibilities of the future.

... Gelsey Kirkland

28. Nurture your mind with great thoughts, to believe in the heroic, makes heroes.

... Benjamin Disraeli

29. Every glory has an ugly story; it takes determination and faithfulness to attain it.

... Eckobig Anthony

30. Each chapter and season of life has a benefit and a product if only you will look for it.

... Unknown

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

31. You are only confined by the walls you build yourself.
... *Unknown*
32. When a man is excited about what he has discovered in God for his life, he rejoices even when he is being persecuted for it.
... *Gbile Akanni*
33. You are capable of much more than you are presently thinking, imagining, doing or being.
... *Unknown*
34. Sometimes it is a slender thread, sometimes a strong stout rope, she clings to one end, I the other, she calls it friendship; I call it hope.
... *Unknown*
35. A genius is a person who has encroached into the boundary of impossibility, making it possible, one who took failure and turned it into success. .
... *Unknown*

LIFE IS AN ADVENTURE... DARE IT!

02

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

Common courtesy is becoming less common every day and that is not good because the bible says, “*Be courteous, that you may inherit a blessing*” (I Peter 3:9). Sometimes we are not sure how to go about pleasing God, preachers have made it complicated. The prophet Micah simplifies it; He has shown you a mortal what is good and what does the Lord requires of you? To act justly and to love mercy and to walk humbly with your God (Micah 6:8). What the Lord requires of us is to love mercy, kindness. Could the language be clearer? Here are ten-not-so common courtesies you should work on every day and to teach your children, after all, if they don't learn common courtesy from you, where are they going to learn it?

1. Go out of your way to speak to people, pleasant words are healing (Prov. 16:24)
 2. Try to remember their names, it shows you value them
 3. Smile, it increases your face value
 4. Be friendly and helpful, if you do, people will return it (Prov. 8:4).
 5. Show genuine interest, you can find something good in anybody, if you try. (Phil. 4:8)
 6. Be generous with your praise and cautious with your criticism.
 7. Be slow to judge, there are three sides to every story; your side, their side and the right side
-

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

8. Instead of using others serve them, by love serve one another (Gal. 5:13).
9. Start trusting people, it builds lasting relationships.
10. Be humble, Oswald Chambers said; when a saint becomes conscious of being a saint, something has gone wrong.

Courtesy Does Two Things:

- A. It speaks well of your parents. Jesus said; *"Let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your father in heaven* (Matthew 5:16 NIV).
- B. It determines your level of blessing. Be courteous, that you may inherit a blessing.

Our words and attitudes have a powerful effect on other people. The woman caught in adultery is a case point (John 8). Observe how the Pharisees handled hers. In the law, Moses commanded us to stone such a woman (Vs 5). How different Jesus' attitude was? Looking at her with compassion, He said, neither do I condemn you, go now and leave your life of sin. Lifted, redeemed, empowered. You can't help but believe she spent the rest of her life trying to live up to the view of her the mandate to encourage one another and build up each other is woven throughout the New Testament. All of us need reassurance and appreciation. So why do we pocket the praise and admiration we should pass onto others or sidestep the practical help we could offer to open the way for them to succeed?

Sometimes, it is simply because we are liars or selfish or we fall into the habit of taking people for granted. Sometimes it is just easier to find fault, we under\estimate the impact our words and attitudes can have on another person or assume our

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

approval is obvious, are we afraid our praise or admiration might be a stumbling block, causing pride in them? Jesus didn't fear that when He hailed Nathaniel "... *Here is a true Israelite, in whom there is nothing false*" (John 1:47) "*Now here is a genuine son of Israel, man of complete integrity*" (NLT).

What a compliment. The truth is more people die of broken hearts than swelled heads, nothing builds intimacy like words of love and appreciation. Why do we lose our sense of gratitude and begin to overlook goodness for these reasons:

1. **Problems:** If you close one of your eyes and hold a coin close enough to your other eyes, you can actually block out the light of the eyes from seeing. Getting the point?
2. **Pressure:** Sometimes the perks we thought would bring us pleasures end up wearing us down.
3. **People:** When they disappoint us, we turn sour and forget all the God has done for us.

What is the solution? The faithful love of the Lord never ends. His mercies never cease. "Great is His faithfulness, His mercies begin afresh each morning (Lamentation 3:22, 23 NLT). God's mercies begin each morning, and our gratitude should too. Indeed, your days should be saturated in it. Continual gratitude comes from looking beyond your blessings to their unfailing source, the Lord Jesus Christ. His love, His faithfulness and His mercy are already at work when your eyes open each day forming a negative opinion based on appearance takes less than twenty seconds. It is easy to do when someone doesn't look, or think like you. John says, "*Whoever claims to love God yet hates a brother or sister is a liar. For whoever does not love their brother and sister, whom they have seen, cannot love God who they have not seen*" (1 John 4:20 NIV).

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

You cannot love God if you harbor bad feelings towards others. We are more than flesh, we are spiritual beings and our God given gifts, character, values, intellect and passions are the foundation of who we are, not our height, weight, mannerism, hair colour and age. When we realize God loves us even though He doesn't like some of our attitudes and actions, it becomes easier to love others. When we realize our negative feelings towards others, get in the way of our love for God, it becomes easier to love. And when we are in communion with our creator, asking Him to give us His eyes and heart, it becomes easier to love. It may never be easy to love certain people, but when you make the tough choice to love them anyway, the rewards are always worth it. The Bible says; "*Love never fail, and when you refuse to love, you miss out on God's best.*" Don't miss out on any of it. God is Love, and when you release love, you release God, and He becomes responsible for the outcome. Release Love, compliment every moment into every situation, it is one solution that always works.

Life is Beauty ... Admire It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. May God give you eyes to see beauty only the heart can understand.
... Eckobig Anthony
2. Notice words of compassion; seek out deeds of kindness. These are like the doves from heaven pointing out to you who are the ones blessed with inner grace and beauty.
... Christopher de Vinck.

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

3. Our words and actions are directed energy. They affect not only the persons we direct them to, but also the people they directed them to.
... Unknown
 4. Men of few words are the best men.
... Unknown.
 5. Looking at yourself in the mirror isn't exactly a study of life.
...Lauren Bacall.
 6. The beauty of the world has two edges, one of laughter, one of anguish cutting the heart asunder.
... Virginia Woolf
 7. Try not to become a man of success rather a man of value.
... Albert Einstein
 8. Those who bring sunshine to the lives of others cannot keep it from themselves.
... James Barries
 9. The more you say the less people remember, the fewer the words, the deeper the impression.
... Francis De Salgnal Fenelon
 10. Think of others first, the truth is that none of us is as smart as all of us.
... Unknown
 11. There is something infinitely better than making a living, it is making a noble life.
... Unknown
-

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

12. Character is the corner stone in building and maintaining success.

... *Unknown*

13. Knowing what to say is not always necessary, just the presence of a caring friend can make a world of difference.

... *Shery Curry*

14. Praise is expressing to God our appreciation and understanding of His word. Our inward attitude becomes outward expression when we praise God.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

15. God has wonderful plan for each person, He knew ever before He created the world, what beauty He would bring forth from our lives.

... *Louis B. Wyly*

16. Everyone has inside himself apiece of good news. The good news is that you really don't know how great you can be, how much you can love, what you can accomplish and what your potential is.

... *Anne Frank*

17. Live for something; write your name in kindness, love and mercy on the heart of thousands you come in contact with, you will never be forgotten.

... *Thomas Chalmers*

18. He surrounds me with loving kindness and tender mercies, He fills my life with good things.

... *Psalms 103:4-5.*

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

19. The fullness of our heart is expressed in our eyes, in our touch, in what we write, in what we say, in the way we walk, in the way we receive, they way we need.
... Mother Theresa
20. Nothing is as strong as gentleness and nothing is as gentle as real strength.
... Francis De Sales
21. Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again, rejoice, let your gentleness be evident to all.
... Phil. 4:4
22. What the dew is to the flower, gentle words are to the soul.
... Poly Rupe.
23. I am convinced that God has built into all of us an appreciation for beauty and has allowed us to participate in the creation of beautiful things and places. It may be one way that we can contribute towards bringing in wholeness to our fallen world.
... Mary Jane Worden.
24. Influence often is not noticed until it blossoms, later in the garden of someone else's life. Our words and action may land close to home or they may be carried far and wide.
... Pam Farrel.
25. I have seen what a life can do, it can transform almost unbearable tears into something bearable even hopeful.
... Bob Hope.

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

26. We can make up our minds whether our lives in this world would be beautiful and fragrant like the lilies of the field.

... *Elizabeth Elliot.*

27. Isn't it splendid to think of all the things there are to find out about? It just makes me feel glad to be alive; it's such an interesting world. It wouldn't be half so interesting, if we knew all about everything.

... *Lucy Maud Montgomery.*

28. The miracle of joy is this, it happens when there is no apparent reason for it. Circumstances may call for despair yet something different rouses itself inside us, we are able to remember what the sunrise looks like, we remember God, we remember His love, we remember He is near.

... *Ruth Senter.*

29. I believe that God is in me as the sun is in the colour and fragrance of a flower - the light in my darkness, the voice in my silence.

... *Helen Keller.*

30. God is the friend of silence. Tree, flowers, grass grow in silence. See the stars, moon and sun how they move in silence.

... *Mother Theresa.*

31. I want to help you to grow as beautiful as God meant you to be when He thought of you first.

... *George Macdonald.*

32. The person you see always is the person you will become.

... *Unknown*

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

33. The world's most seductive attractions are only - cheap substitutes for what God has to offer.

... Eckobig Anthony.

34. Good times become good memories; bad times become good lessons. Keep smiling because life is a beautiful thing and there is so much to smile about.

... Jerry John Rawlings.

LIFE IS BEAUTY... ADMIRE IT!

03

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

Patience develops in us the ability to stand up to the pressures that accompanies blessings. Look back, aren't some of the things you have been through the very things that have equipped you to handle what you have now? Had God given them to you sooner, you couldn't have handled them, and He loves you too much to let them happen (Heb 12:5-8 NIV).

Whatever you are going through today, there is a greater peace in knowing that whatsoever the enemy does, nothing can prevent God's plan. So don't be impatient for God to act, keep travelling steadily, along his pathway and in due season He will honour you with all of His blessings if you faint not (Rom. 8:18).

It is the bad time not just the good times that causes us to grow. We receive direction through persecution, sometimes those who attack us are agents of the Lord without even knowing it. God uses them to get us where we need to be. Then like Joseph, we look back years later and say, *"You meant it for evil but God meant it for Good"* (Gen. 50:20). We cry because someone slammed a door in our face but in retrospect we are able to say it was the best thing that could have happened to me. The Psalmist wrote, **"No good thing will he withhold from them that work up-rightly"** (Psalm 8:11). If God is allowing you to go through a tough time, then it must be for your good.

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

Understanding this moves you to a deeper dimension in your walk with God. But every new dimension brings a new level of opposition. Don't forget that the enemy won't give up without a fight whether the battle is over. Your family, your finances, your health, your business or your ministry, expect three things:

1. The closer you get to victory, the more intense the battle becomes.
2. What matters is not your comfort, but what you are called to do.
3. Your victory has been ordained by God, so keep fighting.

While everybody else was preparing to fight, she was preparing to surrender. Somehow, Rahab had heard about what God had done for Israel, how He had turned the red sea to a red carpet, converted rocks into a drinking fountain, made breakfast for them every morning in the Wilderness and dried up the waters of River Jordan. Rahab may not have been wise when it came to her body, but she was wiser than everyone else in town when it came to her soul. She knew it was a fight she can't win. For her, the path to victory was surrender and it is the right path for you too. If only you will stop trying to **"Run the show"** and turn your life over to Jesus Christ, He will take you to places of blessings you have always dreamt of, longed for, but did not know how to get to. God had a great future for Rahab, He planned to make her progenitor to king David and also our Lord Jesus Christ. How is that for recycling? God who loves both the sinner and the saint, the rich and the poor, will do the same for you regardless of the spiritual condition you may be in today. Read this: **"For I know the plans I have for you; says the Lord, they are for good and not for disaster to give you a future and a hope"** (Jer. 29:11)

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

Sometimes, when we have a problem, we do what Mary and Martha did with their deceased brother, Lazarus. We bury it and roll a stone in front of it. Then Jesus Christ comes along and tells us to roll the stone away so He can deal with it and makes us whole again. It takes honesty, humility and courage to roll away the stone on the stubborn or shaming situation. But you will never become healthy and whole until you're willing to do that. Can you imagine the state Lazarus was in the grave after four days? Martha said, "**He stinketh**"; yet Jesus Christ said "**Did I not tell you that if you believe, you will see the glory of God?**" (John 11:40). The great thing about this story is that, no matter how far gone your situation maybe or how unpleasant it is, Jesus Christ can turn it around for you. But you must be willing to roll away the stone and allow Him to work. If you let Him, He will give you back what life has taken from you. People may give up on you but Jesus Christ won't. **HAVE YOU EVER CHANGED A BABY'S NAPPY?** If anything, else smells that bad, you would throw it in the trash but not your baby or children because you love them and know that with a little help they are capable of outgrowing it and becoming something good. Like Mary and Martha, you may think it is too late for a miracle, but it is not. Your finances may stink, your relationship may stink, your prospect for the future may stink, even everything around you may stink but if you will believe, you will see the glory of God.

Life is a Challenge ... Meet It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. To finish what we start takes hard work, wisdom, self-discipline and patience. Anyone with vision can start a big project. But vision without wisdom often results in unfinished projects and goals.
... Eckobig Anthony.
2. High waves that will frighten a swimmer produce a tremendous thrill for the surfer who has ridden them. The things we try to avoid and fight against- tribulation suffering and persecution, are the very things that produce abundant joy in us
... Oswald Chambers.
3. Your success in life is only limited by your willingness to work for it. Too much analysis often leads to action paralysis. Just do it!
... Ope Banwoo.
4. The ultimate measure of a man is not where he stands in the time of comfort and convenience but where he stands in the time of controversy.
... Martin Luther King Jr.
5. History has demonstrated that the most notable winners usually encountered heart breaking obstacles before they triumphed.
... T. S. Elliot
6. The greatest glory in living lies in not falling but in rising every time you fall.
... Nelson Mandela.

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

7. A genius is the person who has encroached into the boundary of impossibility making it possible, one who took failure and turned it into success.
... Unknown.
 8. If the world seems cold to you, kindle fire to warm it.
... Mathild Gage.
 9. Where the willingness is great, the difficulty cannot be great.
... Niccolo Machiaveli
 10. We must accept finite disappointment, but we must not loose infinite hope.
... Martin Luther King Jr.
 11. One willing man is better than a million winning men.
... Unknown
 12. You can measure a man by the number of oppositions it takes to discourage him.
... Robert Savage.
 13. You must pay the price if you wish to secure the blessing.
... Andrew Jackson.
 14. You either ride life or it rides you, your mental attitude determines who is the rider or the horse.
... Napoleon Hill.
 15. The turning point in the lives of those who succeed usually comes at the moment of crisis through which they are introduced to their other selves.
... John Bunyan.
-

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

16. Many a man has finally succeed only because .he failed after repeated efforts, if he had never met defeat, he would have never known great victory.
... *Orison Swett Marden.*
17. No one ever is defeated until defeat has been accepted as a reality.
... *Unknown.*
18. Our attitude, colour, our whole personality, we cannot always choose what happens to us but we can choose our attitude to different situations.
... *Unknown.*
19. In those things towards which we exacted our best endeavours we succeed.
... *Unknown.*
20. No one deserves the right to live without first persevering through pains, heart aches and failures.
... *Charles Swindoll.*
21. The crowd is never friendly, they only support their own. So to win life's challenge, you must ignore what people are saying about you and never forget that the pathway of champions is littered with scorpions, snakes, false accusation, scoffers, scandals, mistakes and enemies (unfriendly friends).
... *Unknown.*
22. The gem cannot be polished without friction nor a man perfected without trials.
... *Chinese Proverbs.*
-

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

23. Viewing impossible situation from Gods point of view helps us to put giant problems in perspective. Once we can see clearly, we can fight more effectively.

... Eckobig Anthony.

24. Since you will need fresh energy and new insight to handle what tomorrow throws at you, wait until it dawns before taking it on. Some of the things you do today may seem totally insignificant as far as tomorrow is concerned but stay at it.

... Charles .R. Swindoll.

25. You have to have faith that there is a reason you go through certain things. I can't say I am glad to go through pain but in a way one MUST, in order to gain courage and really feel joy.

... Carol Burnet.

26. The God who created the vast resources of the universe is also the inventor of the human mind. His inspired words, encouragement guarantee us that we can live above circumstances.

... James Dobson.

27. You can come out of furnace of trouble in two ways. If you let it consume you, you come out a cinder, but there is a kind of metal which refuses to be consumed and comes out a star.

... Unknown.

28. The Lord doesn't always remove the sources of stress in our lives, but he is always there and cares for us. We can feel His arm around us on the darkest night.

... James Dickson.

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

29. Times of help keep my focus on God, during times when I am surrounded and overwhelmed by the cares and commitment of my life..

... Keri Wyatt Kent.

30. Perhaps this moment is unclear, But let it be even if the next and many moments after are unclear let them be. Trust that God will help. you work them) out and that all the unclear moments will bring you to that moment of clarity and action when you are known by Him and know him. These are the better and brighter moments of 'His blessings.

... Unknown.

31. Blessed are the flexible for they shall not be bent out of shape.

... Barbara Johnson.

32. I thank God for my handicaps, for through them I have found myself, my work and my God.

... Helen Keller.

33. In every desert of trial, God has an oasis of comfort.

... Unknown.

34. An umbrella can't stop the rain, but it allow us to stan in the rain. Confidence may not bring success but it gives us power to face challenge.

... Jerry John Rawlings.

35. If God is with you, no amount of darkness can dim your light. No matter how dark it is, the hand can always locate the mouth.

... Ven. Okey Ifionu.

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

36. It is usually, through hard times, the unexpected and not-according-to-plan times, that we experience God in more intimate ways. We discover an unquenchable longing to know him more, it is a passion that isn't concerned that life fall within certain predictable lines, but a passion that pursues God and knows He is relentless in His pursuit of each one of us.

... *Unknown.*

LIFE IS A CHALLENGE ... MEET IT!

04

LIFE IS A DRIVEWAY ... BE CAREFUL!

Life is a driveway and daily living itself is akin to continuously steering the wheels of a vehicle. Sometime ago on a particular express road, there use to be a dangerous bend at a particular point where vehicles crashed and ran into a ditch on an almost daily basis. To check the rate of accidents at this point, the government took step to arrest the situation. Three large warning signs were erected at about 50 meters equidistance.

1. SLOW DOWN
2. DANGEROUS BEND AHEAD
3. YOU ARE WARNED!

Ordinarily one would assume this is enough reasonable check on any motorist, but many motorists never lived to tell the story. They perished in spite the opportunity given to them to live. Today as you read this book; **WHAT IS LIFE?** You are cruising through a driveway. Like on any driveway, obedience to simple traffic rules means safety, while disobedience, dangerous, and reckless driving spells death, doom, disaster, and destruction. Dear reader, has it ever occurred to you that life is a driveway?

Are you aware of the drive codes? By the way how are you driving on this way? *"For we are strangers before thee, and sojourners, as were all our fathers; our days on earth are as a shadow, and there is not abiding"* (1 Chronicles 29:15). *"For here we do not*

LIFE IS A DRIVEWAY ... BE CAREFUL!

have an enduring city, but we are looking for the city that is to come" (Heb. 13:14 NIV). Life and death are enough proof that life is a driveway. Unfortunately, many leave the wheels of their lives to Satan only for them to crash eventually. The traffic department produces a booklet called the highway code. A motorist needs to understand everything in this small booklet, which serves as a guide for proper behaviour on the steering.

The word of God "Holy Bible" reveals the Highway Code for driving along life lane. Jesus Christ answered and said, *"I am the WAY, the Truth and Life, no man cometh to the Father but by Me"* (John 14:6). *"He that believeth on the son hath everlasting life, and he that believeth not on the son, shall not see life, but the wrath of God abideth on him"* (John 3:36). *"Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path"* (Psalm 119:105).

Dear, the Highway Code is not religion, educational degree, fame, position, wealth, beauty or connections. The Highway Code is been saved by having Jesus Christ as your personal Lord and Saviour. Jesus Christ as your Highway Code cannot be substituted with anything in this world, not even chains of degree theology. Many never realize that life is a driveway, not to talk of finding the right code for living. Satan deceives many to believe that they have the code, whereas they do not. A man may have seen a luxury car on the highway, yet he may not personally own one. This is true of many that have heard of Jesus Christ. Some even have believing relatives, yet they themselves are yet to accept the Lordship of Jesus Christ. How are you driving on the dangerous way of life? There are only two controlling powers on this driveway, Jesus Christ and satan. A crash is therefore imminent. You are an alcoholic, you womanize, tell lies, use foul language and deceive people, you

LIFE IS A DRIVEWAY ... BE CAREFUL!

are involved in cultism, ancestral worship or you have or are practicing vain religious outside Jesus Christ, or have refused the Lordship of Jesus Christ and have continue to live in sin, surely, you are driving dangerously and your case is similar to one driving along the road described at the beginning of this chapter.

Jesus Christ is calling you today to accept His own drive code. In all of life's problems *"including the ones facing you now"*, Jesus Christ has already made a good provision for you. Hear Him. *"When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you pass through the rivers, they will not sweep over you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be burned; the flames will not set you ablaze"* (Isa. 43:12).

Do you want to enjoy eternal insurance? Jesus died for you, yes you, so that this insurance could cover you if you so desire. Avoid crash today by accepting Jesus Christ.

Life is a Driveway ... Be careful!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. When you can't change the direction of the wind adjust your sail.
... Max Depre
2. Sometimes we just need to slowdown and live.
... Eckobig Anthony
3. Nothing in the entire world is more dangerous than sincere ignorance and conscientious stupidity.
... Martin Luther King Jr.

LIFE IS A DRIVEWAY ... BE CAREFUL!

4. As soon as there is life there is danger.
... *Ralph Waldo Emerson.*
 5. Danger gleams like sunshine to a brave man's eyes.
... *Unknown*
 6. If one is forever cautious, can one remain a human being?
... *Alexander Solzhenitsym*
 7. The cautious seldom err.
...*Confucius*
 8. Be careful when you are blindly following the masses,
sometimes the “M” is silent.
... *Unknown*
 9. We are what we pretend to be, so we must be careful what
we pretend to be.
... *Kurt Vannegut.*
 10. Be careful what thoughts you allow to take real estate in
your mind.
... *Unknown*
 11. You can't be friends with someone who wants your life.
... *Oprah Winfrey*
 12. The tongue has no bone but it is strong enough to break
heart. So be careful with your words.
... *Unknown.*
 13. Talent is God-given – be humble. Fame is man-given – be
grateful. Conceit is self-given, be careful
... *John Wooden*
-

LIFE IS A DRIVEWAY ... BE CAREFUL!

14. The muddy the water, to make it seems deep.
... Friedrich Nietzsche
 15. Align yourself with people that you can learn from,
people who want more out of life, and people who are
stretching and searching and seeking some higher
grounds in life.
... Les Brown
 16. You don't have to have it all figured out to move forward.
Just take the next step.
.... Unknown
 17. What you allow is what will continue.
... Unknown
 18. Sometimes things have to go wrong in order to go right.
... Sherrilyn Kenyon.
 19. Remember how far you've come, not just how far you
have to go. You are not where you want to be, but neither
are you where you used to be.
... Rick Warren
 20. The beginning is the most important part of the work.
... Plato
 21. The future lies before you, like a field of fallen snow, be
careful how you tread it, for every step will show.
... Unknown
 22. There are no speed limits on the road to success.
... Unknown
-

LIFE IS A DRIVEWAY ... BE CAREFUL!

23. Lord, make me to know my end, and the measure of my days what it is, that I may know how frail I am.
... *Psalm 39:4*
24. Be careful ... not all are what they seem, some people pretend to be the beach, but they are actually quicksand.
... *Steve Maraboli*
25. Today I will slow down, smile, and enjoy it.
... *Unknown*
26. A good friend is a connection to life, a tie to the past, a road to the future, the key to sanity in a totally insane world.
... *Lois Wyse.*
27. Whenever you change the way you look at things, things you look at change.
... *Unknown*
28. Your biggest risk will be the one you don't take.
... *Unknown*
29. The scariest thing about distance is you don't know whether they will miss you or forget about you.
... *The Notebook*
30. Sometimes we just need to slow down and grow.
... *Lois Wyse.*
31. Slow and steady makes a perfect welcome.
... *Unknown.*
32. Slow and steady wins the race.
... *Unknown*
-

05

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

To fulfil your dream, you must learn to share it with others. And to do that successfully, you must be able to connect with them in four ways.

First, you must connect with them logically. What people don't believe; they don't buy into. So your first step is to gain credibility. If you don't, you will not be able to proceed any further. How do you do that? By communicating a realistic understanding of the situation as it is today. Every time you share your vision, one of the first thing people will ask is – **What about ...?** If they don't ask it loud, they say it to themselves. And they will keep asking it until you have addressed all their concerns. This requires being extremely thorough when sharing your dreams, and not dwelling on the positive benefits to the exclusion of the challenges.

Second, you must provide a sound strategy they can believe in. If a dream seems too large and unattainable, people will become discouraged and quickly lose interest. When big dreams are broken into smaller pieces and different pieces are given to talented individuals, the task seems more attainable, and each person involved has an increased sense of personal ownership and involvement. There is a real art to communicating all this effectively; without getting bogged down in details or boring people. You have to give enough information to satisfy most people, but not so much that you

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

lose them. All this takes skills, practice and God's help. But to share your dream with others, you must learn to do it (1 Cor. 1:10).

Third, you must share your dreams emotionally. Apostle Paul knew how to do this (Phil. 4:15-17). Get people excited about the rewards. Show them the dream from their perspective. Ralph Waldo Emerson struggled, trying to wrestle a young Calf in his barn, he was ready to give up when an Irish servant girl walked over the Calf, stuck her finger in its mouth, and the calf associating the sensation with its mother, followed the girl into the barn. Pushing and prodding people doesn't work, but if you help them to feel that they will benefit personally, they are likely to go along. People do things for their own reasons, not yours. And their reasons are almost always tied to their emotions. Don't be afraid to show people your heart. People buy into dreamers before they buy into the dream. You may be able to communicate the idea of your dream in few minutes, but it will take a lot longer to convince people of where your heart is. It will require patience, of course you are enthusiastic, but you must adapt to your strides to the lower pace of others. If you run too far ahead, you will lose your power to influence them. Generally, people have to hear an idea at least seven times before they embrace it and call it their own. Ten percent of people are pioneers, 70 percent are settlers and 20 percent are antagonists. Make it your goal to win over the pioneers, to wait for the settlers and to leave the antagonists behind.

Fourth, you must share your dream visually (2 Kings 6:17). Only when people see it, they will buy into it. People are in search of significance, they want to feel they are part of something bigger than themselves. Most of us are looking for a calling, not a job. Most of us have jobs that are too small for

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

our spirit. When a dream is truly great, it benefits everyone. Your job is to help people see what those benefits are. You need to help them connect with the opportunities for achieving personal growth, finding fulfillment and increasing their self-esteem. You need to provide them with every reason you have for them joining, if you can't offer them plenty of legitimate reasons for doing so, then you have no business trying to recruit them in the first place.

WILL THIS BE EASY? – NO! It never is. Even people who say they desire a dream often don't want it. What they want is the result of the dream, not the price required to achieve it. Look at all the TV commercials for diets, people see the before and after pictures, and they want the after. But if you live your dream, practice integrity and achieve a degree of success, people will see what the dream has done for you and that will make them want it too. How will you know when you have successfully share your dream with someone else? Because they will take ownership of it, add to it and want to make it even bigger and better. When that happens, your dream becomes bigger than you or your team. Too many of us stands on the dock waiting, we want the ship in place, the gangplank perfectly positioned, the weather right, and an engraved invitation before we are willing to launch out. It will never happen! Dreams don't move towards us, we have to move towards them.

It is time to quit waiting for perfection, inspiration, permission, reassurance, someone to change, the right person to come along, the kids to leave home, the new administration to take over, an absence of risk, someone to discover you, a clean set of instructions, more self-confidence or the pain to go away. Stop waiting and start working towards realizing your

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

dreams. Successful people do not spend the majority of their time thinking about what must be done; instead they spend twice as much time reflecting on what they have already accomplished. And how they are capable of accomplishing what they set out to do. John Wooden said: *"Things turn out best for the people who make the best of the way things turn out"*. Pushing a God given dream is a bumpy ride, as every leader in the Bible found out, and only those who think right succeed.

The greatest gap between successful people and unsuccessful people is the thinking gap. This is especially so when it comes to failure. Successful people see failure as a regular part of success, and they get over it. They keep trying, keep learning, and keep moving forward. They win the battle in their minds and then it overflows into what they do.

Let's look at some of the excuses we offer for not pushing the dreams God has given us.

1. **NO VISION (Joel 2:28):** Dreams don't come true for ordinary people without vision to pursue their God given dreams. The Wright Brothers wanted to fly, Winston Churchill envisioned a free Europe, Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. dreamt of racial equality. But you don't have to be a world figure to have a dream, No! The pursuit of a dream is what make the difference between ordinary and extra ordinary people. Ordinary people live extra ordinary lives when they follow their dreams. Why do we say that? Because God given dream will motivate you to make important changes in your life. You won't change who you are in order to live your dream, you pursue your dream, and the process changes who you are and what you can accomplish. In other words, your dream is both your goal and your change agent.

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

2. **NO PASSION (Gen. 37:6):** He said to them, listen to this dream I had. Eckobig Anthony said, passion fuels the pursuit of dream. If the dream isn't big enough, it is not worth pursuing. *"Size doesn't determine significance, your dream doesn't have to be big, it just have to be bigger than you."* Mother Theresa said, *"We can't all do great things but we can all do small things with great love"*.
3. **NO MOTIVATION (Joshua 1:9):** Have I not commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid, do not be discouraged, for the Lord your God will be with you wherever you go. Now is the right time to pursue your dream, permission to pursue your dream comes from two sources, God and yourself. George Elliot said: *"it is never too late to become what you might have been"*. The timing will never be perfect for you to pursue your dream, so you might as well start now. If you don't, next year you will be one year older and not a step closer to it.

Life is a dream ... Realise It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. A man with dreams is a man with wings, he can soar high to any height, which practically would be too high for others.

... Unknown.
2. People with dreams are never enslaved by economic or social limitations; instead they shine through adversity and create new records.

... Unknown.

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

3. Don't dream up thousands of reason why you can't do what you want to, find one reason why you can.
... John L. Mason.
4. Dreams are renewable; there are still untapped possibilities within you and a beauty waiting to be born.
... Dr. Dale Tuner.
5. Be lieve in your dreams, they are not coincidences, they are given to you for a reason.,
... Eckobig Anthony.
6. Until your mind is set to achieve a thing in life, you will continue to wish for things instead of working for them.
.... Unknown.
7. Unless you continually try to reach higher, go farther, see over and grasp something greater than you know, you will never discover your full potential.
... Myles Monreo
8. Vision doesn't follow resources; it happens the other way round. First we have a dream, and we move forward with it, then and only then do people and resources follow.
... Eckobig Anthon
9. Never become a spectator in the grand stand of life, instead risk the arena of conflict to wear the crown of victory.
... Unknown

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

10. Greatness comes when you take some knocks, some disappointment, when sadness comes, because only if you've been in the deepest valley can you ever know how magnificent it is for you to be on the mountain.
... Richard Nixon
11. There is nothing like a perfect dream, all dreams are imperfect until worked out, believe in your dreams with all its imperfections.
... Unknown
12. Determination and perseverance moves the world, thinking that others will do It for you IS a sure way to fail.
... Marva Collins
13. Decision and determination are the engineer and the firearm of our train, opportunity and success.
... Burt Lawlor
14. The art of record breaking is the ability to take more out of yourself than you've got.
... Unknown
15. The gem cannot be polished without friction nor a man perfected without trails.
... Chinese Proverb
16. In whatever place you find yourself in life; continually ask God to help you see and respond to need that you are uniquely placed to meet.
... Eckobig Anthony

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

17. You must know all there is to know in your particular field and keep on the alert for new knowledge. The least difference in knowledge between you and another person may spell his success and your failure.
... Henry Ford
18. Nothing great will ever be accomplished without great men, and men are great only if they are determined to be so.
... Charles De Gaulle
19. We must accept finite disappointment, but we must not lose infinite hope.
... Martin Luther King Jr.
20. It is in your worst moment that God gives you some of your best insight.
... Eckobig Anthony.
21. Great achievers are people who are immune to fear, blind to possibilities of failure.
... Unknown
22. You must pay the price if you must secure the blessings.
... Andrew Jackson
23. Many of life's failure are people who do not realise how close they were to success when they gave up.
... Thomas Eddison.

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

24. Every person who wins in any undertaken must be willing to burn his ship and cut all sources of retreat, only by so doing one can be sure of maintaining that state of mind known as a burning desire to win, essential to success.

... *Unknown.*

25. You've got to get up every morning with determination, if you are going to go to bed with satisfaction.

... *George Horace Horier.*

26. Destiny is the force that generates a passion and willingness in a man to stake his life for something in order to make an impact.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

27. Dreams only became reality when we keep our commitment to them.

... *Judy Wardell Halliday.*

28. The crowd is never friendly, they only support their own, so to win life's race, you must ignore what people are saying about you, and never forget that the pathway of champions are littered with scorpions, mistakes, snakes, false accusations, scoffers, scandals and enemies (unfriendly friends).

... *Unknown*

29. Champions aren't made in the gyms; they are made from something they have deep inside them, a desire, a dream, and a vision.

... *Muhammed Ali*

LIFE IS A DREAM ... REALISE IT!

30. Allow your dreams a place in your prayers, and plans.
God's given dreams can help you move into the future
He's preparing for you.

... *Barbara Johnson.*

31. Hold fast your dream! Within your heart keep one still
secret spot where your dream may go and sheltered so
that it may thrive and grow.

... *Louise Driscoll*

32. The stars exist that we might know how high our dreams
can soar.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

33. Anything in life worth having, is worth working for.

... *Unknown*

34. Your friends will stretch your vision or choke your
dreams.

... *Napoleon Hill*

06

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

Focusing solely on what you can do, without first deciding what kind of person you should be is a mistake. (Micah 6:8) *“he has shown you O mortal, what is good. And what does the Lord require of you? And to walk humbly with your God”.*

Your talent may make your name known, but your character will determine what people associates with you. Your talent may dictate your potential but your character will determine your legacy.

WHAT IS CHARACTER? It is the will to do what is right, even when it is not easy. It's deciding ahead of time what is truly non-negotiable, count on it. The day will come when so-called **“progress”** calls for compromising your conviction. In that moment, what hangs in the balance is your moral authority. So, you must be clear about your convictions. You will be tempted to believe that once you reach a certain level of success, these challenges disappear. No, success doesn't make anything easier, it just raises the steaks. What was once applauded is now simply expected. It's a lot easier to win the title than defend it.

Furthermore, with success comes the inclination to see yourself as the final authority on right and wrong. Look around and you will see that it is not uncommon to find

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

leaders playing by a different set of rules. Everything we need really does not look different at the top. Once intoxicated by success, you can start to believe that the rules don't apply to you, and that can be fatal. In the final analysis, your reputation is how you are known before men but your character is how you're known before God. You say, *"but why cling to something that is outdated or has the potential to slow me down?"* the Bible answers; this is what God requires ... to act justly and have mercy and to walk humbly with your God. *"For the son of man is going to come in His Father's glory with His Angels and then He will reward each person according to what they have done"* (Matthew 16:27) Jesus Christ answered, *"If you want to be perfect, go sell your possessions and give to the poor and you will have treasure in heaven. Then come follow me"* (Matthew 19:21). *"Although they cannot repay you, you will be repaid at the resurrection of the righteous"* (Luke 14:14).

God is keeping track record of what you do for Him each day. You have more to gain by serving the Lord than you ever imagine. Yes, He will bless and reward you in this life, but not by comparison to what awaits you in the next one. When you know that, simple decisions such as how to spend your time, your money and your energy suddenly become opportunities with great promise. Once you understand that, you will begin to live with an unshakable certainty that everything you do today matters forever. And that truth can change your life for better. Jesus Christ said, *"Blessed are you when people hate you, when they exclude you and insult you and reject your name as evil, because of the Son of man. Rejoice in that day and leap for joy, because great is your reward in heaven, for that is how their ancestors treated the prophets"* (Luke 6:22-23).

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

Now, Jesus Christ didn't mean that when you are mistreated by His behalf, you will be so happy, you want to jump. No, He said, "*Great is your reward in heaven*". Those six words reveal why you can rejoice in the worst of circumstances. You see there is a direct connection between something you do for God on earth, and something great He is going to do for you in heaven. Jesus Christ isn't asking you to enjoy misery on His behalf, that's masochism – "*Enjoying a painful activity*". He is saying that your reward is in heaven, for certain actions on earth, it will be so wonderful that simply knowing this can transform how you live now. It can actually create spontaneous outbursts of joy. Your life is like a camera, you have got to focus it correctly to get the right result. Having the right focus can bring four results:

1. **It simplifies things:** When you are not clear as to your purpose, you try to do too much and it causes stress, inner conflict and confusion. You have only enough time and energy to do God's will. Not getting everything done maybe an indicator that you are doing far more than God ever intended. Focus leads to a simpler lifestyle and a saner schedule. Only when you keep your mind you can keep your focus, you can keep your peace. "*You will keep in perfect peace whose mind is steadfast, because He trusts in you*" (Isaiah 26:3 NIV).
2. **It gives you direction:** If you want your life to have impact, consult God, and then do what He tells you. Don't confuse activity with productivity. Diffused light has limited impacts but when light is focus with the laser, it can cut through steel.

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

3. **It energizes you:** It is meaningless work not overwork that wears people down. George Shaw said, *"This is the true joy of life; being used up for a purpose recognized by yourself as a mighty one. Being a force of nature instead of a selfish little cloth of ailments and grievances, complaining that the world will not devote itself to making you happy"*.
4. **Finally, it determines your legacy:** When people recall your name, what will they associate with it? A good name is more desirable than great riches; to be esteemed is better than silver and gold (Proverbs 22:1). Ultimately, what matters isn't what others say about you, but what God says. So focus the major not the minor.

Life Is A Duty ... Perform It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. In whatever place you find yourself in life; continually ask God to help you see and respond to the need that you are uniquely placed to meet.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 2. A man's attitude to ordinary things, in ordinary times and ordinary places tells much about who he really is.
... Gbile Akanni
 3. Heavenly father, teach me not to procrastinate but to do what I can today, because there is no promise of tomorrow. Lead me to those people who are in need of something that I can give; I want to be available for you in any way that you should choose. Amen.
... Kim Boyce
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LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

4. Nobility isn't about being better than anyone else, it is about being better than you used to be.
... Rossi.
5. Your commitment in that which is least is judged to be your best in that which is much.
... Gbile Akanni.
6. The world has yet to see what God will do with and for and through and in and by the man who is fully and wholly consecrated to him, I will try my utmost to be that man.
... Dwight L. Moody.
7. The art of record breaking is the ability to take more out of yourself than you've got.
... Unknown.
8. Determination and perseverance move the world, thinking that others will do it for you is a sure way to fail.
... Marya Collins
9. It is not size or quantity that God measures, it is faithfulness.
... Gbile Akanni.
10. You possess awesome potentials within, waiting to be activated and released of your potential demands that you refused to be satisfied with your latest accomplishment.
... Myles Munreo.

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

11. One of the most common causes of failure is the habit of quitting when one is overtaken by temporary defeat.
... *Unknown*
12. The largest room in the world is the room of improvement.
... *Unknown.*
13. Everything you have on earth is allocated to you as a capital to trade for eternity.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
14. Timely advice is as lovely as gold apples in a silver basket.
... *Proverbs 25:11.*
15. One of the main weaknesses of mankind is the average man's familiarity with the word "impossible", he knows all the rules which will not work and all the things which cannot be done.
... *Unknown.*
16. When you become detached mentally from yourself and concentrated on helping other people with their difficulties, you will be able to cope with your own more effectively. Somehow the act of self-giving is a personal power-releasing factor.
... *Norman Vincent Peale.*
17. Discipline is the soul of an army, it makes small numbers formidable, procure success to the weak and esteem to all.
... *George Washington.*

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

18. A Word of encouragement offered at the right moment can be the difference between finishing well and collapsing along the way.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 19. Anything acquired without effort, and without cost is generally unappreciated, often discredited.
... Unknown.
 20. Dress for the job you want, not for the one you already have.
... James Agur.
 21. Champions in any field are potential maximizers.
... Unknown
 22. Planning is a responsibility and not an option.
... Unknown.
 23. Every actions of life touches on some certain cords that vibrates for eternity.
... Edwin Hubble.
 24. The price of greatness is responsibility.
... Winston Churchill.
 25. Remember it is not what you have, it is what you do with what you have that matters.
... Eckoig Anthony.
 26. It is the duty of every Christian to be Christ to his neighbour.
... Martin Luther
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LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

27. Remember that you are needed. There is at least one important work to be done that will not be done unless you do it.

... *Unknown.*

28. We must not in trying to think about how we can make a big difference, ignore the small daily differences we can make which over time add up to big differences that we often cannot foresee.

... *Maria Wright Edelman.*

29. Don't put off for tomorrow what you can do today, because if you enjoy it today, you can do it tomorrow.

... *James Michener*

30. Bless every humble soul who in those days of stress and strain, preached sermon without word.

... *Peter Marshall*

31. Courage is contagious; when a brave man takes a stand the spines of others are often stiffened.

... *Billy Graham.*

32. Don't think so much about who is for or against you, rather give all your care that God be with you in everything you do.

... *Thomas A. Kempis.*

33. That is God call to us - simply to be people who are contend to live close to him and to renew the kind of life in which the closeness is felt and experienced.

... *Thomas Merton.*

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

34. Prayer is not asking, prayer is putting oneself in the hand of God, at his disposition and listening to his voice in the depth of our hearts.

... *Mother Teresa.*

35. It's not what we do that matters but what the sovereign God chooses to do through us. God doesn't want our success, He wants us.

... *Charles Colson.*

36. It is not the work we do that is so important, it is the people we work with, it is the work God does in our lives through them, and it is the work he does in their lives through us. That is what is sacred, slowing down and stopping is our way of acknowledging it.

... *Ken Gire.*

37. In response to all he has done for us, let us outdo each other in being helpful and kind to each other and in doing good.

... *Hebrew 10:25*

38. Part of our job is simply to be always attentive to what we are doing and what is going on inside us and at the same time listen and pay attention to the people and events around us. Part of our job is to expect that if we are attentive and willing, God will **"give"** us prayer **"will"** give us the things we need, **"our daily bread"** to heal and grow in love.

... *Roberta Bondi.*

LIFE IS A DUTY ... PERFORM IT!

39. One of the most important responsibilities in the life of a Christian is to care about others, smile at them and be a friend to the friendless.

... *James Dosson*

40. True prayer is simply a quiet, sincere, genuine conversation with God. It is a two-way dialogue with friends.

... *W. Philip Keller.*

41. Time alone with God can help us grow, but so can serving others. Instead of feeling guilty about how little time alone I get, I need to look at how I can connect with God in the midst of my chaos.

... *Keri Wyatt Kent.*

42. One taper lights a thousand, yet shines as it has shone, and the humblest light may kindle a light brighter than its own.

... *Hezekiah Butter Worth*

43. All your years on earth are a capital deposit given to you by God to trade for eternity.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

07

LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

A family executing their carefully planned escape at midnight, dashing for the border, a man standing outside the prison walls, gulping fresh air, a washed in the new sun, a young woman with every trace of the ravaging drugs gone from her system ... they are FREE!

With fresh anticipation, they can begin life anew. Whether feeling oppression, stepping out of prison, or breaking a strangling habit, freedom means LIFE. There is nothing so exhilarating as to know that the past is forgotten and that new options awaits. People yearn to be free. *“For by the grace given me I say to every one of you; do not think of yourself more highly than you ought to, but rather think of yourself with sober judgment, in accordance with faith God has distributed to each of you”* (Romans 13:3 NIV).

The amount of faith God has given you is equal to the assignment He’s given you. So, whatever you are facing, tell yourself, God has given me faith to handle this. Nothing is more important than your faith. Jesus Christ told Peter; *Simon, Simon, satan has asked to sift all of you as wheat. But I have prayed for you, Simon, that your faith may strengthen your brother* (Luke 22:31-32 NIV).

Faith is more important than money, or career success, or reputation. Everything can be taken from you, but if you have

faith you'll bounce back. Faith is like having a direct line to God. As prayer of faith goes up, His power and answer flows down. As a result, you are more than adequate for the challenge. Failure is never final, as long as your faith doesn't fail. That is why satan will do everything he can each day to keep you from spending time in the scriptures. Consequently, faith comes from hearing the message, and the message is heard through the word about Jesus Christ (Romans 10:17 NIV). Jesus Christ said, *"Because you have so little faith, truly I tell you, if you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, move from here to there".* And it will move. Nothing will be impossible for you.

There are obstacles in your life that will only be removed by faith. And you don't need a truckload of it, just a mustard seed. Think a tiny seed has the power to grow, overcome obstacles, and become a mighty tree. It will press up through the ground, around rocks, braving storms, withstanding animals and other treats to its life. It is not so much the size of your faith, but the quality of it that determines your success. So, use your "measure of faith".

One day a chronically ill woman who had haemorrhage for 12 years pushed her way through the crowd and touches the hem of Jesus Christ garment, and He said, **"Who touched me"?** (Luke 8:45). When all denied it, Peter and those with Him said, **"MASTER,** the multitude throng and press you, and you say, **"who touched me".** But Jesus Christ said, **"somebody touched me, for I perceived power going out from me".** Now the woman saw that she was not hidden, she came trembling, and falling down before Him, she declared to Him in the presence of all the people how she was healed immediately. And He

said to her, **“Daughter, be of good cheer, your faith has made you well”**. Go in peace.

What is at work in this story? FAITH **“expressed and exercised”**. Notice Peter’s words; **‘Master the multitude throng and pressed you’** and you say **‘who touched me’?** Understand this: Jesus Christ can tell the difference between the indiscriminate touch of the crowd, and a touch of faith. Faith draws out His power and brings result. Notice this woman touched the hem of Jesus Christ garment. The last thing a dressmaker does when she makes a garment is to sew up the hem. So the hem represents the finish work. The same back that bore the cross which takes away your sins, also bore the stripes which takes away your sickness. *“But He was pierced for our transgressions, he was crushed for our iniquities; the punishment that brought us peace was on Him, and by His wounds, we are healed”* (Isaiah 55:3 NIV). What do you need today? Forgiveness of sins? Healing? Deliverance? Salvation? Restoration? Reconciliation? Reach out in faith to Jesus Christ, and you too will be made whole.

The disciple went and woke Him, saying, **“Master, Master, we’re going to drown”**! he got up and rebuke the wind and the raging waters, the storm subsided, and all was calm. **“Where is your faith?”** He asked the disciples. In fear and amazement they asked one another, **“Who is this? He command even the wind and the water, and they obey Him”** (Luke 8:24-25 NIV). Observe what is at work in the above story: a fearful spirit, the exact opposite of active faith. No matter how often God blesses us and answers our prayers, we still give in to fears the next time we face a crisis, especially when it is one we haven’t face before. Who told the disciple to get into the boat in the first place? The answer is Jesus Christ. Understand this: faith

doesn't exempt you from life's storms; it equips you to go through it, however, severe.

Jesus Christ knew the storm was coming before the disciples ever stepped into the boat. So why did He exposed them to it? Because He was equipping them for the future, for the day when He would no longer be around and they would face persecution, imprisonment and even death. So don't be afraid, the Lord is with you, you are going to make it to the other side. The Bible says, **"For we live by faith, not by sight"** (2 Corinth. 5:7 NIV). The devil doesn't mind you speaking words of faith as long as you don't take steps of faith. So trust God when He says something to you, it is always for a good reason. When He tells you to do something, He will give you the strength and resources to do it. Apostle Jude writes, ***"But you, dear friends, faith and praying in the Holy Spirit"*** (Jude 1:20 NIV). Jude places the responsibility of building yourself up spiritually and strengthening your faith where it belongs squarely on you. There are two kinds of faith:

- (1) Mechanical faith
- (2) Intentional faith

Each time you flip on a light switch you are exercising mechanical faith. But when you face the unknown, the untried, and the undone, you need intentional faith, faith that believes God to do exceedingly, abundantly above all that you ask or think (Eph. 3:20). If you are proactive, your faith will grow. If you are passive, it won't. Like the rush of water against the riverbank, there is an erosion of faith that comes simply from living everyday. If you don't do anything to secure and strengthen your faith, it begins to deteriorate. Christ told the Church at Ephesus to remember the heights from which they had fallen (Rev. 2:5). What a strange thing to say! If you fell

from a significance height don't you think you will remember it? Not if this fall was so gradual that you didn't notice it. So ask yourself, have those who know me best begun to notice that the glam has gone out of my eyes, the joy out of my step, the peace out of my spirit and the word of God out of my conversation?

Faith is like a muscle; if you don't exercise it consistently it will atrophy and become powerless. Hear this! *Wake up, strengthen what remains and is about to die, for I have found your deeds unfinished in the sight of my God*" (Rev. 3:2 NIV). This word "**Building**" is an architectural term that means to renovate. It implies tearing down what is not working for you and building up what works. When you don't understand that, you are left to believe that whatever life has handed you is just the way it is, and you have to take it. You would be surprised at the number of people who go to Church every week just to get a word to help them survive. They sing about faith and talk about it, even some parents give their children the name "Faith". But when you ask them, how are you doing? They will say "I am just hanging on. I am just hoping I can make it through". Yes, there are times when that will truly be the case, but that should be the exception, not the rule. The Bible says, *"No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us"* (Rom. 8:37 NIV). To conquer means to fight a battle and win it. But to be more than a conqueror means to win a battle without even having to fight it. Jesus Christ has already fought same power to become more than a conqueror. *"I have given you authority to trample on snakes and scorpions and to overcome all the powers of the enemy, nothing will harm you"* (Luke 10:19 NIV).

LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

You may ask, how do I get this power? Jude 1:20 says we can access the power by building yourselves in your most holy faith and praying in the Holy Spirit. And you can do it anywhere, in your car, on the way to work, on your treadmill, even in your bathroom. You just need a place where you can be alone with God, praying and reading His words building up your faith. When bad news comes don't allow it to panic you and cause you to act in haste. Stop, think rationally and get the facts before you arrive at a conclusion or make a decision. Prayerfully ask, Lord what can I do about this situation? If you can do it for yourself, God won't do it for you. The poet said, His part we cannot do, our part He will not do. Faced with a well-armed, vastly superior force there was nothing Hezekiah could do to save himself. So he went to the house of God and spread out his need before the Lord (2 Kings 19:14). That's always a wise move. When you respond in faith, a crisis becomes an opportunity for God to demonstrate what He can do on your behalf. The truth is, when you have nothing left, God have got enough! Even to handle the situation, enough to get through it and enough to bounce back. Ask yourself, is this problem really mine? Yes, we are supposed to bear one another's burdens (Gal. 6:2). But you are not supposed to let everybody dump their problems on you. Sometimes in our eagerness to rescue others we get in God's way when He is dealing with them. And stop listening to round-the-clock news, if you do you'll begin to think negatives. Things are bad everywhere. But what has God said about you and your situation? *"I will never leave you nor forsake you"*.

Search your scriptures and discover His promises for every situation. God doesn't respond to your need, He responds to your faith. Discover what He has said, then stand on it.

Life is Faith ... Express It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Lack of faith and trust in God always prevents us from receiving His best.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 2. Faith is like taking the first step, even when you don't see the full staircase.
... Martin Luther King Jr.
 3. God's glorious grace says; throw the guilt and anxiety overboard - draw the anchor - trim the sails, man the rudder - a strong gale of my spirit is coming.
... Charles R. Swindoll
 4. The highest purpose of faith is not to change your circumstances but to change you.
... Eckobig Anthony
 5. Faith without work is dead.
... James 2:7
 6. I know that God is faithful. I know that he answers prayers, many times in ways I may not understand.
... Sheila Walsh
 7. Pray and let God worry.
... Martin Luther
 8. Faith enables us to be persuaded of his promises and embrace them regardless of our trials and difficulties.
... Eckobig Anthony
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LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

9. Faith is the element which transforms the ordinary vibration of thought, created by the finite mind of a man into spiritual equivalent.
... Unknown
10. Faith has to be exercised in the midst of ordinary down to earth living.
... Elisabeth Elliot.
11. Do not let lack of faith keep you from giving freely and generously.
... Eckobig Anthony.
12. Chaff is a symbol of a faithless life that drifts along without direction; good grain is a symbol of a faithful life that can be used by God. Unlike grains we can choose the direction we will take.
...Psalm 1:4.
13. Don't pray when it rains, if you don't pray when the sun shines.
... Unknown.
14. To pray effectively, you need faith in God, not faith in the object of your request. If you focus only on your request, you will be left with nothing if your request is refused.
... Unknown.
15. The power that ushers us into the world of possibilities is the power of prayer.
... Eckobig Anthony.

LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

16. Prayer instigates and builds your faith to operate in the world of possibilities.
... Unknown.
17. Faith is the only agency through which the comic forces of infinite intelligence can be harnessed and used by man.
... Unknown.
18. Faith is the basis of miracles and all mysteries which cannot be analysed by the rule of science.
... Unknown
19. Faith in God and the promises in his word is an antidote to overcome failure.
... Eckobig Anthony.
20. Faith is the starting point of all accumulation of riches.
... Unknown.
21. Faith is the eternal elixir which gives life, courage, power and action to impulse of thought.
... Unknown.
22. A mind dominated by positive emotions becomes a favourable abode for the state of mind known as faith.
... Unknown.
23. Your belief or faith is the element which determines the actions of your subconscious mind.
... Unknown.

LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

24. Faith means you want God and want to want nothing else, in faith there is movement and development, each day something is new.
... *Brennan Manning.*
25. True faith transforms our conduct as well as our thought.
... *Eckobig Anthony*
26. Faith is the ability to believe long and far into the misty future. It is simply taking God at His word and taking the next step.
... *Joni Eareckson Tada*
27. Faith is weakness leaning on omnipotence.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
28. Prayer is weakness leaning on omnipotence
... *Correnten Boom*
29. Genuine self-acceptance is not derived from the power of positive thinking, mind games or pop psychology. It is an act of faith in the grace of God alone.
... *Benjamin Manning*
30. True faith always results in a changed life and good works.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
31. Faith goes up the stairs that love has made and looks out of the window which hope has opened.
... *Charles H. Spurgeon.*

LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

32. The most extraordinary thing about an oyster is this; irritation gets into his shell; and when it cannot get rid of them, it uses the irritation to do the loveliest thing an oyster ever has the chance to do. If there are irritations in our lives today, there is only one prescription, make a pearl! It may have to be a pearl of patience, but anyhow, make a pearl. And it takes faith and love to do it.
... *Harry Emerson Fosdick.*
33. True faith involves a commitment of your whole self to God.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
34. Pray often and in faith, for prayer is a shield to the soul and a sacrifice to God and a scourge to satan.
... *Unknown.*
35. God wants us to lay our burdens on him and rest on his love. It is His responsibility to work out His purpose and plan in our hardships. Only our refusal to trust Him can hinder His purpose in our lives.
... *Joni Eareckson Tada.*
36. Delicate threads of hope, patiently woven, become the strong fabric of our faith.
... *Janet Weaver Smith.*
37. Faith is a mind-set that expects God to act, when we act upon this expectation, we can overcome our fears.
... *Unknown*
38. Always advertise your faith in the showroom of life challenge and adversity.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
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LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

39. Optimism is the faith that leads to achievement. Nothing can be done without hope and confidence.
... *Helen Keller.*
40. Faith must be located in the context of time.
... *Ven. Okey Ifionu.*
41. Spirituality is not one compartment or sphere of life. Rather it is a lifestyle. The process of life lived with the vision of faith.
... *Unknown.*
42. If you want extraordinary miracles, you must have extraordinary faith, faith that is tied to the power of God will be honoured.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
43. Faith in God gives Christians the absolute confidence that He is working for good in our lives even when all the evidence and emotions points to what is bad in our lives.
... *Leith Anderson.*
44. An untried faith is fear based, like a vapour it can easily vanish.
... *Unknown*
45. Faith is not believing that God can do it, it is believing that God will do it; in fact that God has done it.
... *Ven. Okey Ifionu*
46. Real faith never says die, instead it echoes loud and clear "I'm alive".
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
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LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

47. Faith is believing and trusting in Jesus Christ, reaching out to accept his wonderful gift of salvation.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*

LIFE IS FAITH ... EXPRESS IT!

08

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

Every birth is a miracle, and every child is a gift from God. But nearly 20 centuries ago, the miracle of miracles occurred. A baby was born, but He was the son of God.

The gospels tell of His birth, but Dr. Luke (Bible book of Luke). As though he was there as the attending physician, provided most of the details surrounding this awesome occasion. With a divine father and human mother, Jesus Christ entered history - God in the flesh. Wrinkled face, tiny hands with fingernail chips, folds on new skin and miniature eyes, a nose, and mouth - she's a new-born. After months of formation, she burst forth into the world and into her family. "She has her mother's eyes". I can sure tell who her parents are. Now that's your nose. Relatives and friends gaze into the little life face and see her mom and dad. Mother and father rejoice in their daughter, a miracle, a new member of the family. A loving parent, they will feed, protect, nurture, guide, and discipline her. This is their duty and joy.

God too has children - man and women who He has chosen as His very own. There have always been individuals marked as His, but with Abraham He promised to build a nation. Israel was to be God's country, and her people, the Jews, His very own sons and daughters. Down through the countries, God meted out discipline and punishments, but always with love

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

and mercy. God, the eternal father, protected, and cared for His children.

To overcome the fear of acceptability you must:

1. **Understand who you are:** You are fearfully and wonderfully made (*Psalm 139:14*). Made in his own image. God didn't assign your creation to His most powerful angels. You are a hands-on, made-to-order, one of a kind product. As a redeemed child of God you are His handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do. (*Eph 2:10*) believe that and stand on it regardless of your feelings and social status.
2. **Understand who God is:** He calls Himself your Heavenly Father, not just yet creator and designer. Your creator and designer refers to what He does; your father refers to who He is. He will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty Cod, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. (*Isaiah 9:6 NIV*). These are not his roles, they are His proper names. They are capitalised in scripture because they are what you are to call Him. When Jesus taught us to pray in scriptures, he didn't begin with "*O, Omnipotent, Omnipresent, Omniscient God.*"

Yes, He is all of this, but when it comes to us, he wants to be recognized as father. This then is how you should pray " Our father in heaven, hallowed be your name (Matthew 6:9 NIV). That is how he thinks about us, and wants us to think and feel towards Him. Father is meant to convey warmth, security, acceptance, concern, compassion, protection, provision, etc. He is your father. When you grab the truth of that you will begin to overcome the fear of acceptance. Overcoming the fear of acceptance requires understanding God's commitment to you. His fatherhood isn't based on sentiment, emotion and mood; it

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

is based on His unchanging character and reputation. Everything He is and claims to be, stands or falls apart depending on His faithfulness to you. For the sake of his great name the Lord will not reject his people, because the Lord was pleased to make you His own (1 Samuel 12:22). Notice two things in this scripture: concern for His good name, and the pleasure He takes in being your father, are why he will never turn His back on you. Your problems don't mean that God is judging or disowning you. Satan would love to have you believe that, he will tell you that you've failed God or that God has failed you in order to make you feel hopeless and unworthy before God and abandoned.

No, generations of believers have sung their souls dark night, great is thy faithfulness, O God, my father. In your circumstances and suffering, God's loyal love couldn't have tan out, His merciful love couldn't have dried up. *"Because of the Lords great love, we are not consumed, for his compassion never fail, they are new every morning, great is your faithfulness"* (Lamentation 3:23 NIV). Suffering and adversity don't cancel His faithfulness. *"He is the same yesterday, today and forever"* (Heb 13:8 NKJV). He can't love you once and not love you always.

"After you suffer for a short time, His who gives all grace, will make everything right, he will make you strong and support you and keep you from falling." (1 Peter 5:10) Declare and say to yourself, *"Nothing can ever separate me from God's love"* (Romans 8:38).

There was a blind lady who hated herself because she was born blind. She hated everyone except her loving fiancé. He was always there for her she told her fiancé "if I could only see the world, will you marry me?"

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

One day someone donated a pair of eyes to her, when the bandages came off, she was able to see everything, including her fiancé. He asked her, Now that you can see the world, will you marry me? The lady looked at her fiancé that he was blind. The sight of his closed eyes shocked her. She hadn't expected that. The thought of looking at them the rest of her life led her to refuse to marry him. Her fiancé left her in tears and days later wrote a note to her saying, take good care of your eyes, my dear, before they were yours, they were mine. This is how the human reasoning works when our status changes. Only a very few remember what life was like before, and who was always by their side in the midst of the pain full situation. Please realize that life is a gift. Before you say an unkind word, think of someone who cannot speak. Before you complain about the taste of food, think of someone has had nothing to eat, before you complain about your husband or wife, think of someone who is crying out to God for a companion. Before you complain about your life, think of someone who just died send Leon this said. Before you complain about your children think of someone who is without a child. Before you argue about your dirty house that someone didn't clean or sweep, think of people who are living on the streets. Before you complain about the distance you drive to work, think of someone without a car or walk the same distance with their feet. And when you are tired and complain about your job, think of the unemployed, the disabled, who also wish they had your job. ***"If anyone speaks, they should do as one who speaks the very words of God"*** (1 Peter 4:11 NIV). When God gives you an assignment, he gives you all that is needed to fulfill it. Winston Churchill said, to each there comes in his or her lifetime a special moment when they are tapped on the shoulder and offered the chance to do a very special thing, unique to them and fitted to their talent. What a tragedy if that moment find

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

them unprepared or unqualified for that which could have been their finest hour. You can't always be what you want to be. That is because He assigns and directs us each according to one's own ability. (Matt. 25:15). What do you love doing and do consistently well? Is music your forte?, Crunching numbers?, Working with kids? Paul says, "*The spirit of giving each of us special way of serving*" (1 Corinthians 12:7).

That means some of the things other people find boring, will actually energise and enrich you. The bible says "*that God is building a spiritual house*" (1 Peter 2:5). And there is a place for each of us in it. Knowing this dispels misconception that you are not valuable because you don't have the same talents others do. It also defines your actual responsibility by doing away with the myth that you are suppose to do everything. No, your goal should be stay within the boundaries of God's plan for you. So instead of apologising for the skills you don't have, discover the gifts God has given you and put them to work for His kingdom.

There is a lesson here: people develop at different rates. Your words create an environment in which people not only discover their gifts but also develop and excel in them. Let's tell our young people that the best books are yet to be written, the best paintings have not yet been painted, the best governments are yet to be formed, the best is yet to be done by them. Within every human being there is a God-given drive to achieve something. If you can tap into that drive and demonstrate that you believe in their future, they will do almost anything to live up to true Christian character is a willingness to be encouraging and lift people. So, in dealing with others, are you problem - focused or possibility focused.

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

Understand this: God uses the encouraging words, actions and attitudes we direct at each other to strengthen our inner resolve to succeed. But to be effective, your praise should be immediate, specific and genuine. Ask yourself, what would I attempt, if I weren't afraid of failing? Jesus Christ told of a man who entrusted his business to three key workers. He gave the first one five talents, the second person two talents and the third person one talent. In the bible time, one talent was about fifteen year's salary.

So you begin to grasp what an opportunity this was. It was a defining moment which gave each of them the chance to test their skills, develop initiative practice good judgment and profit from theirs. But the third was afraid of falling, so he went and buried his talent. Jesus Christ describes this man as "WICKED" and said his talent should be taken from him and given to the man who uses his profitable. He wasn't judged for what he did, he was judged for doing nothing. Fear of people, fear of failure and fear of rejection can tempt you to bury your gifts. Don't do it, unless you have the courage to start - You are already finished. When God called people like Moses, Gideon, Deborah and Esther, all have to overcome their natural fears. So will you. When they were in the wilderness fear of lack made the Israelites want to go back to Egyptian slavery. Fear of persecution caused Peter to deny Jesus Christ three times. Refuse to let fear stop you. How you use your talents and gift is a matter of the uttermost importance. The truth is, it is the basis upon which God will finally judge and reward you. Discover the gifts that God has given you and put them to work for His kingdom.

Life is a gift ... Accept it!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Time indeed is a sacred gift, and each day is a little life.
... *Sir John Lubbock.*
2. Heavenly father thank you for the opportunity to laugh.
Help me to find joy in everything that I do. Let me laugh
and be cheerful, so that those around me will be blessed
by my smile and my optimism amen.
... *Kim Boyce.*
3. Embrace your uniqueness; time is too short to be living
someone else's life.
...*Kobi Yamada.*
4. Giving is a gift from God, and a serious rewarding
business because givers never lack.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
5. Nobody is born a genius; rather genius is born out of a
person.
... *Unknown.*
6. A man is literally what he thinks.
... *James Allen.*
7. Time does not have the same appeal for everyone.
... *Williams Shakespeare.*
8. Forest burn down are able to grow back and broken bone
heal.
... *Unknown*

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

9. Patience is the best remedy for every trouble.
... Titus Platus
10. There is a very little difference in people but that little difference makes a big difference. The little difference is attitude; the big difference is whether is positive or negative.
... Unknown
11. You have made me known the path of life; you will fill me with joy in your presence, with eternal pleasures at your hand.
... Psalm 16:11
12. Accept yourself as you are right now, an imperfect, changing, growing and worthy person.
... Denis Waitley.
13. Grace is giving of God, but knowledge is bought in the market.
... Arthur Clough.
14. You've got to get up every morning with determination if you are going to go to bed with satisfaction.
... George Horace Horimer.
15. Each of us is a statistical impossibility around which hover a million other lives that were never destined to be born.
... Loren Eiseley

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

16. When life appears certain and controllable don't let pride make you too comfortable or God may allow adversity to drive you back to himself.
... Eckobig Anthony
 17. Try to despise nothing except selfishness, meanness and corruption, to fear nothing but cowardice, disloyalty and indifference, to covet nothing that is your neighbours, except his kindness of heart, and gentleness of the spirit.
... Anonymous.
 18. A person who has everything on earth, can still lack the most important thing; eternal life.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 19. Every person has a path to greatness, as our destiny is difference, so is our path to greatness.
.... Eckobig Anthony
 20. Anything in life worth having is worth working for.
... Unknown
 21. If you believe what you like in the gospel, and reject what you don't like, it is not the gospel you believe but yourself.
... St. Augustine of Hippo
 22. The person you see always is the person you will become.
... Unknown
 23. The world's most seductive attractions are only cheap substitutes for what God has to offer.
... Eckobig Anthony
-

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

24. Each day comes bearing its own gifts, untie the ribbons.
... *Ruth Ann Schumacher*
25. Your friends will stretch your vision or choke your dreams.
... *Napoleon Hill*
26. Human nature is created so that you choose your destiny and controls it.
... *Anthony Robbins*
27. What lies behind you is history and what lies before you is future.
... *Unknown*
28. There is only one hand that can lift you and sustain you at the top. That hand is called the Everlasting hands.
... *Eckobig Anthony*
29. Behind every disability, there are unlimited abilities.
... *Unknown*
30. If you feel wounded and torn by the events of your life, turn to God so He can heal and comfort you.
... *Eckobig Anthony*
31. Most times God will roast you before He will rest you.
... *Unknown*
32. Wealth commands authority but only good health can enjoy wealth.
... *Cindy Vdome*
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LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

33. Your gifts were designed by God to build others up. Only when you use them for that purpose will you find fulfillment.

... Eckobig Anthony

34. This new day brings another year renewing hope, dispelling care. And may we find before the end, a deep content, another friend.

... Arch Ward

35. God loves to look at us and loves it when we will look back at Him. Even when we try to run away from our troubles, God will fund us, bless us, even when we feel most alone, unsure, God will find a way to let us know that He is with us in those place, wherever we are.

... Kathleen Norris

36. More and more I realize that everybody, regardless of age needs to be hugged and comforted in a brotherly or sisterly way now and then, preferably now.

... Jane Howard

37. The creator thinks of you to have sent someone very special so that you might have life- abundantly, joyfully, completely and victoriously.

... Unknown

38. God has given us two hands – one to receive with and the other to give with. We are not cisterns made for hoarding. We are channels made for sharing.

... Billy Graham

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

39. Every time I begin to feel that any more strength in me, I end up knowing that there is more in him.
... *Gloria Gaither*
40. There are moments when one hearts nearly burst within us for the sheer joy of being alive. The first sight of our newborn babies, the warmth of love in another's eyes, the fresh scent of rain on a hot summer's eve – moments like these renew in us a heartfelt appreciation for life.
... *Gwen Weising*
41. Since He did not spare even his own son for us but gave Him up for us all, won't He also surely give us everything else?
... *Romans 8:32*
42. The Christian life is that our hearts might be restored and set free. That's the deal, that's what Jesus came to do, by His own announcement, Jesus wants life for us.
... *John Eldridge.*
43. Blessed be the Lord, who daily loadeth us with benefits, even the God of our salvation.
... *Psalm 68:19.*
44. A friend understands what you are trying to say, even when your thoughts aren't fitting into words.
... *Ann D. Parrish*
45. Good humour is a tonic for mind and body. It is the best antidote for anxiety and depression. It is a business asset. It attracts and keep friends. It lightens human burdens. It is direct route to serenity and contentment.
... *Greenville Buechner*
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LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

46. The grace of God, there is only one catch like any other gift, the grace can be yours only if you'll reach out and take it. Maybe being able to reach out and take it is a gift too.

... *Fredrick Buechner.*

47. What God sends is better than what we ask for, because He knows what we need, not what we want.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

48. I am leaving you with a gift- peace of mind and heart! And the peace I give isn't fragile like the peace the world gives. So don't be troubled or afraid.

... *John 14:27*

49. If you can learn to laugh in spite of the circumstances that surrounds you, you will enrich others, enrich yourself and more than that, you will last.

... *Barbara Johnson*

50. An infinite God can give all of Himself to each of His children. He does not distribute Himself that each may have a part, but to each one He give all of Himself as fully as if there were no other.

... *A. W. Tozer*

51. Friends remind us we are part of something greater than ourselves, a larger world.

... *Barbara Jenkins*

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

52. The life we have been given can't be bargained for, it is a gift. Every good and perfect gift comes from above, coming down from the father of light in who there is no variation or shifting of shadows (*James 1:17*). If our day is indeed a gift from God, something from the giver should be evident within the gift.

... *Ken Gire.*

53. Memories, important yesterdays were once today. Treasure and notice today.

... *Gloria Gaither*

54. Time is a very precious gift of God, so precious that it's only given to us moment by moment.

... *Amelia Barr*

55. He Himself gives life and breathes to everything and satisfies every need there is.

... *Acts 17:25*

56. May the Lord continually bless you with Heaven's blessings as well as human joys.

... *Psalms 128:5*

57. For all of us, whether we walk old paths or blaze new trails, friends remains important.

... *Lois Wyse*

58. There is nourishment from being encouraged and held up by others when we are weak. We are nourish from feedback of friends whom we trust and who will be honest with us.

... *Rich G. Buhler*

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

59. Each of us is God's special work of art. Through us, He teaches and inspires, delights and encourages, informs and uplifts all those who view our lives.
... *Joni Eareckson Tada*
60. My friends have made the story of my life in a thousand ways, they have turned my limitations into beautiful privileges and enabled me to walk serene and happy.
... *Helen Keller*
61. Lord give me the gift of faith to be renewed and shared with others each day. Teach me to live this moment only, looking neither to the past with regret nor the future with apprehension. Let love be my aim and my life a prayer.
... *Roseann Alexander - Isham*
62. God created us as human beings with the need for intimacy to know and be known. And His perfect plan is to provide us with a beautiful way to meet that need. Fellowship with Him and with each other.
... *Jack Frost*
63. All the absurd little meetings, decisions and skirmishes that go to make up our days. It all adds up to very little, and yet all adds up to very much. Our days are full of nonsense and yet not, because it is precisely into the nonsense of our days that God speak to us words of great significance.
... *Frederick Buechner*

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

64. Grace comes free of charge to people who do not deserve it and I am one of those people. Now I am trying in my own small way to pipe the time of grace. I do so because I know more, more surely than I know. Any types of healing or forgiveness or goodness I have ever felt comes from solely the grace of God.

... *Philip Yancey*

65. You have made known to me the paths of life, you will fill me with joy in your presence.

... *Acts 2:28*

66. You are valuable just because you exist, not because of what you do or what you have done, but simply because you are.

... *Max Lucado*

67. A living, loving God can and does make His presence felt, can and does speak to us in the silence of our hearts, can and does warm and caress us till we no longer doubt that He is near, that He is here.

... *Brennam Manning*

68. Grace tells us that we are accepted just as we are. We may not be the kind of people we want to be, we may be a long way from our goals, we may have more failures than achievements, we may not be wealthy or powerful or spiritual, we may not even be happy, but we are nonetheless accepted by God, held in His hands.

... *McCullough*

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

69. Gratitude is not something we do, rather it is a medium of grace, a gift of God that softens the heart and enables it to see and hear and receive the things that come to it from God.

... *Roberta Bondi.*

70. To be grateful is to recognise the love of God in everything He has given us and He has given us everything, every breath we draw is a gift of His love, every moment of existence is a gift of grace, for it brings with immense grace from Him.

... *Thomas Merton.*

71. There is no enough darkness in all the world to put out the light of one small candle ... Any reminder of something deeply felt or dearly loved. No one is so poor as not to have many of these small candles. When they are lighted, darkness goes away and a touch of wonders remains.

... *Arthur Gordon*

72. Only God gives true peace. A quite gift He sets within just when we think we have exhausted our search for it.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

73. Every good and perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of the Heavenly lights, who does not change like shifting shadows.

... *James 1:17*

74. Instead of a gem, or even a flower, we should cast the gift of a loving thought into the heart of a friend, that would be giving as the Angels give.

... *George Macdonald*

LIFE IS A GIFT ... ACCEPT IT!

75. Give generously, for your gifts will return to you later.
... *Ecclesiastes 11:1*
76. The secret of life is that all we have and are is a gift of
grace to be shared.
... *Lloyd John Ogilvie*
77. God's care for us is more watchful and more tender than
the care of any human father could possibly be.
... *Hannah Whithall Smith*
78. World's most seductive attractions are only cheap
substitute for what God has to offer.
... *Eckobig Anthony*

09

LIFE IS A GAME ... PLAY IT!

The shrill whistle pierces the air and all the action on the court abruptly stops. Pointing to the offending player, the referee shouts "FOUL". Rules, fouls and penalties are part of any game and are regulated and enforced vigorously by referees, umpires, judges and other officials. Every participant knows that boundaries must be set and behaviour monitored, or the game will degenerate into chaos. The world also has laws boundaries and rules for living established by God. But men and women regularly flaunt these regulations, hiding their infractions or overpowering others and declaring that might make right. God calls this sin-willful disobedience, rebellion against His control, or apathy. And at times it seems as though the violators succeed - no whistle blow, no fouls are called, and individual dictators rule. The truth is, however, that ultimately justice will be served in the world. God will settle all accounts. When a player begins to score, the opposing team assigns their best player to block him. So the attack you're experiencing right now could be an indication of your value to God. Paul wrote, *I have had to struggle with friends, struggle with foes; I have been at risk in the city, at risk in the country, endangered by the desert sun and sea storm, and betrayed by those I thought were my brothers. I have known druggery and hard labour, many a long and lonely nights without sleep, many a missed meal, blasted by the cold and naked to the weather.* (2Corinthians 11:26-27). Regardless of when or why you stumbled, God wants to pick you up and put you back on your feet. People who never experienced

LIFE IS A GAME ... PLAY IT!

failure usually don't accomplish much, there is a certain security in playing it safe, nothing is lost, but nothing is won. They never get out of the boat to walk on the water. Wouldn't it be better to be almost drown and have to be saved, than never to experience God's power working through you? Eckobig Anthony says: "Life is like a football game, we are the football. Never mind the kicks from the players because without their kicks we may not reach the goal post".

Also adversity is like yeast, when the heat is turned up, it rises, and the hotter it gets the more it rises. The truth is that every opportunity God gives you will come with obstacles, and you will have to rise above them. Look at the children of Israel in Egypt, the more they are afflicted, the more they multiply and grow. (Exodus 1:12). Often the bad times do more to strengthen your faith than the good ones. The most secure place in the world is in the will of God. If you align your plan with His purpose, ultimately you will win and there is nothing they can do to stop you, *"I will instruct you and teach you in the way you should go, I will counsel you with my loving eye on you"* (Psalm 32:8 NIV).

Dr John Maxwell points out that in order to thrive in uncertain territories you must be able to do the following things:

- 1) Understand your certainty quotient; think back to your last big decision that you got right. How certain were you? Eighty percent? Fifty percent? If your best decisions are usually made at the seven to five percent, that is your certainty quotient. When you reach the point. It's time to stop debating and start moving.

LIFE IS A GAME ... PLAY IT!

- 2) *Express your uncertainty with confidence. Never look at successful people and assume that single-handedly and with no hesitation, they fearlessly navigate the currents of uncertainty. No, they just understood that with each step, answers would be given. So instead of pretending to know more than you do; begins to encourage a culture of transparency the fosters the free exchange of ideas. When you don't know, just say" I don't know, but I'll try to find out".*
- 3) Consult others. King Solomon wrote more about seeking counsel than any other writer in the Bible. Do kings need good input? Yes absolutely! And only those with the humility to acknowledge it ever prospers.
- 4) Measure your success by the scoreboard, not the playbook. Every good coach goes into the pitch with a plan, but buddy he is willing to change it in order to win use pencil in your plans, but write your vision in ink! Good leaders, like good coaches, are often forced to, abandon amend some of their plans in order to deliver on the vision. The ones who do are the ones who reach their destination. Playing safe does not score the goal, but playing well!

Live is a game ... Play it!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Courage is when know you've licked before you begin but you begin anyway and you see it through no matter what.

... Harper Lee.

LIFE IS A GAME ... PLAY IT!

2. When you say yes to others, make sure you are not saying no to yourself.

... Eckobig Anthony

3. The mind in its own place and in itself can make a heaven of hell or hell of heaven.

...John Milton.

4. Life is a grindstone, whether it grinds us down or polishes us depends on us.

... Thomas Holdcraft.

5. One of the main weakness of mankind is the average man's familiarity with the word impossible. He knows all the rules which will not work and all the things which cannot be done.

... Unknown.

6. Battles are guns sent to fire you to the top, but your attitude is the bullet in that gun.

... Unknown.

7. Life does not play hide and seek to those who know what they want out of it, they go for it and never settle for the less, they are champions and not mediocres.

... Unknown.

8. What happens in your life is determined by who you live with, who you keep company with, where you spend your time and what you feed into your mind.

... Myles Munreo.

LIFE IS A GAME ... PLAY IT!

9. God does not play hide and seek with anyone, if we seek him by reading the bible through prayer, we shall certainly find him. Faith rests on assurance.
... *Eckobig Anthony*.
 10. Those who stand for nothing fall for anything.
... *Alexander Hamilton*.
 11. All I know is that I know nothing
.... *Socrates*.
 12. Don't show me what your priorities are, show me where you spend your money.
...*James Frick*.
 13. When you think and act like somebody else you may likely end up a nobody, but if you think like no one else you become somebody.
... *Eckobig Anthony*.
 14. The remarkable truth is that our choices matters, not just to us and our own destiny but amazingly to God himself and the universe he rules.
... *Philip Yancey*.
 15. When darkness seems to hide his face, I rest on his unchanging grace.
... *Unknown*.
 16. Life is like a football game, we are the football! Never mind the kicks of people, because without their kicks we may not reach the goal.
... *Eckobig Anthony*.
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LIFE IS A GAME ... PLAY IT!

17. Parents have a choice: to raise children who will make them proud or ruin their peace.

... Ven. Okey Ifionu

10

LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

What's a success? Most definitions include references to achieving goals and acquiring wealth, prestige, favour and power. "Successful" people enjoy the good life - being financially and emotionally secure, being surrounded by admirers and enjoying the fruits of their labours. They are leaders, opinion makers and trend setters. Their example is emulated, their accomplishments are notice. They know who they are and where they going. And they stride continually to meet their goals.

Every person dream to make plans for the future. Then they work hard to those dreams and plans to come true. But to make the most of life, we must include God's plan in our plans. He alone knows what is best for us, He alone can fulfil purpose for us. As you make plans and dream dreams, talk with God about them. Successful people allow their giving-passion and talent to guide them in life. They have a single focus and undivided heart. God doesn't create you to be talented in one area, then ask you to give yourself to some unrelated area. There is always a potential alignment of talent and passion, if you have the courage to pursue your life's purpose and take risks.

P. O. Branson, author of **"What I should do with my life?"** writes, I am convinced that business success in the future starts with the question, "what should I do with my life?" Yes, that's right, people don't succeed by migrating to a "hot" industry or

LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

by adopting a particular career-guiding mantra. They thrive by focusing on the question of who they really are and connecting to work they truly love." And instead doing, unleashing a productive and creative power they never imagined.

Carly Fiorina said: *"love what you do, or don't do it. Make the choice to do something because it engages your heart as well as your mind."*

Don't become a slave to someone else's dream because once you own a dream, that dream will own you. Being a slave to someone else's dream quickly becomes a nightmare. Paul said; *"we do not dare to classify or compare ourselves with some who commend themselves. When they measure themselves by themselves and compare themselves with themselves, they are not wise. We, however, will not boast beyond proper limits, but will confine our boasting to the sphere of service God Himself has assigned to us, a sphere that also includes you (2 Corinthians 10:12-13 NIV).* If you are confused, out of focus or going in circles pray, Lord gives me a clear vision and an undivided heart. That is a prayer God will answer, when you want to achieve your goals. (Mark 1:15 NIV). *"The time has come", he said "the kingdom of God has come near!"*

The Bible says above, after John was put in prison, Jesus Christ went in to Galilee, proclaiming ...*"The kingdom of God has come"*. The average preacher takes three years to prepare for a ministry that will last thirty years or so. Jesus Christ did the reverse. He took thirty years to prepare for a ministry that will last just over three years. What's the point? The quality of your preparation determines the quality of your performance. The world's greatest pianist invests hundreds of hours to practice before a concert. That is because they know those grueling hours of preparation will allow them to give their best

LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

performance. World champions boxers don't become champions in the ring, they are merely recognize in the ring. Their becoming is as a result of their daily routine. Something important is happening at each stage of your development. For example, God can introduce you to someone today who will play a major role in your life twenty or thirty years from now. If you are in a hurry you may not stop long enough to connect with them. Think what a loss that would be. Waiting also reveals the weakness in your plans. Haven't you looked back and said, "Thank you Lord, for saving me from that! Each chapter and season of your life has the benefit and a product if only-you will look for it. Before Jesus Christ launched His ministry, we read, "*Jesus Christ increased in wisdom and stature, and in favour with God and man* (Luke 2:52). Jesus Christ understood the value of timing and training. He was willing to wait and prepare himself. You too must wait!

One of the great theme of the Bible is perseverance. Apostle Paul who refused to quit, wrote: "*let us not to grow weary while doing good, for in due season we shall reap if we do not lose heart,* (Galatians 6:9). Ralph Waldo Emerson said, "The great majority of men are bundles of beginnings. Are you merely a starter, or are you also a finisher? When the enthusiasm for a new idea fades, when the odds against you increase and the results diminish, when it looks as if success is impossible, you must keep forging ahead. Quitting is more about who you are, then where you are or what you are up against. We all have our excuses. The truth is, external things don't stop us. It's what happens to us on the inside! Most of us stop ourselves from reaching our potential, we can pretend that people, things and situations outside of ourselves are to blame, but in reality most failures are just the results of a lack of bulldog- like tenacity. Leonardo Da Vinci said; "*Obstacles cannot crush me*". Every

LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

obstacle yields to stern resolved. He who is fixed on a star, does not change his mind. You must have a mindset to tenaciously pursue your goal. The only guarantee for failure is to stop trying. There is no insurmountable barrier, except your inherent lack of purpose and persistence. After speaking about being shipwrecked, stoned, imprisoned, betrayed, hungry, thirsty, sleepless, cold, and naked, Paul, who was resolute in his purpose and relentless in the pursuit of it, writes; "*who is weak and I do not feel weak ...*" (2 Corinthians 11:29 NIV). Where does this kind of strength and tenacity come from? God! The assignment God gives you will never be greater than the grace He provides. So draw on His strength, keep pressing ahead, pursue your goal and you will prevail.

Life is a goal ... Achieve it!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Nothing great will ever be achieved without great men, and men are great only if they are determined to be so.
... Charles De Gaule.
2. Every great and commanding movement in the annals of the world is a triumph of enthusiasm. Nothing great was ever achieved without it.
... Ralph Waldo Emerson.
3. Your potentials will not be released until you take your thoughts, plans and imaginations and put them into action, you must work to mine your hidden potentials.
... Myles Munroe.

LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

4. Until your mind is set to achieve a thing in life, you would continue to wish for things instead of working for them.
... *Unknown.*
 5. Great achievers are people who are immune to fear, blind to the possibility of failure.
... *Unknown.*
 6. Most of the important things in the world have been accomplished by those who have kept on trying when there seemed to be no hope at all.
... *Dale Carnegie.*
 7. Discipline is the bridge between goals and accomplishment.
... *Jim Rohn.*
 8. Obstacles are those frightful things you see when you take your eyes off your goals.
... *Thomas Edison.*
 9. Things turn out best for the people who make the best of the way things turn out.
... *Art Linkletter*
 10. Desire is the starting point of all achievements, the first step towards riches.
... *Unknown.*
 11. Always aspire to acquire the desire you admire, do not retire but re-fire even when people conspire because you have a messiah who will make their conspiracy against you to expire. To be effective always be selective.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
-

LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

12. Obstacles at the stepping stones for the strong and are the stumbling blocks for the weak when pursuing life's goals.
... *Unknown*.
13. No one is ready for a thing until he believes you can acquire it.
... *Unknown*.
14. Failures do what is tension-relieving why winners do what is goal-achieving.
... *Unknown*.
15. Whatever the mind of a man can conceive and believe it can be achieved.
... *Unknown*.
16. To achieve anything worthwhile, we must have God's word (the bible) always in our hearts and meditate on it daily.
... *Eckobig Anthony*.
17. The height of your accomplishment will equal the depth of your convictions.
... *William Scolayino*.
18. There is something for you to start that is destined for you to finish.
... *Myles Monroe*.
19. In life, to achieve the incredible, unbelievable, unimaginable, one has to attempt the impossible.
... *Eckobig Anthony*.

LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

20. Willingness creates the ability to accomplish great things.
... *Unknown.*
21. A burning desire can generate the drive to action that is imperative for great achievement when combined with a positive mental attitude.
... *Unknown.*
22. Planning for the future is the process of breaking down your dreams into achievable goals.
... *Unknown.*
23. Planning is bringing the future into the present so that you can do something about it now.
... *Unknown.*
24. One sound idea is all that one needs to achieve great success.
... *Unknown*
25. Don't worry about everybody else, the whole world is full of everybody else, you know that! But only if you make a significant achievement.
... *Ben Carson's Mum*
26. With a new understanding we shall find honorable ways to accomplish our desires.
... *Unknown*
27. A person's greatest accomplishment may well be helping others accomplish great things. Likewise a person's greatest failure may be preventing others from achieving greatness.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
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LIFE IS A GOAL ... ACHIEVE IT!

28. It is good to have goals, but goals can disappoint us if we leave God out of them. There is no point making plans, as though God does not exist because the future is in his hands. If we put God's desire at the centre of our planning, he will never disappoint us.

... Anonymous

11

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

The vacuum produced when a strong leader departs can devastate a movement, organization - or- institution. Having been dependent on his or her skill, style and personality, associates and subordinates flounder or vie for control. Soon efficiency and vitality are lost, and decline and demise follow. Often this pattern is repeated in churches. A great speaker or teacher gathers a following, and effective. Lives are being changed and people led into the Kingdom. But when this person leaves all dies, with him or her goes the drive and heart- the organization. People flocked to hear Paul's teaching. Educated, articulate, motivated, and filled with the Holy Spirit, this man of God faithfully proclaimed the good news throughout the Roman Empire; lives were changed and churches begun. But Paul knew that the church must be built on Christ, not on a person. And he knew that eventually he would not be there to build, and encourage discipline, and teach. So he trained young pastors to assume leadership in the churches after he is gone. Paul urged them to center their lives and preaching on the word of God. (*2 Timothy 3:16,17*) and to train others to carry on the ministry (*2 Timothy 2:2*).

Joshua had already tasted the joys of the promise land. But now he had to go back and wait until Moses died and every doubter in Israel was buried. (*Joshua 1:2*). "Moses my servant is dead. Now then, you and all these people, get ready to cross

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

the Jordan river into the land am about to give them - to the Israelites.

Observe two lessons in this journey of the Israelites to the promise land which we can apply in our daily lives:

1. Some of our old ways must die before we move forward, onward and upward into our promise land in the journey of life. Moses represented the past. It was good for then not now when you align yourself with what was (the past), instead of what is (present realities), you are not ready. In the former, there are still too many folks you need to impress, you are so bound by certain philosophies that when God says it is time to move, you are inclined towards consulting those around you. When God told Joshua, "*Moses my servant is dead, Arise go over this Jordan, you and all this people, to the land which I am giving to you.*" There was only one correct response. "*Yes Lord.*" You should honour the past, but not get stuck in it. You should stand on already existing truths, but continually seek God for fresh instructions and insight if you are to reach you destiny.
2. Your doubts must be buried, only two out of the twelve spies who went to survey the promise land believed in God's' capacity to give it to them. The other ten saw giants, caved in to doubts, died and were buried in the wilderness. In like manner, every doubt that is holding you back has got to be eliminated in order to ensure that you complete your journey in life into your destiny. Penciled down for elimination should be the voice of your low self-esteem, your childhood fears, your anxieties and inner destructive critic. Gather them up,

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

put them in a box, bury it, stand up tall and say, ashes to ashes, dust to dust. Before you can move ahead and complete your journey in life, you must understand and live by these principles.

When do the golden years begin? With your first grey hairs? When somebody says you remind them of their father instead of their brother? If you can still sleepdream. If you can still workplan. Take on new projects, make new friends, learn new skills, venture into a new ministry, take a short-term mission trip, volunteer for a worthy cause. Your golden years are not to be wasted, they are to be invested (*Psalms 71 vs 18-21*)

With God there is no generation gap. Then shall the virgin rejoice in the dance, both young men and old together (*Jeremiah 31:13*). They say young people are not interested in older people. Don't you believe it? Young people are looking for those with wisdom and experience. They trust them when it comes to counsel and guidance, and you can be such a person. Don't be like the old man who said it is hard to tell when your youth has been spent, because your get-up and go has got-up and went. Get up and go after it!

Caleb was climbing mountains and slaying giants in his last years and Caleb's God is your God. At hundred and twenty, Moses eyes were not dim and his strength were not gone (*Deut. 34:7*) and Moses God is your God. At seventy, Paul announced "that is why I am so eager to preach the gospel also to you who are at Rome." (*Romans 1:15 NIV*), and Paul's God is your God. Keep the torch burning brightly, then hand it on to the next runner before you go, "even to your old age and grey hairs, I am he, I am he who will sustain you ..." (*Isaiah 46:4 NIV*).

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

Growing old graciously should be one of your life goals. You don't need to fear ageing or try to gloss over your uneasiness about approaching it or attempt to cover up your anxiety. Mother Nature and Father Time may have brought you back aches, baldness and bifocals but you don't have to get old and you don't have to think old. Instead of trying to add years to your life, try adding life to your years, instead of resenting the fact that you are getting old, think how much you will resent being denied the privileged, when asked how he felt about turning eighty, president Eisenhower replied, it sure does beat the alternative. If you are still alive, God kept you around for a reason. Find out what it is. Then pour everyday and every ounce of energy you've left into it. You can be old at twenty-five and young at eighty-five. You are only old when you feel old, or feel like you know all there is to know, or find yourself saying "I'm too old to do that, or think that tomorrow holds no promise, or take no interest in the activities of youth or would rather talk than listen or long for the good old days feeling they were the best.

Sometimes we joke about getting older and say things like I'm thirty-nine and holding, meaning we don't want to turn forty and be considered old. As long as you have a dream in your heart you will never be old. The psalmist said; *I have been young, and now I'm old; yet have I not seen the righteous forsaken, nor his seed begging bread, (Psalm 37:25) "cast me not off in the time of old age ..."* (Psalm 71:9). The main fear about ageing is ending up lonely, needy and unwanted. As living costs go up and pensions go down its wonderful to be able to say, **my God shall supply all my needs in glory by Christ Jesus** (Phil. 4:19). Your golden years can be your greatest years of life. All the things you wanted to do when you didn't have the time is now available to you, I wish I have more time to read, now you can,

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

I wish I had more time to spend in prayers, now you can, so many things; travel, ministry, grandchildren, hobbies, visiting friends, now you have the time to enjoy them. (Job 5:26) speak of old men and women, full of years. You can die full of years. That word "**Full**" means filled to the brim and running over. How good is that? Senior Citizen, God said; Even to your old age, and grey hairs I will carry you, I am he, who will sustain you.

Life is a Journey ... Complete it!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Diversity is the key to longevity.
... Unknown.
2. Every person has a path to greatness, as our destiny is different so is our path to greatness.
... Eckobig Anthony.
3. What lies behind you is history and what lies before you is future.
... Unknown.
4. Where will you spend your eternity? This is a good point for you to pause and pray.
... Gbile Akanni.
5. Many of lives' failures are people who did not realize how close they were to success when they gave up.
... Thomas Edison.

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

6. What you call disappointment in life may actually be the appointed route to your destiny.
... Eckobig Anthony.
7. Life is a journey that we all must endure and experience, but it is a short lived one, so make every moment count.
... Unknown.
8. It is friction that provokes motion; it is problem that triggers progress.
... Unknown.
9. The law of autosuggestion will lift you up or pull you down according to the way you set your sail of thought.
... Unknown.
10. Success is the ability to go from one failure to another with no loss of enthusiasm.
... Winston Churchill.
11. Destiny is the force that generates passion and willingness in a man to stake his life for something in order to make an impact.
... Eckobig Anthony.
12. You will pass failure on your way to success.
... Mickey Rooney.
13. Do you wish to rise? Begin by descending, you plan a tower that will pierce the sky or the cloud, first lay the foundation of humility.
... Saint Augustine.

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

14. Your greatest glory lies buried hidden in your path of greatest affordable risk.
... Unknown
15. The path to greatness is along with others.
... Baltasar Gracion
16. Always remember where you are going and do all you can to make sure you get there.
... Unknown
17. The simple solution for disappointment and depression is get up and get moving, physically. Move, do, act, get going.
... Peter McWilliams.
18. Direction with speed leads to a destination, speed without direction leads to frustration.
... Eckobig Anthony ·
19. The world is round; the place which may seem like the end may only be just the beginning.
... Unknown
20. Look carefully at the closest association in your life, for that is the direction you are heading.
...Unknown.
21. When Jesus Christ takes the lead, even in an unpleasant circumstance, the end is usually blissful.
... Eckobig Anthony

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

22. Be reminded that the compass (direction) is more important in life than the clock (speed).

...*Unknown*

23. We are not citizens of this world trying to make our way to heaven; we are citizens of heaven trying to make our way through this world. We should live as those who are on a journey.

...*Landis Farne.*

24. The older I get, the more I feel like an exile, that I don't belong here. And I don't, I was made for heaven.

... *Fr. John Coradi.*

25. We live our lives in seasons, and seasons have beginning and endings.

... *Unknown.*

26. A journey with God has an endless hope; a journey without God has a hopeless end.

...*Eckobig Anthony.*

27. I have decided and have chosen the way I want to live my life. You may scheme to put me to shame or try to ridicule me but none of these things shall move me. I know what I am living for and where I am going.

... *Gbile Akanni*

28. If you are walking with Jesus, in the spirit, you need not fear going far. No believer has gone as far as God wants him to go.

... *A. A. Allen*

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

29. Go as far as you can see, when you get there you see further.

... *Unknown.*

30. If we celebrate the years behind us, they become stepping stones of strength and joy for the years ahead.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

31. At every crossroad, follow your dream; it is courageous to let your heart lead the way.

... *Thomas Leland.*

32. When I look back at where I have been, I see that what I am becoming is a whole lot further down the road from where I was.

... *Gloria Gaith*

33. Dedicate yourself to the call of your heart and see where it leads you.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

34. Oh, Lord God, I have no idea where I am going, I do not see the road ahead of me, I cannot know for certain where it will end, I will not fear, for you are ever with me.

... *Thomas Merton.*

35. You can never change the past, But by the grace of God, you can win the future, so remember those things which will help you go forward, but forget those things which will only hold you back.

... *Richard C. Woodsome.*

LIFE IS A JOURNEY ... COMPLETE IT!

36. Be patient with yourself and others. There are no shortcuts to spirituality. Growing fruits takes time.

... *Unknown*

12

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

The word happiness evokes vision of unwrapping gifts on Christmas morning, strolling hand in hand with the one you love, being surprised on your birthday; responding with unbridle laughter to a comedian, or vacationing in an exotic locale. Everyone wants to be happy. We make chasing this elusive ideal a lifelong pursuit! Spending money, collecting things and searching for new experiences. But if happiness depends on our circumstances, what happens when your toys rust, love one dies, health deteriorate, money is stolen, and the party's over? Often happiness flees and despair sets in. in contrast to happiness stands joy. Running deeper and stronger Joy is the confident assurance of God's love and work in our lives, that he will be there no matter what!

Happiness depends on happenings; joy depends on Jesus Christ! Continual learning is essential for life time growth. You can have a great deal of experience can be no smarter for all the things you have done, seen, and heard. Experience is no guarantee of life time growth. But if you regularly transform your experiences into new lessons, you will make each day of your life a source of growth. The smartest people are those who can transform even the smallest events or situations into breakthrough in thinking and action. Look at all of life as a school and every experience as a lesson, and your learning will always be greater than your experience. All of us have

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

personal life experiences but the tragedy is that we go through it but don't grow.

We attend meetings designed to help us learn, then do nothing with what we have heard after closing our notebooks. Don't get excited about a learning event, get excited about learning. And you haven't really learned it until you have applied it. Learn to build your life around your person, not your role, otherwise when your role changes you will lose your sense of worth! Don't allow changing times to change who you are, or make you stop dreaming and give up hope, when your role changes, remember that your life is not over see your own worth as a person, discover your next assignment, gather up your assets and keep on living and giving. Don't develop a "Mara" mentality like Naomi did in (Ruth 1:20). She allowed herself to become cynical when her circumstances changed, don't let that happen to you. Discouragement often comes when we feel like we have seen it all, heard it all, done it all and most of it was bad.

No matter how old you are, God can do exceedingly, abundantly above all that we ask or think (Eph. 3:20). You don't know what God can do with your life, before it is over, but he has a way of saving the best for the last. When Moses passed the touch to Joshua, a lot of things had changed. For forty years Joshua had been taught to navigate and survive in a wilderness, but now it was time to enter the promise land. And what worked in the wilderness didn't necessarily work in the promise land. Can't you hear Joshua's thoughts? I know a lot about wandering, but not much about warfare, so God told him; "this is my command- be strong and courageous! Do not be afraid or discouraged. For the Lord your God is with you wherever you go" (Josh. 1:9 NLT).

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

Why would God tell Joshua to be strong and courageous? Because he must have felt anxious! Everything about his new situation reeked of uncertainty. The only thing Joshua knew for sure was that God had said, "Go" so Joshua commanded the people saying, "prepare yourselves, for within three days you are to cross this Jordan and possess the land. Can't you imagine the people's thoughts? Question; but Joshua, how are we going to get across the river? Answer; I'm not sure, but in three days be ready to go. Question, but Joshua what are we going to do when we get-to the other side? Answer: I'll tell you when we arrive. Just be ready to move out. Are you getting the picture?

As a leader you will always be uncertain as to many things, especially when you go into a new territory. But you can never afford to be unclear or in doubt as to your calling, your vision and your ultimate victory. And where does such confidence come from? God's promise, "**I am with you**". Can you imagine a nation without a leader, a work place without a boss or an army without a general? It would be chaotic. Structure creates order, without it no progress can be made. That's why you don't park your car in the bedroom or sleep in the garage. Learn to respect those in authority over you. Honour those who have lived longer than you because they possess a wealth of knowledge, listen to them and grow. Until you learn to take orders, you will never be qualified to give them.

Jesus understood this, He was the son of God, He knew more than any other human being, yet He honoured the authority of the government in power. When the Pharisees ask Him His opinion on paying taxes, He answered; Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's (*Mark 12:17 NKJV*). Are you speaking words of doubt about

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

your organisation? Are you belittling those in authority over you? Stop it now! True, they are not perfect. **(Perhaps that's why they can tolerate you)** if you rebel against every instruction you are given, don't complain when those around you rebel against your word and opinions. The law of reciprocity states that if you want to be treated with respect, you must respect others ... that include those you don't agree with, or even like. Jesus Christ did as a leader. You will be called upon to make decisions regarding relationship, money, time, values, opportunities and disputes. And your decisions will show up on the bottom line. There, in the clear light of day, your leadership will be judged. And there's something else you need to know; in that realm it takes longer to recognise your brilliance or stupidity, because you are forced to lead for long periods of time without the benefit of knowing. If you made the right call.

By the time your crop starting coming in, it's too late to change your agricultural procedure. You have to wait until the next season of planting. When it comes to leadership, uncertainty is a permanent part of all progress; it never goes away. Furthermore, uncertainty isn't an indication of poor leadership, it just underscores the need for it, it is the environment in which good leadership is most often discovered. As a leader you may think you should always know what to do, but in reality there will be few occasions which you are absolutely certain. It's why King Jehoshaphat prayed; **"We do not know what to do, but we are looking for help"**. (2Chron. 20:12).

Since you'll constantly be called on to make decisions with limited information, your goal should not be to eliminate uncertainty but to develop the ability to trust God and be

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

courageous and clear in spite of it. It's not your job to remove uncertainty, it your job to inspire clarity, faith, courage, hope and progress in the midst of it, when you can do that, you are learning to be a leader.

Life is a Lesson Learn It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. What the wise man does at the beginning the fools does in the end.

... *Warren Buffet.*

2. God does not waste our time, He will use our past and present so that we may serve him with our future.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

3. If you believe what you like in the gospel, and reject what you don't like, it is not the gospel you believe but yourself.

... *Augustine of Hippo.*

4. Most times God will roast you before He will rest you.

... *Unknown.*

5. Heavenly Father, my prayer is that I would learn to trust you more, it is such a comfort to know that my life is in your hands, and the circumstances surrounding me are in your control. Remind me daily that choosing to be happy is an option. May I find my strength in your joy. Amen.

... *Kim Boyle*

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

6. When we face a difficult conflict, we can run about frantically or we can pause to pray. Which approach will be effective?
...Unknown.
 7. Let us believe that God is in all our simple deeds and learn to find Him there.
... A. W. Tozer.
 8. You already know that God is everywhere, and where God is, there is heaven - heaven! - where his majesty reigns in glory.
... Theresa of villa.
 9. If you can't have the best of what you want, learn to make the best of what have.
... Unknown.
 10. Time spent in communion with God is never lost.
... Gordon Lindsay.
 11. If you want to be a leader, learn from the others with quality traits in leadership, so you will be prepared when the opportunity comes.
... Unknown.
 12. The greatest incitement to a crime is the hope of escaping punishment.
... Unknown.
 13. Learn to say everyday "I am not afraid of delays or storm, for I am learning to sail my ship."
... Unknown.
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LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

14. Crime and punishment are twins of the same destiny.
... *Unknown*
15. Prayer may not change all things for you, but it sure changes you for all things, prayer is the stop that keeps you going. If God is your father please call home.
... *John L. Mason.*
16. I have so much to do today that I spend the first three hours in prayer.
... *Martin Luther.*
17. Do not have your concert first and tune your instruments afterwards. Begin the day with God.
... *James Hudson Taylor.*
18. Purpose is the reason why something was made.
... *Myles Monroe.*
19. Wishing will never be a substitute for prayer, remember that prayer can't be answered until they are prayed.
... *Edwin Louis Cole.*
20. Prayer is not monologue but dialogue, God's voice in response to mine, is its most essential part.
... *Andrew Murray!*
21. God is never more than a prayer away from you, when you feel swept off your feet, get back on your knees, heaven is ready to receive all those who pray.
... *Unknown.*

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

22. No erudition, no purity of diction, no width of mental outlook, no flower of eloquence, no grace of person can atone for lack of fire, flame gives prayer access as well as wings, acceptance as well as energy. Therefore there is no incense without fire no prayer without flame.
... *E. M. Bounds.*
23. Worship is thankful response to God and a repayment for what He has done.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
24. The greatest tragedy of life is not unanswered prayer but unoffered prayer.
... *F. B. Meyer.*
25. I know that God will not give me anything I can't handle, I just wish that He didn't trust me so much.
... *Mother Theresa.*
26. The greatest tragedy in life is not death, but life that fails to fulfil its purposes and potentials.
... *Unknown.*
27. It is not the man with motive but the man with purpose that prevails.
... *Unknown.*
28. If you try to live without God you will completely mess up your life, because life without purpose brings abuse.
... *Myles Monroe.*
29. The power that ushers us into the world of impossibility is the power of prayer.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
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LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

30. The most powerful energy anyone can generate is the prayer energy.
... *Corren Ten Boom.*
31. Prayer is weakness leaning on omnipotence.
... *W. S. Bowden.*
32. It's not what we know that makes us Christians but who we know, knowing Christ is knowing God.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
33. The great commission is not an option to be considered, it is a command to be obeyed.
... *Hudson Taylor.*
34. If your gospel isn't touching others, it hasn't touched you.
... *Curry R. Blake.*
35. Pray often, for prayer is a shield to the soul, a sacrifice to God and a scourge for Satan.
... *John Bunyan.*
36. When a Christian shuns fellowship with other believers, the devil smiles, when he stops studying the bible, the devil laughs, when he stops praying, the devil shouts for joy.
... *Corren Ten Boom.*
37. Talking to men for God is a great thing, but talking to God for men is greater still.
... *E. M. Bounds.*
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LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

38. We talk of the second coming of Christ, half of the world has never heard of the first.

... Oswald J. Smith

39. There is only one thing-we can do here on earth that we can't do in heaven, that is evangelism.

... Eckobig Anthony.

40. Revenge is an uncontrollable monster. Each act of retaliation brings another. It is a boomerang which cannot be thrown without cost to the thrower, the revenge cycle can only be halted by forgiveness.

... Unknown.

41. It is the duty of a Christian to be Christ to his neighbors.

... Martin Luther.

42. A fool is not someone with mental deficiency but character deficiency such as, rebellion, anger or laziness.

... Eckobig Anthony.

43. We can overcome fear when we cry to God for protection in our darkest hour.

... Eckobig Anthony.

44. When everything seems to go wrong, God is still for us. If a circumstances has turned against you, don't blame God, seek him.

... Eckobig Anthony.

45. Your past is your school of experience let your past mistakes points you to God's way.

... Eckobig Anthony.

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

46. God always offers a way of escape - even when we get ourselves in so deep that it doesn't look as if there is any way out.

... *Jeremiah 44:7.*

47. The farther we drift from God, the more confused our thinking becomes, the more complex and complicated our situation and circumstances will become.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

48. Departure from God's leading is the origin of man's calamities.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

49. When calamity forces you to examine your life, take a closer look at God's instructions for you and be willing to humbly apply what you find there.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

50. God does not forget those who take a stand for him.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

51. In whatsoever place you find yourself in life, continually ask God to help you see and respond to needs that you are uniquely placed to meet.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

52. The places we serve in life can often provide us with the unique opportunities to serve God and His people.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

LIFE IS A LESSON ... LEARN IT!

53. God is not pleased with those who come to Him only for what they can get rather than seeking to establish or deepen a relationship with Him.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

54. God does not guarantee that His servants will escape persecution, even when they are faithful. But God does promise that He will be with them and give them the strength to endure.

... *2 Corinthians 1:3*

55. As you minister to others recognise that your service is for God and not just for human approval. God rewards our faithfulness but not always during our stay on earth.

... *Unknown.*

56. It is better not to pray than to pray deceptively. God cannot be deceived.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

57. It is not good to make plans unless we are willing to have God change them, and it is not good to pray unless we are willing to accept God's answer.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

13

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

Life is saturated with stories of sexual escapades, secret rendezvous, and extramarital affairs, today's media teach that immorality means freedom, perversion is natural, and commitment is old fashioned. Sex, created by God and pronounced good in the Garden of Eden, has been twisted, exploited, and turned into an urgent, illicit, casual and self-gratifying activity.

Love has turned into lust, giving into getting and lasting commitments into **"No strings attached"**. In reality, sexual intercourse, the physical and emotional union of male and female, should be a holy means of celebrating love, producing children, and experiencing pleasure, protected by the commitment of marriage. God thinks sex is important, and the scripture contains numerous guidelines for its use and warning about its misuse. And sex is always mentioned in the context of a loving relationship between husband and wife.

As you read and study this book **"WHAT IS LIFE"**, especially this chapter; **"Life is love ... Show it!"** Remember that you are loved by God, and commit yourself to seeing life, sex, and marriage from His point of view. As Christians, we should consider ourselves dead and unresponsive to sexual immorality, impurity, lust, and evil desires. The bible everywhere celebrates heterosexual, monogamous' marriage as the proper situation for sexual fulfillment; strictly for

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

married couples. Christian men and women should be open to true love, and to sexual intimacy- within the commitment of lifelong fidelity. That is God's way; the rest is dangerous and futile. Stay away! Sexual sin and perversion will drain your energies and turn your heart away from God.

Love is a tiny little word that has many interpretations as there are stars in the sky. Most often it is confused with lust, Ego attachments, or infatuation! Love has many definite characteristics, meaning without those characteristics, it is not really love. Love is secure, love is inclusive, kind, encouraging, honest, selfless, considerate, puts others first, and based on appreciation and trust over time. It is respectful and uses power to build up, not to tear down, it is a moment-to-moment strength of a bond between people that cannot be fully explained, but those who have experienced it knows it for life. Most often, the first true love people feel is between themselves and their parents. The way their parent treat them and each other is the basis for our definition of love.

As adults, we show love by taking the role of our parents, or by acting similarly to how we did when we were children. This may not be the healthiest plan, as often our parents were not effectively able to act out of love to us or to each other. Love can be hindered by insecurity, low self-esteem, past pain that is not yet been forgiven, and many other factors. If one cannot say they love themselves, then it is unfortunately true that they won't be able to love another person and show words and actions of true love to them. We all have an immense capacity to love ourselves and others, yet most of the masses are not engaging in it much, if at all. The biggest reason for this is the fear of getting hurt. But like trust, if you choose to just not love or trust anyone your whole life, then instead of being protected

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

the whole time, you will actually be hurting the whole time, and hurting others in the process.

Starting with you, learn to accept yourself 100%, focus on your positive qualities, abilities, your physical features, your wit, your problem-solving skills, your willingness to help others, think of the last ten complements, you've been paid, believe them, people mean them. Rarely do forks just throw around random complements. Are you neglecting your loved ones? Stop now! (*Prov. 28:27 NIV*) "***He who gives to the poor will lack nothing, but he who closes his eyes to them receives many curse***". When it comes to charitable giving some people say "that is Old Testament doctrine. What is the New Testament teaching? Glad you asked! Jesus. Christ launched his ministry saying: the spirit of the Lord is on me, because He has anointed me to preach good news to the poor. (*Luke 4:18, Isaiah 61:1*) and it did not stop with Jesus Christ. The New Testament church carried out Christ's mission of mercy on daily basis. All the believers shared everything they had. They sold their properties and possessions and shared the money with those in need. As a result, they experienced great joy (*Acts 2:44-46 NLT*). You may say won't that leave me financially strapped? No. Because of their compassion and generosity, there was not a needy person among them (*Acts 4:34*). The giver and the receiver were both blessed. The rules of God's kingdom are; give freely and become more wealthy, be stingy and lose everything. The generous will prosper, those who refresh others will themselves be refreshed. (*Prov. 11:24-25*). It seems counter-intuitive, especially when you are struggling financially, but God promises that the generous will prosper. Your giving initiates God giving back to you. So look for someone in need, give and watch it come back to you.

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

The bible says, "***The Lord blesses everyone who freely gives food to the poor***" (Prov. 22:9) he who gives to the poor will lack nothing. Try it. Next time God urges you to show compassion and give, do it. Then when you have a need pray, Lord, I have honoured you, now I believe you will honor me. (Psalm 41:1 NIV) "***Blessed is he who has regard for the weak, the Lord delivers him in times of trouble***". Even in a bad economy, most of us are still better off than others, and better off than we have ever been. We may lack the latest, the biggest, the finest and the fastest, but we seldom lack the necessary, right? Now God doesn't guilt- trip us but He wants us to consider, remember, be mindful of the poor. The bible says, *he who shuts his ear to the cry of the poor will also cry himself and not be answered.* (Proverbs. 21:13).

Could this be a key to your prayers getting answered? To be comfortably provided for is a blessing, but you must not forget those in need. What is God's attitude towards the poor and what does he expect of us? "If there is a poor man among your brothers, do not hard-hearted or tight-fisted towards him and give him nothing, you will be found guilty. (Deut. 15:7-9 NIV).

Helping others is an obligation not an option. In scripture, the tithe took care of God's work and God's servant, but it was also to be shared with the stranger, the fatherless and the widow, so that they may eat and be satisfied. (Deut. 26:12) God said, ***if one of your country men becomes poor, unable to support himself, help him as you would an alien or a temporary resident, so he can continue to live among you*** (Levi. 25:35). The truth is, we've been called to feed, shelter and cloth the needy. (Isa. 58:5-12) God is compassionate and, generous to the poor, and he promises us his blessing for following His examples.

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

Bottom line: *You can give without loving, but you can't love without giving to those God loves.*

Life is Love ... Show It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Everyone has inside himself a piece of good news! The good news is that you really don't know how great you can be, how much you can love, what you can accomplish, and what your potential is.
... *Annie Frank.*
2. Live for something; write your name in kindness, love and mercy on the heart of thousands you come in contact with, you will never be forgotten.
... *Thomas Chalmers.*
3. The true measurement of happiness is found in God's love and in doing His will.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
4. If you love God, you won't hate your fellow men.
... *Pastor E. A. Adeboye.*
5. My children, our love should not be just words and talk, it must be true love, which shows itself in action.
... *1 John 3:18*
6. At the root of all displacement, destruction and crime witnessed all over the world is the absence of love.
... *Pastor E. A. Adeboye.*

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

7. When you walk in love, you will no longer keep records of wrong done against you by others. Rather, you will let go and let God have His way in your life.
... Pastor E. A. Adeboye.
 8. True love is not easily offended, and it is always willing to forgive. It is this love that enables you to show kindness to those who hurt you, even though you have the power to harm or punish them.
... Pastor E. A. Adeboye.
 9. We can either go alone with the crowd or speak up for God. When someone is treated unkindly or unjustly, reach out to that person with God's love.
...Unknown.
 10. A candle loses nothing of its light by lighting another candle.
...Unknown.
 11. Dare to love and be a real friend. The love you give and receive is a reality that will lead you closer and closer to God as well as to those who God has given you to love.
...Henry J. M. Nouwen.
 12. God is every moment totally aware of each of us. Totally aware in intense concentration and love.
... Eugenia Price.
 13. The grand essentials to happiness in this life are something to do, something to love and something to die for.
... Joseph Addison.
-

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

14. The capacity of getting along with others depends to a large extent on the capacity for getting along with ourselves.
... Eric Hoffer.
15. Love is a fabric which never fades no matter how often it is washed in the waters of adversity and grief.
... Eckobig Anthony.
16. In the depth of winter, I finally learned that there was within me an invincible summer.
... Albert Camus.
17. We never have to worry that God will run out of love, because His mercy flows from a well that will never run dry.
... Eckobig Anthon
18. Share smiles and hugs. Happiness is a perfume you cannot pour on others without getting a few drop on yourself.
... O. G. Mandino.
19. To speak gratitude is courteous and pleasant, to enact gratitude is generous and noble, but to live gratitude is to touch heaven.
... Johannes A. Gaertner.
20. The superior man stands erect by bending above the fallen, he rises by lifting others.
... Unknown.

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

21. We are each of us angels with one wings; and we can only fly by embracing one another.

... *Lucretius*.

22. Your most precious valued possessions and your greatest powers are often necessarily invisible and intangible, no one can take them, you and you alone can share them, the more you share, the more you will have.

... *Unknown*.

23. Value yourself by giving a smile to everyone you meet, a kind word, a pleasant response, appreciation with warmth from the heart, cheers, encouragement, hope, honor, credit, and applause, good thoughts, evidence of love for your fellow men, happiness, a prayer for the godless, and the godly and a time for worthy cause and eagerness.

... *Unknown*.

24. My best friend is the one who brings out the best in me.

... *Henry Ford*.

25. Friendship is the inexpressible comfort of feeling safe with a person, having neither to weigh thoughts nor measure words.

... *George Elliot*.

26. Let yourself be silently drawn by the stronger pull of what you really love.

... *Eckobig Anthony*.

27. Motives are just as important as actions, and where one's treasure is also his heart will be.

... *Unknown*.

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

28. Love the moment, flower grows out of dark moments, therefore each moments is vital, it affects the whole. Life is a succession of such moments, and to live each is to succeed.

... *Corita Kent.*

29. Share that which is good and desirable, and withhold that which is bad and undesirable.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

30. Only in union with Christ can we love enough to overcome our hostilities, and one day the whole world will acknowledge that Christ is Lord.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

31. The secret to a happy heart is filling our minds with thoughts that are true, pure and lovely.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

32. What a woman should know; a man who truly loves her will never let you go no matter what the situation is. What a man should know; a woman who truly loves him you will be angry at you for so many things but will stick around.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

33. Just don't give up trying to do what you really want to do. Where there is love and inspiration, I don't think you can go wrong.

... *Ella Fitzgerald.*

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

34. There is a time for risky love. There is a time for extravagant gestures. There is a time to pour out your affection on the one you love. And when the time comes - seize it, don't miss it.

... *Max Lucado.*

35. We learn to love by loving.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

36. All the beautiful sentiments in the world weigh less than a simple lovely action.

...*James Russell Howell.*

37. Caring words, friendship, affectionate touch - all of these have a healing quality. Why? Because we were all created by God to give and receive love.

...*Jack Frost.*

38. In God's wisdom, He frequently chooses to meet our needs by showing His love towards us through the hands and heart of others.

...*Jack Hayford.*

39. Oh, the comfort, the inexpressible comfort of feeling safe with a person, having neither to weigh nor measure words but pour them out.

... *Dinah Maria Mulock Craik.*

40. What value has compassion that does not take its object in its arm?

...*Antoine De Saint - Exupery.*

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

41. The great thing to remember is that our feelings come and go, His love for us does not.

... *C. S Lewis.*

42. Be with me in my silence and in my speech, in my haste and in my leisure, in company and solitude, in the freshness of the morning and in the weariness of the evening, and give me the grace at all times to rejoice in thy mysterious companionship.

...*John Baille.*

43. All God's words are right and everything He does is worthy of our trust. He loves whatever is just and good, the earth is filled with His tender love.

...*Psalm 33:4-5*

44. We are truly loving when we help ourselves and others to be all we are meant to be. A loving life is life where there is a balance between fulfilling our own needs and caring enough about others to help them fulfil theirs.

... *Alexandra Stoddard.*

45. Open your hearts to the love that God instills, God loves you tenderly. What He gives you is not to be kept under lock and keys, but to be shared.

... *Mother Teresa.*

46. This is and has been the father's work from the beginning - to bring us in to the home of his heart.

... *George MacDonald.*

LIFE IS LOVE ... SHOW IT!

47. The goal of grace is to create a love relationship between God and us who believe, the kind of relationship for which we were first made.

... *J. I. Packer.*

48. Love is not about what we do but who we are, convincing others of our love for them, and about who loves us.

... *Jack Frost.*

49. There is no fear in love. But perfect love drives out fear, we love because He first loved us.

... *1 John 4:18.*

50. I am glad that in the springtime of life, there were those who planted flower of love in my heart.

... *Robert Louis Steveson*

51. All that we have and are is one of the unique and never to be repeated ways God has chosen to express Himself in space and Time. Each of us made in his image and likeness, is yet another promise He has made to the universe that He will continue to love and care for it.

... *Anonymous.*

14

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

He spoke, and galaxies whirled into place, stars burned the heavens, and the planets began orbiting their suns - words of awesome, unlimited, unleashed Power. He spoke again and the waters and land were filled with plants and creatures, running, swimming, growing, and multiplying- words of animating, breathing, pulsing life. Again He spoke, and man and woman were formed, thinking, speaking, and loving- words of personal and creative glory. Eternal, infinite, unlimited, He was, is, and always will be the maker and Lord of all that exists. And then He came in the flesh to a speck in the universe called planet earth.

The mighty creator became a part of the creation, limited by time and space and susceptible to agony, sickness, and death. But love propelled Him, and so He came to rescue and save those who were lost and to give them the gift of eternity. He is the word; He is Jesus Christ the Messiah. The bible is concerned primarily with the story of redemption as it is in Jesus Christ. If you read the scriptures and miss the story of salvation, you have missed its message and meaning. There have been those who have gone through the bible and traced the story of Jesus Christ.

In Genesis, He is the seed of the woman.
In Exodus, He is the Passover Lamb;
In Leviticus, He is the Atoning Sacrifice.

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

In Numbers, He is the Smitten Rock.
In Deuteronomy, He is the Greatest Prophet.
In Joshua, He is the captain of the Lord's Host.
In Judges, He is the Deliverer.
In Kings, He is the Promised King.
In Nehemiah, He is the Restorer of the Nation.
In Esther, He is the Advocate.
In Job, He is my Redeemer.
In Psalms, He is my Shepherd.
In Proverbs, He is my Pattern.
In Ecclesiastes, He is my Goal.
In the Songs of Solomon, He is my Satisfier.
In the books of the Prophets, He is my Coming Prince of peace.
In the Gospels, He is our Representative of the Father's Right Hand.
In Revelation, He is our Returning Lord.

In an age of psychology and eclectic theology, the bedrock of Our faith is still Christ's virgin birth, His sinless life, His atoning death, His victorious resurrection, His mediatorial work, and His visible return as King of kings. Jesus Christ there is no one like Him! History growing moment occurred when Christ died for the ungodly (Rom. 5:6) He didn't just die for His friends and supporters, He died for people who despised Him. It was no 50-50 deal where Jesus said; I'll accept you if you accept me, No, it was a selfless one- sided act out of love. No conditions, nothing demanded in return. As a result, God delivered us from the power of darkness and conveyed us into the kingdom of the dear son. (Colo. 1:13). Stop and meditate on- these advantages you enjoy through Jesus Christ's blood:

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

1. You've been delivered; Jesus Christ rescued us by drawing us to himself, our deliverance was a deeply personal event to Him. By His shed blood He drew you to Himself The distance sin put between you and God was reversed and you were accepted in the beloved. (Eph. 1:6).
2. You have been freed from the power of darkness: That "**power**" is Satan's tyranny over those living under his control. Christ's blood liberated you from the darkness, ignorance and blindness Satan used to deceive and manipulate you.
3. You have been translated into the kingdom of Gods son. The word "**translated**" implies being transferred from one place to another, Christ's blood transferred you into His kingdom to enjoy unlimited advantages, guaranteed protection, abundant provision for all your needs, full status of son-ship, and unlimited access to His throne. *"But now He has reconciled you by Christ's physical body through death to present you holy in His sight without blemish free from accusation"* (Colo. 1 :22).
4. You have been reconciled to God; God wants an unbroken, intimate friendship with us, as with Adam in Eden. But sin made us enemies of God. You who were once far away from God, enemies, separated you from Him by your evil thoughts and actions. Yet He never stopped pursuing that relationship, sending Jesus Christ to restore it. He made peace by means of Christ's blood on the Cross, resulting in your reconciliation to God. The Greek word for reconciliation means "**to be friends as we once were**", holy and blameless without a fault!

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

5. You are the Lords redeemed; At the Jordan River, John saw Jesus Christ and said *"look the lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world"* (Jn. 1:29) Jesus, in whom we have redemption through His blood (Col. 1:14). The word **"redemption"** means liberation from captivity by a ransom paid. Not only are you purchased at the cost of Christ's life, you are also adopted by blood into God's family.
6. You are forgiven of all sins; in who Jesus Christ we have the forgiveness of sins, how did He accomplish the total removal of all our sins? Having cancelled the written code with its regulations, that was against us, He took it away, nailing it to the Cross (Col. 2:14). He wrote in His blood **"paid in full"** across your outstanding bill of indebtedness to God, nailing your cancelled debt notice, to His. You are forgiven. You owe nothing again! What an amazing discovery! Glory to Jesus Christ!

Life is a Mystery ... Unfold It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. You either ride life or it rides you. Your mental attitudes determines who is the rider or the horse.
... Napoleon Hill.
 2. Not knowing when the dawn will come, I open every door.
... Emily Dickson
 3. Times and cultures changes, but God is always majestically present as protector and provider.
... Eckobig Anthony.
-

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

4. Emotional intelligence quotient is stronger than academic intelligent quotient.
... Daniel Golemen.
 5. Forests burnt down are able to grow back and broken bones heal.
... Unknown.
 6. There is only one hand that can lift you and sustain you at the top. That hand is called the everlasting hands of God.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 7. This new day brings another year, renewing hope, dispelling fear, and may we find before the end, a deep content another friend.
... Arch Ward.
 8. Every time I begin to feel that there just isn't any more strength in me, I end up knowing that there is more in Him.
... Gloria Gaither.
 9. God can do wonders with a broken heart, if you give Him all the pieces.
... Victor Alfsen.
 10. Take a moment to consider the awesome reality that God who spoke and created the universe is now speaking to you. If Jesus could speak and raise the dead, calm a storm and heal the incurable, then what effect might a word from Him have upon your life?
... Henry T. Blackaby.
-

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

11. God's peace is far more wonderful than the human mind can understand. His presence will keep your thoughts .and your heart quiet and at rest as you trust in Jesus Christ.
... Philippians 4:7
12. You must know all there is to know in your particular field and keep on the search for new knowledge. The least difference in knowledge between you and another man may spell his success and your failure.
... Henry Ford.
13. Your potentials will not be released until you take your thoughts, plans and imaginations and put them into action, you must work to mine your hidden potentials.
... Myles Monroe.
14. The optimist sees the rose and not the thorns, the pessimist stares at the thorns oblivious of the rose.
... Kahl Gibran.
15. One of the things people began to find out in the last century was that thoughts – just thoughts – are as powerful as electric batteries. As good for one as sunlight is, or as bad as poison.
... Frances Hodgson Burrett.
16. Failure is one major symptom of poverty but it can be turned into a splendid accomplishment we diagnose with the power of prayer.
... Eckobig Anthony.

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

17. Our real blessing often appears to us in the shape of pains, loses and disappointments, but let us have patience and we shall soon see them in their proper figures.
...Joseph Addison.
 18. To the one who has faith, no explanation is necessary, to the one without faith no explanation is possible.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 19. Success is another form of failure, if we forget what our priorities should be.
... Henry Ford.
 20. In the depth of winter, I finally learned that there was within me an invincible summer.
... Albert Camus.
 21. What lies behind us and what lies before us are tiny matter compared to what lies within us.
...Ralph Emerson
 22. If a man empties his purse into his head, no one can take it from him, an investment in knowledge always pays the best interest.
... Benjamin Franklin.
 23. When you stop reading, you stop leading and when you stop learning, you start leaning on others for survival.
... Unknown.
 24. To recognise another's inwardness is to have seen the sacred.
... Koestenbaum.
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LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

25. Appearance doesn't reveal what people are really like or their true value.

... Eckobig Anthony.

26. Every man is what he is because of the dominating thoughts which he permits to dominate his own mind.

... Unknown.

27. When riches begin to come, they come so quickly in such great abundance, that one wonders where they have been hiding during all those lean years.

... Unknown.

28. The subconscious mind will translate into reality. A thought driven by fear just as readily as it will translate into reality a thought driven by courage or faith.

...Unknown.

29. There are two kinds of study, the one kind being the things we learn and know, the other the training that thought us how to find out what we did not know.

...Unknown.

30. More gold has been mined from the thought of men than has ever been taken from the earth.

...Unknown.

31. Your work is to discover your world and then with all your heart give yourself to it.

... Eckobig Anthony.

32. He who knows others is learned, he who knows himself is wise.

... Lao-Tsze.

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

33. Wealth is like a tree which grows from a tiny seed, the alms you give is the seed from which your tree of wealth shall grow.

... *Unknown.*

34. Our minds are thought factories where ideas are put together, that enables us to achieve our purpose.

... *Unknown.*

35. We need to grow in our knowledge of the Word of God (The Bible) because ignorance of it makes us vulnerable to deception.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

36. It is in the digging that life is lived.

... *Unknown.*

37. The mind is not a vessel to be filled but a fire to kindle.

... *Unknown.*

38. When we call on God, He bends down His ears to listen, as a father bends down to listen to his child.

...*Elizabeth Charles.*

39. The place where God calls you to, is the place where your deep gladness and the world's deep hunger meet.

... *Frederick Buechner.*

40. Most mysteries are usually revealed to us by God in our darkest moments.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

41. When you are in the dark, listen and God will give you a very precious message for someone else when you get into the light.
... Oswald Chambers.
42. If I can keep laughing, everything will be fine.
... Beverly Hills.
43. Everyday holds the possibility of a miracle.
.... Eckobig Anthony
44. Nothing is impossible with God.
.... Luke 1:37
45. God understands our prayers even when we can't find the words to say them.
... Eckobig Anthony.
46. There will come a time when you believe everything is finished. That will be the beginning.
...Louis L'Amour.
47. We do not understand the intricate pattern of the stars in their courses, but know that He who created them does, and that just as surely as He guides them, He is charting a safe course for us.
... Billy Graham.
48. With God there is always more unfolding, what we can glimpse of the divine is always exactly enough, and never enough.
... Kathleen Norris.
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LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

49. God guides us, despite our uncertainties and our vagueness, even through our failings and mistakes, He lead us step by step, from event to event. Only afterwards as we look back over the way we have come to reconsider certain important moments in our lives in the light of all that has followed them do we experience the feeling of having being led .without knowing it, the feeling that God has mysteriously guided us.

... Ruth Senter.

LIFE IS A MYSTERY ... UNFOLD IT!

15

LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

One day Abraham sent his servant Eliezer out to find a wife for his son Isaac, standing by a small forth well, Eliezer prayed, "let the woman who offer to water my camels be the one you have chosen." Suddenly Rebekah shows up and says "*Drink and I will also give your camels to drink*" (Gen 24:13-14). Rebekah had no idea that Eliezer had the ability to change her life. She didn't know her act of kindness will open a door to great blessings. In Old Testament times, it was customary to offer water to a stranger, it was known as the law hospitality. The Jews believed the word; *Do not forget to entertain strangers, for by so doing some have unknowingly entertained angels* (Heb. 13:2). But who on earth offers to water ten thirsty camels? One camel can drink forty gallons of water that is a half day project. Rebekah was generous to a total stranger, seeking nothing but the joy of serving. What she didn't know was that these camels would transport her back to Isaac, make her bride, shower her with great wealth and put her in the family of Jesus Christ. "*The power of seeing opportunity in every difficulty rather than seeing difficulty in every opportunity*". So, if you want to get ahead in life, show up early, stay late, work hard, be honest and be a problem solver. Live by Christ's teaching "go the extra mile" (Matt. 5:41). The key to success is in doing merely what is expected, but a little more. Yes, camels are ugly, but out of that ugly situation came the most beautiful thing that ever happened in history to Rebekah.

LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

The story of Rebekah teaches us a very important truth about life.

When opportunity knocks, make sure you are ready to answer the door. And when opportunities refuse to knock at your door, build a door for it, not with wood like any other door but with gold, so that it will stand irresistible to opportunity. Rebekah didn't think about the extra effort required to water ten thirty camels, she didn't say I don't do that kind of work, nor did she say it is not in my job's description, she lived by the principle; whatever your hands find to do, do it with your might. (Eccl. 9:10). She didn't suddenly develop a work ethic when Eliezer showed up, she practiced one every day and it paid it off. A saying goes what you do repeatedly you become permanently. Faithfulness always brings rewards. God is watching your attitudes and actions in small things. Big moments don't come to people who wait for them, they come from faithfulness in-small moments. In daily routine and non-glamorous service. Rebekah didn't quote the Torah or ask Eliezer what his denomination was, instead of trying to be super-spiritual, she decided to be nice. As a result, she got his attention, earned his respect, and ended up in the family of Abraham. Notice one more thing; when Rebekah took Eliezer home to meet her family, they wanted her to wait for ten days before leaving to go meet Isaac. That was customary, but she said I will go (Gen 24:58). When God opens the door don't delay. Don't say "others are more qualified than I am. If God has called you, you are the right person. So, step over your fears and move in the direction he is leading you, because where God leads, He will provide. A journey without God's leading will have a hopeless end, a journey with God's leading will have endless hope. Let's look at the two sinners Jesus Christ welcomed; (Luke 15:2)

LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

FIRST: Matthew, as a tax collector working for the Romans, he was hated by his own people, the Jews. But Jesus Christ had a special plan for him. Because he was skilled in keeping records Jesus Christ did not only save his soul but salvaged his talents. As a result he ended up writing the four Gospels. Do you still think God can't use you? Not a chance. The fact that Matthew invited Jesus Christ over to his house for dinner is surprising. The fact that Jesus Christ accepted is truly amazing. That is because this man welcomes sinners.

SECOND: Zacchaeus; Zacchaeus wanted to see Jesus Christ so badly that he climbed up a tree. He was willing to go out on a limb to find God. When Jesus Christ reached the spot, He looked up and said to him, "*Zacchaeus, come down immediately. I must stay at your house today*". O he came down at once and welcomed Him gladly. All the people began to mutter, "*He has gone to be the guest of a sinner*". But Zacchaeus said to the Lord, Here and now I will give half of my possessions to the poor, and if I have cheated anybody I will repay back four times the amount. "Jesus Christ said to him ", Today salvation has come to this house (Luke 19:5-9). The bible says God is a rewarder of them that diligently seek Him (Heb. 11:6). So be diligent in your search, the persistent in quest and relentless in your pilgrimage. Turn away from the puny pursuit of possessions and positions and seek the Lord in your pursuit of purpose! You will not be disappointed!

Life is an Opportunity ... Take it!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Decision and determination are the engineer and the fireman of our train - opportunity and success.

... Burt Lawlor.

LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

2. None of us know what next change is going to be, what unexpected opportunity is just around the corner, waiting to change all the tenor of our lives.
... Kathleen Norris.
 3. God is looking for people who will come in simple dependence upon His grace, and rest in simple faith upon His greatness. At this very moment, He is looking at you.
... Jack Hanford.
 4. Indeed, the various circumstances in which you find yourself can serve as obstacles or they can be turned into opportunity.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 5. The world has more winnable people than ever before, but it is possible to come out of a ripe field empty handed.
... Paul Little.
 6. Obstacles are those frightful things you see when you take off your eyes off your goals.
.... Henry Ford.
 7. Opportunity has a sly habit of slipping in by the back door and often it comes disguised in the form of misfortune, or temporary defeat, perhaps this is why so many fail to recognize opportunity.
...Unknown.
 8. One's best success comes after their greatest disappointment.
... Henry Ward Beecher.
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LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

9. A life spent making mistakes is not only more honourable but more useful than a life spent in doing nothing.
... Benard Shan.
10. Grace is giving of God, but knowledge is bought in the market.
... Arthur Clough
11. Four things that never come back, the spoken words, the speed arrow, the past life and the neglected opportunity.
... Saudi Arabia Pellets
12. Instead of living in the past, decide to live for today, live in such a way that you will look back on today as one of the good old days.
...Eckobig Anthony.
13. Psychology has correctly said that when one is truly ready for a thing, it puts on in its appearance.
... Unknown.
14. Always begin anew with the day, just as nature does, it is one of the sensible things that nature does.
... George E. Woodbury.
15. Our most important opportunities may come when we least expect them.
... Eckobig Anthony.
16. You draw nothing out of the bank of life except what you deposited in it.
... Unknown.

LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

17. If I have seen further than others, it's because I have stood on the shoulder of giants.
... *Sir. Isaac Newton.*
18. The time is always right to do what is right.
... *Martin Luther King Jr.*
19. Be a blessing to others, the best helping hand you will ever find is at the end of your own arm. In the midst of your own battles, care about others, an unused life is an early death.
... *Unknown.*
20. Let every occasion be a great occasion, for you cannot tell when fate may be taking your measure for a larger place.
... *Unknown.*
21. Every opportunity has a difficulty and every difficulty has an opportunity. The difference between an obstacle and an opportunity is our reaction to the obstacle. Problems are the price of progress.
...*Unknown.*
22. The place we serve in life can often provide for us the unique opportunities to serve God and His people.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
23. Success seems to be largely a matter of hanging on after others have let go.
... *William Feather.*

LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

24. See each morning as a world made a-new, as if it were the morning of the very first day, treasure and use it, as if it were the final hour of the very last day.
... *Fay Hartzell Arnold.*
25. Today is unique! It has never occurred before and it will never be repeated. At midnight it will end, quietly, suddenly, totally, forever. But the hours between now and then are opportunities with eternal possibilities.
... *Charles R. Swindoll.*
26. It is better to walk through the valley with God than to stand on the mountaintop alone.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
27. Not knowing when the dawn will come, I open every door.
...*Emily Dickson.*
28. In a special way, human beings, being made in the image of God, only become real human beings, are only able to grow and thrive as human beings, as they also yearn for God.
... *Roberta Bondi.*
29. When God supplies your needs and gives you over and above your immediate needs, it is him giving you seed for sowing,so that you can increase the harvest of your righteousness.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
30. What you will use to secure your eternity is what you have now here on earth.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
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LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

31. Eternity has nothing to do with exaggeration - it does not seek to impress anybody. Eternity is constant. It does not need to tell you something that you will not see tomorrow.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

32. For you to receive heavenly ministry, support and enabling and for you to come to the point where it is angels that are running errands for your life, you have got to first of all push behind you the glory of this world.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

33. If you succeed at keeping malice with somebody for three months, you would have wasted three months of opportunity to have correctly positioned yourself in eternity.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

34. It is what you do here' on earth that determines your placement in eternity.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

35. My investments are here just to release eternal credit to my eternal deposits.

... *Gbile Akanni*

36. Labouring for eternity means doing things here on earth that will have an everlasting reward.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

37. Eternity is the final everlasting state into which everyone is going to enter. The truth is that you are already making choice of what your eternity will look like, by what you are doing now.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
38. If you want to be a leader, you must lead by example.
... *Chinedu Nwaejinaka.*
39. If you want to be the head, you must be ahead.
... *Chinedu Nwaejinaka.*
40. Every man is given a chance to live in this world where change can occur so that can by himself make a choice of his placement in eternity where there will be no change.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
41. Your choices on earth are what determines your chances and placement in eternity.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
42. It is readiness that enables us to recognize opportunity.
.... *Eckobig Anthony.*
43. Opportunity is looking at what everybody is looking at, but seeing what nobody else sees.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
44. Things turn out best for the people who make the best of the way things turn out.
... *Unknown.*
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LIFE IS AN OPPORTUNITY ... TAKE IT!

45. It is only what you succeed in transferring into your heavenly account that is truly your own.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
46. The best of a man's life is only revealed in his attitude to handling little, and seemingly inconsequential things.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
47. The things that the world system is running after will come running after you when you let go of the world system and embrace the eternal.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
48. Opportunity is missed by most people because it is dressed in overalls and looks like work.
... *Thomas Edison*
49. Ask and it is given.
...*Abraham-Hicks.*
50. Life may not always be fair but it gives everybody at least one golden opportunity.
... *Ven. Okey Ifionu.*

16

LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

Class reunions, photo albums, familiar songs and. old neighbourhoods - like long-time friends they awaken our memories and stir our emotions. The past is a kaleidoscope of promise, failure, victories and embarrassments. Sometimes we want to forget memories that are too painful. As the year passes, however, remembrances of unpleasant events usually fade into our subconscious. But there is a time to remember, mistakes should not be repeated, commitments made must be fulfilled and the memory of special events can encourage us and more to action. What "wall" stands between you and God's blessing? Limited resources? Past failures? Does the job look big and you feel too small? Rise up and say, God by you I can run against a troop, by my God I can leap over a wall". Instead of accepting what your sight and your senses tell you, stand on the promises God has given you in His word. On the other side of the wall, there is victory for you. A.B Simpson said "*you will never learn faith in a comfortable surroundings.*" It was after the disciples came through the storm that the wind and sea obey Him? (Matt. 8:27). The one who commanded them to get into to the boat knew there will be a storm, yet He sent them into it. Why you may ask? To develop their faith!

A little boy was crossing the ocean with his father, who was a captain of the ship, when they try to ran into a terrible storm. The wave tossed them about like a cork and everyone was sick

LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

with fear. But he sat unafraid, his eyes directed toward a certain spot. When someone asked him why he was not afraid, he answered, I have my eyes on the little window. Through it I can see the bridge, and on that bridge is my father. He is the captain of this ship. He has taken it through many storms and I know he will take it through this one too. Rejoice, you make it through this storm and get to the other side. God has promised it. Start saying by my God I can. If you are waiting for a promise God has given you to be fulfilled, observe the words of Jesus Christ; The kingdom of God is as if a man should scatter seed on the ground, and should sleep by night and rise by day, and the seed should sprout and grow, he himself does not know how, for the earth yield crop by itself. First the blade, then the head, after that the full grain in the head. But when the grain ripens, immediately he puts in the sickle, because the harvest has come, (Mark 4:26-29). The process is complete and promise fulfilled. Before you receive what God has promised, you often you through certain stages. Let's look at them.

1. **First stage; The I don't know stage:-** your seed is in the ground, when it will produce a harvest is entirely up to God. But His word assures us it will.
2. **The blade stage;** His just a tiny bade blowing in the breeze but it is enough to encourage you and let you know that the answer is on the way.
3. **The head stage;** Now it is starting to look like what you have prayed for. Hopefully you have been watering it with prayer, fertilizing it with God's word and protecting it from any negative force that will try to uproot it.

LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

4. Final stage; **Full grain stage**: This is when God says, put in the sickle, because your harvest has come, at this point, it is crucial to recognize your harvest and begin to reap it. Whatever stage you are today, stand on God's promise and keep trusting Him. He will not disappoint you. Faithful is He that promised. He will do it.

Life is a Promise ... Fulfil It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. The quality, not longevity of one's life is important.
... Martin Luther King Jr.
2. An educated man is the one who has so developed the faculties of his mind that he may acquire anything he wants or its equivalent without violating the right of others.
...Unknown.
3. Activities never bring solution but responsibility is the master key to great success and achievements.
...Eckobig Anthony.
4. To succeed, you need to find something to hold on to, something to motivate you, something to inspire you .
... Tony Dorsett.
5. No man is an iceberg drifting on the ocean of history. Each one of us belongs to a great family, in which he has his own place and his own role to play.
...Pope John Paul II

LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

6. Your days at most cannot be very long, so use them to the best of your ability for the glory of God and the benefit of your generation.
... William Booth.
 7. I expect to pass through this life but once, any good thing therefore that I can do, or any kindness that I can show to any fellow creature, let me do it now, let me not defer or neglect it, for I shall not pass this way again.
...Etienne De Grellet.
 8. Stop being afraid of what could go wrong and think of what could go right.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 9. I am still confident of this, I will see the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living. Wait for the Lord, be strong and take heart.
... Psalm 27:13-14
 10. Everyone thinks of changing the world, no one thinks of changing himself.
... Charles Schwab
 11. Team work divides the task and doubles the success .
... Unknown.
 12. When you don't get exactly what you want in life, see it as an avenue to get what God wants for you.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 13. I rather fail with honor than succeed with fraud.
... Mr. Sophocles.
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LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

14. I don't know who my grandfather was, I am much concerned to know what his grandson will be.
... Abraham Lincoln.
15. Failure is never a friend to anyone except for those who see it and ran away.
... Eckobig Anthony.
16. People may have known your yesterday and have seen your today, but your tomorrow they do not know.
... Unknown.
17. Living with ability brings responsibility, dying with ability reveals irresponsibility.
... Unknown.
18. Remember that there is no happiness in having or getting, but only in giving.
... Eckobig Anthony.
19. Your future depends on many things, but mostly on you.
... Frank Tyger.
20. Begin today! No matter how feeble the light, let it shine as best as it may. The world may need just that quality of light which you have.
... Henry C. Blin.
21. Don't let your desire for approval, applause, or popularity drives you to embrace the immoral.
... Eckobig Anthony.

LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

22. I have thoroughly tested your promises and that is why I love them so much.
..... Psalm 119:140.
23. The possibilities of prayers run parallel with the promises of God. Prayer opens an outlet for the promises and secures their precious end.
... E. M. Bounds.
24. I will rejoice in doing good to them, and I will plant them in this land in faithfulness, with all my heart and all my soul.
...Jeremiah 32:41.
25. We may depend upon God's promises, for He will be as good as His word. He is so kind that He cannot deceive us, so true that He cannot break His promise.
... Matthew Henry.
26. Forever oh Lord, your words stands firm in heaven. Your faithfulness extends to every generation, like the earth you created, it endures by your decree, for everything serves your plans.
... Psalm 119:89-90.
27. The way you treat people says a lot about who you are. Be careful. Your actions are screaming over your words.
... Thema Davis.
28. I know for sure what we dwell on is who we become.
.... Oprah Winfrey.
-

LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

29. Work for a cause, not for applause, live to express not to impress. Don't strive to make your presence noticed, just make your absence felt. Feel the legacy not just the money.

... *Unknown.*

30. Look at yourself as a color. You may' not be everybody's favourite, but one day you will meet someone who needs you to complete their painting.

... *Unknown.*

31. Be patient and you will get the best.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

32. It is not what you do for your children, but what you have taught them to do for themselves that will make them successful human beings.

... *Ann Lenders.*

33. Weather you break the alabaster box of your life on Jesus Christ or not, you will still break it somewhere somehow.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

34. To secure a place for yourself in eternity, you will have to prove your faithfulness in that which is least.

... *Gbile Akanni*

35. You are to be a channel of blessing to others and not a pool. A stagnant pool soon becomes the breeding spot for dangerous infections in the community.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

LIFE IS A PROMISE ... FULFIL IT!

36. He is a wise man indeed who lives with his focus on eternity.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

37. Whatever God has graciously put in your hand, whatever position He has placed you in life, He wants you to make it count for eternity.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

38. Whatever we do not finish in this world, when we enter into eternity, it cannot be finished again.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

39. You must strive to secure a correct placement for yourself in eternity no matter the cost.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

40. Four squared education combined with godliness are a sure recipe for true greatness.

... *Ven. Okey Ifionu.*

17

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

With a flick of a match, friction occurs and a spark leaps from match to tinder. A small flame burns the edges and grows. Fuel by word and air. Heart builds, and soon the kindling is leaked by reddish orange tongues, higher and wider it spreads, consuming the words. The flame has become a fire. Nearly 2,000 years ago, a match was struck in Palestine. At first, just a few in that corner of the world were touched and warned, but the fire spread the birth and spread of the church - triggered by the flame and fire as recorded in the bible. Beginning from Jerusalem with a small group of disciples, then the message traveled across the Roman Empire, empowered by the Holy-Spirit, this courageous band preached, taught, healed, and demonstrated love in synagogues, schools, homes, market places and courtrooms, and on streets, hills, ship and desert roads where God sent them, lives and history were changed. As a follower of Christ, you can also say, *"I am not ashamed of the Gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto salvation to everyone that believeth"* (Rom. 1:16). Our Gospel is not education or sophistication, but salvation. It's not reformation or rehabilitation, but redemption from the penalty and the power of sin, (Rom. 6:23) and transformation to be like Christ. (Rom. 12:2) and (John 1:12). The bible says if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature, old things are passed away, behold, all things are become new (2 Corinthians 5:17). This is not old car with a new set of plugs, points and a carburetor; it is a brand new model.

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

Notice the words; "To everyone that believeth: by placing your trust in Christ you are forgiving from all sins, clothed in Christ is righteousness, made fully acceptable in God's sight, and qualified for eternity in heaven. You ask, how long does a prayer for salvation have to be?

The thief on the cross prayed only nine words, "*Lord remember me when you come to tour kingdom*" (Luke 23:42). The tax collector in the temple prayed only seven words "*God be merciful to me a sinner*" (Luke 18:13). *When Peter was sinking in the Sea of Galilee he only had time for three words "Lord save me"* (Matthew 14:30). And the good news is Christ saved them all. You asked, how do I receive this life-changing power? By faith! "*for it is with your heart that you believe and are justified, and it is with your mouth that you confess and are saved*". As the scripture says, "*Anyone who trust in Him will never be put to shame*". (Romans 10:10-11). The psalmist wrote, "*They looked to Him and were radiant, and their faces were not ashamed.*" (Psalm 34:5). As a follower of Christ, that should be your testimony. Because you have place your trust in Him you are able to say, "***I am not ashamed***" of;

1. **His birth;** Mary was His mother, but God was His father. So He was tainted with neither inherited sin nor practiced sin, hence He meets all of God's requirements to be our saviour.
2. **His miracles;** He never demanded money in exchange for a miracle. Not one supernatural act was performed for selfish or ostentatious purposes, but only to meet people's needs.
3. **His preaching;** Even His enemies had to admit, No man ever spoke like this man! (John 7:46). Other men's words inform us, His words transform us.

4. **His claims;** He said, He that hath seen me, hath seen The Father (John 14:9). You see the fullness of God expressed in Jesus Christ.
5. **His death;** He bore your shame. You were morally and spiritually bankrupt. But he satisfied all God's claims against you at the cross, writing I paid in full' across your account.
6. **His resurrection;** lifted up was He to die, it is finished was His cry. Now in heaven exalted high, hallelujah, what a Saviour! And His promise is, because I live, you will live also. (John 14:19).
7. **His mediatorship;** Picture this; when you fail He stands before God on your behalf, offering His blood as atonement for your sin. If you saw Him now, you will say I am not ashamed of Jesus Christ.

The psalmist wrote, uphold me according unto thy word, that I may live; and let me not be ashamed of my hope (Psalm 119:116). What is our hope? It is found in the second coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. Paul spells it out: we believe that Jesus Christ died and rose again and so we believe that God will bring with Jesus Christ those who have fallen asleep in Him. For the Lord Himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the arch angel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first, after that, we who are still alive and are left will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air, (1 Thess. 4:14-17). Jesus Christ said, for a time will come when all who are in their grave will hear His voice and come out those who have done good will rise to live, and those who have done evil will rise to be condemned (John 5:28-29) in that day the Lord's prayer will finally be answered; Thy kingdom come, Thy will be done in the earth, as it is in heaven. (Matt. 6:10).

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

The hymnist wrote, O Lord it's for thee, Thy coming we wait.
The sky, not the grave, is our goal.

Oh trump of the angels! Oh voice of the Lord! Blessed rest,
blessed hope of my soul, Jesus Christ has not changed His
mind, He is coming again, coming for whom? For a prepared
people, to take them to a prepared place, where they will dwell
with Him forever. Are you planning to be there?

When you make decision based on doubts and unbelief, they
never turn out right. After hearing Jesus's promise they rise
from the dead, and actually seeing him alive, the disciples
went back to what they were doing before they met Him;
fishing. Now God will use our past experience to teach us, but
He always lead us forward, never backward. When fear and
uncertainty make us want to go back to the security of what
we know, we end up like the disciples, they went out and got
into the boat, that night they caught nothing (John 21:3). But
there is a good news. If God called you, you are still called.
Notice how Jesus Christ addresses them *"children have you
any food?"* (John 21:5). In spite of your lackluster performance,
you are still his child! Next, He tells them, *"throw your net on
the right side of the boat"*. When they did, they unable to haul
the net in because of the large number of fish, then the disciple
whom Jesus loved said to Peter *"it is the Lord!"* (John 21:7).
That morning Jesus Christ eat breakfast with them, renewed
fellowship, remove their doubts and sent them out to change
the world. What is the lesson here? When we work outside
God's will, it is like fishing on the wrong side of the boat, we
wear ourselves out and in the end have nothing to show for
our efforts. Are you succeeding in life? No? Maybe you are
fishing on the wrong side of the boat. Things aren't going to
work out right until you submit to Christ, renew your

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

fellowship with Him and allow Him to direct your steps. Base your life decision on priorities. And if you need help figuring out what they are, ask God. For the Lord gives wisdom, from His mouth come knowledge and understanding. No matter how difficult the puzzle, the solution is in Jesus Christ.

Life is a Puzzle ... Solve It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Sanity is that healthy state of mind when the activities of the conscious and subconscious are in proper balances.
... *Unknown.*
2. If you want to know what God wants you to do ask Him, and He will gladly tell you for He is always ready to give a bountiful supply of wisdom to all who ask him, he will not resent it. But when you ask Him, be sure that you really expect Him to tell you, for a doubtful mind will be as unsettled as a wave of the sea that is driven and tossed by the wind.
... *James 1:5-6*
3. Persistent people begin their success where others end in failure.
... *Edward Eggleston.*
4. A genius is a person who has encroached into the boundary of impossibility, making it possible, one who took failure and turned it into success.
... *Unknown.*

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

5. As a rule, he who has the most information will have the greatest success in life.
... Unknown.
6. Don't fear failure so much that you refuse to try new things. The saddest summary of a life contains three descriptions; could have, might have and should have.
... Louis Boone.
7. Failure is a trickster with a keen sense of irony and cunning, it takes great delight in the tripping one when success is almost within reach.
... Unknown.
8. If we just give the little that we have, we can trust him to make it go round.
... Gloria Gaither.
9. Certain things catch your eyes, but pursue only those things that capture your heart.
... Unknown.
10. One of the main weakness of mankind is the average man's familiarity with the word "Impossible", he knows all the rules which will not work and all the things which cannot be done.
...Unknown.
11. Today's accomplishments were yesterday's impossibility.
... Robert Schuller.

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

12. Men are anxious to improve their circumstances but they are unwilling to improve themselves, they therefore remain bound.

...*James Allen.*

13. There is guidance for each of us, and by lowly listening we shall hear the right words.

...*Unknown.*

14. Man lives to think, man thinks to live.

...*Unknown.*

15. A human body is alive only as long as its subconscious mind functions.

...*Unknown.*

16. God will always give us the ability to create what we need from something that is already here.

... *John Mason.*

17. Give us a clear vision that we may know where to stand and what to stand for, because unless we stand for something, we shall fall for anything.

... *Peter Marshall.*

18. The world does not pay men for that which they know, it pays them for what they do or induce others to do.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

19. One of the best uses of your time is to increase your competence in your key result area.

... *Brian Tracy.*

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

20. One half of life is luck, the other half is discipline and that is the important half, for without discipline you wouldn't know what to do with luck.

... *Carl Zuckmeyer.*

21. Never be afraid to trust an unknown future to an all-knowing God.

... *Corrie Ten Boom.*

22. At times it is only necessary to rest one's self in silence for a few minutes in order to take off the pressure and become wonderfully refreshed.

... *Dresser.*

23. Cast all your cares on the Lord and He will sustain you.

... *Psalms 55:22.*

24. It is such a comfort to drop the tangles of life into God's hands and leave them there.

... *L. B. Cowman.*

25. Night by night I will lie down and sleep in the thought of God.

... *William Mountford.*

26. Find rest, O my soul, in God alone, my hope comes from Him.

... *Psalms 62:5*

27. God has a thousand ways where I can see not one, when all my means have reached their end, then his have just begun.

... *Esther Guyot.*

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

28. We encounter God in the ordinances of life, not in the search for spiritual highs and extraordinary mystical experiences, but in our simple presence in life.

... *Brennam Manning.*

29. The natural and the visible is more appealing to the eyes than that which is eternal and invisible.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

LIFE IS A PUZZLE ... SOLVE IT!

18

LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

"Runners take your marks" the starter barks his signal, and the crowd turns quite attention to the athletes working towards the line, "get set" ... in position now, muscles tense, nervously anticipating the sound of the gun. It resounds!

And the race begins. In any contest, the start is important, but the finish is even more crucial. Often a front runner will lose strength and fade to the middle of the park. And there is the tragedy of the brilliant beginner who set the pace for a time, but does not even finish. He quit the race burned out, exhausted, or injured.

We are number one! The greatest, strongest, prettiest, champions! Daily, such proclamations bodily assert claims of supremacy. Everyone wants to be associated with a winner, losers are those who finish less than first. In direct contrast are the words of Jesus Christ. And whoever wants to be first must be slaves of everyone else, even. the son man came here not to be served but to serve others, and give His life as a ransom for many (Mark 10:44-45) Jesus Christ is the greatest- God incarnated, our Messiah - but He entered history as a servant. Prophet Elisha, God's servant and the woman who refused to give up (2 King 4). The bible spoke of a great woman who lived in Shunem. God gave her a son when she couldn't have one. Then suddenly in his twenties he dies. So the mother picks him up, put him on a horse and carries him back to Elisha, who God

LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

has used to announce his birth in the first place. Imagine what her neighbours must thought as she passed by. **"It is over"**, bury him! But not her, she refused to stop and get the opinion of faithless people, or discuss her situation with those who were unqualified to help.

Be careful who you open up to in crises! Make sure they know God and that their words line up with His. The warrantee hasn't expired on the promises God gave you. This woman believed that if God started it, He could finish, if He made it, He could fix it. And that is how her story end! Elisha stretches his body out on top of the dead boy's corpse and his corpse gets warm. Now that's good, but this lad needs more than just warmth, he needs new life. So Elisha stretches out on top of the boy's body again, this time the boy sneezes seven times and comes to life.

What is the lesson here for you? No matter how bad things look stay on top of the situation! Keep believing God. Your dream may not be fully alive yet, but it is getting warm. Things are improving, God is moving, your answer is on the way, don't give up till it arrives. Everything God has for you hasn't come yet, so you don't give up, you can't give up or walk away and say, that is all there is. No! God's got some stuff planted that you haven't seen or experienced you are still becoming what He planted, knowing that reinforces your faith that it will happen. It also means God believes in you, even when you don't believe in yourself. The bible says; Elisha went to Shunem, where there was a notable woman, and she persuaded him to eat some food. So it was, as often as he passed by, he would turn in there to eat some food. And she said to her husband *"Let us make him a small upper room, and*

LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

let us put a bed for him there, and a table, and a chair and a lamp."

Observe:

1. Whatever you need more of, make room for it. You don't get what you want in life; you get what you prepare for. This woman's generosity towards Elisha resulted in her having a child even when she wasn't able to, and her child being raised from the dead when sickness claimed him. When you make room for God in your life, you make room for the blessing that comes with Him.
2. **Notice the four things she put in the prophet's room:**
 - (1) A bed; There are times when you must run the race and there are times when you must rest. Indeed, if you don't learn to slow down, you will break down.
 - (2) A table; you need spiritual food to nourish your soul. If you plan to keep giving out, you must keep taking in.
 - (3) A chair; this speaks of study. "*Study to show thyself approved unto God, a workman that needed not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth*". (2 Tim. 2:15).
 - (4) A lamp; a place of illumination. Even after you have studied long and hard, you need the Holy Spirit to reveal the truth to your heart. And that's how to run the race of life without giving up.

Life is a Race ... Don't give up!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. The start and the end of a marathon are much more thrilling than the miles in between, it takes stubborn determination to keep going.

... Eckobig Anthony.

LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

2. The man who wins may have been counted out several times, but he refused to hear the referee. Nobody can keep you down unless you decide not to rise again. The secret of success is to start from the scratch and keep scratching.
... Unknown.
 3. It is not the man with motive but the man with purpose that prevails.
...Unknown.
 4. Faith enables us to be persuaded of his promises and to embrace them regardless of the trials and difficulties.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 5. The life of faith is never easy. But God can overrule all opposition to his service. When we face opposition, we must not falter or withdraw, but be active and patient.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 6. Faith doesn't demand details, it just keeps moving obediently forward, believing God for the right result.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 7. Perseverance means; succeeding because you're determined to, not because you are entitled to.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 8. In every race perseverance is needed to win the prize .
... Eckobig Anthony.
 9. In life, perseverance turns adversity into advancement.
... Eckobig Anthony.
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LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

10. Perseverance doesn't demand more than we have, but all that we have.

... Eckobig Anthony.

11. In triumph, there is a lot of try.

... Author Frank Tyger.

12. We count them blessed who endure.

... James 5:11

13. Resilient people are like a twig with a fresh, green, living Core. When twisted out of shape the twig bends but it doesn't break, instead it springs back and continues growing.

... Prof. George Vaillant.

14. We must not become dry, brittle and inflexible. We must draw on God's grace and endeavor to bounce back no matter how we feel.

... Unknown.

15. Persistence is stubborn with a purpose.

... Rich Denise.

16. Champions aren't made in the gyms; they are made from something they have deep inside them, a desire, a dream, a vision.

... Mohammed Ali.

17. When you get into a tight place and everything goes against you, till it seems as though you couldn't hang on a minute longer, never give up then, for that is just the place and time that the tide will turn.

...Unknown.

LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

18. Having a rough day? Place your hand over your heart. Feel that? That is called purpose. You're living for a reason. Don't give up.

...Unknown.

19. God hasn't forgotten about you. He's just hiding you as He prepares you. The only reason God is taking so long with you is because He has something absolutely extraordinary, unique, and amazing for you! ... Don't give up now.

... Jerry John Rawlings.

20. Keep trying, keep learning, and keep moving forward, onward and upward, success is near.

... Eckobig Anthony.

21. People who succeed see what others don't. It is what keeps them moving forward.

... Eckobig Anthony.

22. Effort only releases its reward after a person refuses to quit.

... Eckobig Anthony.

23. The quality of your preparation determines the quality of your performance.

... Eckobig Anthony.

24. World champions' boxers don't become champion in the ring; they are merely recognized in the ring. Their becoming is as a result of their daily routine.

... Unknown.

LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

25. Except you are captured and captivated by Jesus Christ you cannot go far with the things that are eternal. You keep falling and rising.

... *Gbile Akanni.*

LIFE IS A RACE ... DON'T GIVE UP!

19

LIFE IS A SONG ... SING IT!

Deliverance is when God brings you out of a fiery trial that was meant to destroy you. Total deliverance is when, like the three Hebrew children, He brings you out without even the smell of smoke on you. (*Daniel 3:27*). You see, is possible to be delivered but still be damaged, you can hear it in what a person says. They speak only of the past because they stopped living at a certain point. They survived the trauma, because they haven't dealt with it the right way they constantly refer back to it. When they talk, part of them is still in the fire, now we are not talking "**quick fix**" or "**a one size fits all**" form of healing. Your temperament, your faith level, and the depth of your pain at the time are all determining factors in how long it takes to recover and become whole. But this much is clear. Whatever was binding the three Hebrew children when they went into the fiery furnace, wasn't binding them when they came out of it. And that's what God wants to do for you too. Does that mean you are not supposed to talk about what you have been through? No, but don't talk like a victim, talk like a victor!

Instead of saying we have never done it before, say we have the opportunity to be first, instead of saying we don't have the resources, say necessity fuels inventions, instead of saying there is not enough time, say we will change how we work, instead of saying we have already tried that, say we learn from experience, instead of saying we don't have the expertise, say

LIFE IS A SONG ... SING IT!

let's network with those who do, instead of saying our vendors and customers won't go for it, say let's show them the opportunities, instead of saying we don't have enough money, say maybe there is something we can cut, instead of saying we are understaffed, say we are lean, hungry team, instead of saying it will never get any better, say we will try one more time, instead of saying let somebody deal with it, say I am ready to learn something new, instead of saying it is my job, say I will be glad to take responsibility. Instead of saying, I can't, say by God's grace I can, such tenacity only come from right thinking, spirit of gratitude, and it is the hallmark of all successful people, those who haven't learnt new songs in their days of trial and tribulation, they keep trying, keep believing, keep trusting, keep learning, keep being and confessing positive and keep moving forward, singing new songs of victories. They win the battle in their mind and then overflow into songs that they can sing. David said, "*He brought me up out of a horrible pit (the past) and set my feet upon the rock (the present) He has put a new song in my mouth, praise to our God, many will see it and fear, and will trust the Lord (the future)*" (Psalms 40:2-3).

Waiting for God to help us is not easy, but David receives four benefits from waiting:

1. God lifted him up from his despair.
2. God set his feet on the solid ground
3. God steadied him as he walked.
4. God put a new song of praise in his mouth.

Often blessings cannot be received unless we go through the trial of waiting. It is in time of waiting that our heart composes songs of victories; hence He has given me a new song to sing. Your experience may be old, but your song will be new.

Life is a Song ... Sing It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. You have a unique message to deliver, a unique song to sing, a unique act of love to bestow. This message, this song, and this act of love has been entrusted exclusively to the one and only you.

... John Powell S. J.

2. It is impossible to overemphasize the immense need men have to be really listened to.

... Paul Tournier.

3. Your days at the most cannot be very long, so use them to the best of your ability for the glory of God and the benefit of your generation.

... William Booth.

4. What comes out of you when you are squeezed is what's inside of you

... Wayne Dyer.

5. Success comes to those who become success conscious, failure to those who indifferently allow themselves become failure conscious.

... Unknown.

6. What I do best is share my enthusiasm.

... Bill Gate.

7. If it is true that there is always more than one way for of construing a text, then it is true that all interpretations are equal.

... Paul Ricouer.

LIFE IS A SONG ... SING IT!

8. There is a real magic in enthusiasm, it spells the difference between mediocrity and accomplishment.
... Norman Vicent Pearle.
 9. A salesman minus enthusiasm is just a clerk.
... Harry Banks.
 10. I am not what I ought to be, I am not what I want to be, I am not what I hope to be, but still I am not what I used to be. And by the grace of God, I am what I am.
... John Newton.
 11. The tongue of a man is here described as a pen! It can write or rewrite your destiny.
... Psalm 41:5
 12. Words have no wings but they can fly many thousand miles.
... Korean Proverbs.
 13. Words are weapons and it is dangerous to borrow them from the arsenal of the enemy.
... George Santayana.
 14. Those who wish to sing will always find a song.
... Swedish proverbs.
 15. The man who has something to live for lives longer.
...Unknown.
 16. Half of the world is composed of people who have something to say and can't, and the other half who have nothing to say and keep on saying it.
... Robert Frost.
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LIFE IS A SONG ... SING IT!

17. That which you share will multiple and that which you withhold will diminish.

... *Unknown.*

18. Whenever you do a thing, act as if all the world is watching .

... *Thomas Jefferson.*

19. A seasoning has not value if it has no flavor.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

20. Hope is the thing with feathers that perches in the soul and sings the tune - without the words and never stops at all.

... *Emily Dickson.*

21. The ordinary acts we practice everyday at home are of more importance to the soul than their simplicity might suggest.

... *Thomas Moore.*

22. A friend is the one who joyfully sings with you when you are on the mountain top and silently walks beside you through the valley.

... *William A. Ward.*

23. A bird doesn't sing because it has an answer, it sings because it has a song.

... *Barbara Johnson.*

24. Use what talents you possess, the woods would be very silent if no birds sang there except those that sang best.

... *Henry Van Dyke.*

LIFE IS A SONG ... SING IT!

25. For you make me glad by your deeds oh Lord. I sing for joy at the works of your hands.

... *Psalm 92:4.*

26. From the heart of God comes the strongest rhythm - the rhythm of love, without his love reverberating in us, whatever we do will come across like a noisy gong or a clanging cymbal. And so the work of the human heart, it seems to me, is to listen for that music and pick up on its rhythms.

... *Ken Gire.*

27. Centuries have rolled by and still the world longs for, looks for the peace the angels sang about on the first Christmas morning. "Where is His peace"? You ask. I will tell you where it is. It abides in the hearts of all who have trusted His grace.

... *Billy Graham.*

28. You are what you listen to.

... *Unknown.*

29. Do more of what makes you awesome but positive.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

20

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

Sin runs rampant in society - daily headlines and overflowing prison bears dramatic witness to that fact. With child abuse, pornography, serial killings, terrorism, anarchy and ruthless dictatorships, the world seems to be filled to overflowing with violence, hatred and corruption. Reading and hearing about the tragedies - and perhaps even experiencing them - we begin to understand the necessity of God's Judgement. We may even find ourselves wishing for vengeance by any means upon the violence perpetrators. Surely, they are beyond redemption: - But suppose in the midst of such thought, God told you to take the gospel to the worst of the offenders - how would you respond, rather than running away from God, trust him with your past, present and future saying no to God quickly lead to their disaster. Saying yes brings you understanding of God and His purpose in the world.

There are two things you can count on as you walk with God:

1. Tribulation that works for you, and grace that enables you to stand why you are going through it. Have you been praying for patience? Get ready for tribulation, there is no other way to get it. Patience only grows in the soil of adversity. The truth is, some of the people you can't stand right now are the very ones who will mature you spiritually and get you to your destiny. God said, Moab is my wash basin, (*Psalms 60:8*) the Moabites where

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

Israel's troublesome next - door neighbours who drove them crazy. But such people can only drive us closer to God. So who is your wash basin? Who brings out the worst in you? Who develops your character? Sometime a foe can press you into victory where a friend cannot. Who would have ever heard of David, without Goliath? Who would have ever known about Moses, if there had been no pharaoh oppressing God's people? And what about Esther, without Hamman's evil plot against the Jews. The problem is, we pray for certain things but God has a process, only as we, get to know him better do we begin to recognise it.

Here is how it works;

- (1) You ask God for strength and He allows you to go through struggles that develop you.
- (2) You ask Him for wisdom and you get to deal with messy situations that have no easy solutions.
- (3) You ask Him for success and He gives you the ability to work and wisdom to produce.
- (4) You ask Him for favour and you get responsibility, then you want to run from it.

There is a struggle going on in you right now, you may not be fully aware of it, but without it you will never be qualified to handle what God has in mind.

What is your life struggle? As you want to achieve your destiny, is there an enemy standing between you and its fulfilment, fight it. Dare to confront them, and they will become instruments in God's hand to press you into your destiny. When the oppositions are arrayed against you like sand on the sea shore, it is often the time when you lose the

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

most support. Don't worry, God is at work. Gideon took the troops down to the stream, three hundred lapped from their cupped hands, the rest knelt to drink. The Lord said "*I will use three hundred to give median into your hands*". (Judges 7:5-7). What looked like a setback was actually a setup from God to determine who was dependable.

We learn two lessons from this story;

- (1) You need to see your enemies approaching. Those who knelt to drink, sacrificed their vision to meet their immediate need.
- (2) When God reduces your support, it is to give you a miraculous victory. It is to show how somebody without formal credentials can run a company, or somebody who has lost everything can make a comeback.

So when the people around you can't pass God's water test, let them go and trust God, He has something better in mind.

Ever watch a food commercial on television and suddenly feel hungry? That is the power of suggestion, whatever can grab your attention can capture you. Simply repeating, I must stop drinking, or smoking, or over eating, or lusting, doesn't work because it just keep you thinking about what you don't want. Instead of trying to remove those thought, replace them. Once your focus is on good, evil begins to lose its grip (Prov. 4:23).

Only by programming your mind can you keep centered on the right things. The bible says: "*don't let evil get the upper hand but conquer evil by doing good*" (Rom. 12:21).

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

Satan can't get and keep your attention when your mind is given to something else. That is why Paul writes: *"Finally, brothers and sisters, whatever is true, whatever is noble, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable - if anything is excellent or praiseworthy- think about such things"* (Phil. 4:8). Fighting a thought is futile, it only strengthens the connection between you and it. By dwelling on it you actually reinforced it. Hit the remote; change the channel! Furthermore, you don't overcome temptation by fighting the feeling of it. The more you fight a feeling, the more it engages and draws you. Turn your attention to something better! Your mind is where the battle is won or lost. Stop managing your mind and monitoring your media intake. The bible says *"your life is shaped by your thoughts"*.

The psalmist prayed; *"Turn my eye away from worthily things; preserve my life according to your words"* (Ps. 119:37). Is this easy to do? No! It takes discipline and practice. But with time and God's grace, you can change the way you think and overcome temptation.

No matter how spiritually mature you become, you will never outgrow temptation. When you conquer it on one front it attacks you on another. And the closer you get to God the more Satan will try to tempt you. Paul explains it this way: the sinful nature wants to do evil, which is just the opposite of what the spirit wants. These two forces are constantly fighting each other. (Galatians 5:17). So, what is the answer?

Here are two ways you can overcome temptations;

1. First, be honest about it. Ask yourself, when am I tempted most? Usually, we are most vulnerable when we are under stress, when we are hurt, angry, worried, alone, alone, bored; tired or after a big success or spiritually
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LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

height. Learn to identify your patterns. God's people protect themselves by watching where they go. (Prov.16:17).

2. Second, reach for Gods help; *"call on me in time of trouble and I will answer you"* (Ps. 50:15). So why don't we call on God more often? Because sometimes we just want to do what we want to do, right? Or we are embarrassed because we keep giving into the same temptations.

Don't be discouraged, God won't give up on you. His word says let us come before God's throne where we will receive grace to help us when we need it. (Heb. 4:16). If you have to cry out for Gods help every hour of the day, he will be there for you! Just as the root of a tree deepens when storm comes, each time you stand up to a temptation you become stronger.

Life is a Struggle Overcome It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. Greatness comes when you take some knocks, some disappointments, when sadness comes, because only if you've been in the deepest valley can you ever know how magnificent it is to be on the mountain top.
... Richard Nixon.
2. The turning point in the lives of those who succeed usually comes at the moment of some crisis, through which they are introduced to themself.
... John Bunyan.

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

3. You can measure a man by the number of oppositions it takes to discourage him.
... Robert Savage.
4. We must accept finite disappointment, but we must not loose infinite hope.
... Martin Luther King Jr.
5. One willing man is more than a million wining men.
... Unknown
6. It's better to conquer yourself than to win a thousand battles, for then the victory is yours.
... Unknown.
7. Remember that all those who succeed in life take off a bad start, and pass through many heart-breaking struggles before they arrived.
... Unknown.
8. Never become a spectator in the grand stand of life, instead risk the arena of conflict to wear the crown of victory.
... Unknown.
9. In life, your biggest struggle will be your biggest victory if you hold on and do not give up.
... Eckobig Anthony.
10. No one is ready for a thing until he believes he can acquire it.
... Unknown.

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

11. In life what counts is not necessarily the size of the dog in the fight, but the size of the fight in the dog.
... Unknown
12. People with dreams are never enslaved by economic or social limitations; instead they shine through adversity to create new records.
... Unknown.
13. A person who doubts himself is like a man who enlists in the ranks of his enemy and bears arms against himself.
... Alexander Dumes.
14. When they say it can't be done, find a way to do it right, never wait for things to happen, find a way to make it happen.
... Eckobig Anthony
15. There are no limitations to the mind except those we acknowledge.
... Unknown.
16. Mediocrity is living below our known true potentials.
... Myles Munroe.
17. Unbelief ever hinders the display of divine power and goodness, God will not show Himself if our unbelief fills the field of vision.
...Eckobig Anthony.
18. Both poverty and riches are the offspring of our thought.
... Unknown

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

19. It is essential for you to encourage the positive emotions as dominating forces of your mind and discourage, eliminate negative emotions.

... *Unknown*

20. Trials and struggles are great opportunity to learn and shape our destiny.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

21. Our attitude in the time of troubles determines our attitude in life.

... *Unknown.*

22. God hears simple prayers just as clearly as He does more carefully composed ones. "God have mercy on me" or even "help" are delight to His ears. He not only hears but responds, in the chaos He whispers, "I am with you."

... *Anonymous.*

23. Always allow the dominating force of your faith to be higher than the pressure of giving up.

... *Eckobig Anthony*

24. The enemy knows your vulnerabilities and he'll push you to your limits. When he does, remember "Blessed is the man who endures, when he has been approved, he will receive the crown".

... *James 1:2*

25. Hope means to keep living, amid desperation and to keep humming in the darkness.

... *Henri J. M. Nouwen*

LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

26. When you have laboriously accomplished your daily task, go to sleep in peace. God is awake.
... *Victor Hugo*
27. Worrying is stupid. It is like walking around with an umbrella waiting for it to rain.
... *Unknown*
28. The greater the obstacle, the more glory in overcoming it.
.... *Eckobig Anthony*
29. The poverty and struggles you have known is only because you have not let go the glory of this world.
... *Gbile Akanni*
30. In life, the solution is not to avoid trouble, but to change the way we see it.
... *Eckobig Anthony*
31. When we trust God completely to take care of us, we will find that our other fears, even of death itself, will subside.
... *Eckobig Anthony*
32. The glory of this world is always insisting that you can't get it except you fall down and worship the god of this world.
... *Gbile Akanni*
33. God places no greater burden on our shoulders than they can carry.
... *Ven. Okey Ifionu*
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LIFE IS A STRUGGLE ... OVERCOME IT!

21

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

Famous last words" is more than a cliché. When notable men and women of influence are about to die, the world waits to hear about their final words of insights and wisdom. Then those quotes are repeated worldwide. This is also true with a dying loved one. Gather at his or her side, the family strains to hear every whispered syllable of blessing, encouragement and advice, knowing that will be the final message. One of the most knowledgeable, influential and beloved men of history is the apostle Paul. And we have his famous last words. Paul was facing death, he was not dying for a disease in a sterile hospital with loved ones gathered nearby. He was very much alive, but his condition was terminal. Convicted as a follower of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, Paul sat in a cold Roman prison, cut off from the world, with just a visitor or two and his writing material is. Paul knew that he will soon be executed (2 Tim. 4:6). So he wrote his final thought to his "son" Timothy, passing to him the touch of leadership, reminding him of what was truly important, and encouraging him in the faith.

Imagine how Timothy must have read and reread every word; this was the last message from his beloved mentor, counsellor, and life coach Paul. We all have our battle grounds; in some cases they are the things we surrendered to years ago that now lurk in our innermost thoughts, that's why the scriptures warn, keep your heart with all diligence, for out of it springs out

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

issues of life (*Prov. 4:23*). Max Lucado writes; I am at a desk in a hotel room far from home. The voice that encourages are distant, the voice that entice are near. A placard on my nightstand invites me to my lounge "*to make new friends in a relaxing atmosphere*". Another one top of the TV promises late night movies that will make all my fantasies come true.

In the phonebook, several columns of escort services offer "*love away from home*" voices! Some for pleasure, some for power. The world hammers at your door, Jesus taps. The world promises fleshly pleasure, Jesus Christ promises us a quite dinner with Him; *I will come in and eat with him, and he with me*, (*Rev. 3:20*). Which voice will you obey? You ask, how should I handle tempting situations?

In two ways:

1. First, by filling your mind with the scripture so that your first response is always it is "**written**" (*Matt. 4:4*), (*Luke 4:4*).
2. Second, by keeping your eyes on Jesus Christ. (*Heb. 12:2*). Lesley Durkin writes, my father used to put a bit of meat on the floor near his dog and say, "No!" the dog never touched it. But he never looked at it either, because if he did the temptation to disobey would have been too great. He just kept looking at my father's face. Keep your eyes on Jesus Christ. Those who look at Him are radiant; their faces are never covered with shame (*Psalms 34:5*).

We all want the crown of life the Lord promises (*James 1:12*). But we don't want the problems and trials that develop strength of character in us (*Rom. 5:4*) but it can't be done. Here is what you learn in tough time;

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

1. **Enjoyment;** count it all joy when you fall into trials (*James 1:2*). It is when you pass God's test that He fills you with His joy. So pull some of the groans out of your prayers and throw in a few hallelujahs. Remember, pain is inevitable - misery is optional!
2. **Enlargement:** The psalmist wrote; *thou hast enlarged me when I was in distress (Ps. 4:1)*. Most of the things we know best, we learn the hard way. Our greatest progress comes from our greatest pain; hence God doesn't save us from it, but strengthens us in it.
3. **Endurance:** James writes, see how the farmer waits for the land to yield its valuable crops and how patient he is for the autumn and spring rains. You too, be patient and stand firm. (*James 5:7-8*). You can't shorten the season or hurry the harvest, so be patient. And pay attention, while you're waiting, God is working. Bruce Wilkinson says, test of faith and trial and hardship that invites you to surrender something of great value to God, even when you have right not to. We all have different stories from our life experiences, they are raw material and instruments designed by God to build life and shape the destiny of people around us and within the sphere of our influence. Our work should be to use the stories of our lives to encourage, admonish, counsel, chastise, reproof those God has brought our way, just like we practiced in FGBMFI (**Full Gospel Business Men Fellowship - International**). Using the stories of our lives to God's glory, until the new believers are able to make disciples of others. (*Ephesians 4:12-13*). Please look out for the story of Eckobig Anthony, read and be blessed.

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

In 2nd Timothy 2:3-7, Paul used comparisons with soldiers, athlete, and farmers who must discipline themselves and be willing to sacrifice to achieve the result they want.

Like soldiers, will have to give up worldly security and endure rigorous discipline.

Like athlete, we must train hard and follow the rules.
Like farmers, we must work extremely hard and be patient. But we keep going despite suffering because of the thought of victory, the vision of winning, and the hope of harvest.

We will see that our suffering is worthwhile when we achieve our goal of glorifying God, winning people for Christ and one day living eternally with Him.

Life is a Story ... Tell It!

Slum Boy To Global Star! (The story of ECKOBIG ANTHONY).

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. God does not waste our time, He will use our past and present so that we may serve him with our future.
.... Eckobig Anthony.
2. My friends have made the story of my life in a thousand ways, they have turned my limitations into beautiful privileges and enabled me to walk serene and happy.
... Helen Keller.

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

3. God give me the gift of faith to be renewed and shared with others each day. Teach me to live this moment only. Looking neither to the past with regret nor the future with apprehension. Let love be my aim and my life a prayer.
... Roseann Alexander-Isham.
 4. You are valuable just because you exist, not because of what you do or what you have done, but simply because you are.
... Max Lucado.
 5. All the absurd little meetings, decisions and skirmishes that go to make up our days. It all adds up to the very little, and yet all add up to very much. Our days are full of nonsense and yet not, because it is precisely into the nonsense of our days that God speaks to us words of great significance.
... Frederick Buechner.
 6. Grace comes free of charge to people who do not deserve it and I am one of those people ... Now I am trying in my own small way to pipe the tune of grace. I do so because I know, more surely than I know anything, that any pang of healing I have ever felt comes solely from the grace of God.
... Philip Yancy.
 7. Grace tells us that we are accepted just as we are. We may not be the kind of people we want to be, we may be a long way from our goals, we may have more failures than achievements, we may not be wealthy or powerful or spiritual, we may not even be happy, but nonetheless we are accepted by God, held in His hands.
... Mc Collough.
-

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

8. There isn't enough darkness in the world to put out the light of one small candle. Any reminder of something deeply felt or dearly loved. No one is so poor as not to have many of these small candles. When they are lighted, darkness goes away and a touch of wonder remains.
... Arthur Gordon.
9. The secret of life is that all we have and are is a gift of grace to be shared.
... Lloyd John Ogilvie
10. If your gospel isn't touching others, it hasn't touched you.
... Curry R. Blake.
11. Your most precious valued possessions and your greatest powers are often necessarily invincible and intangible, no one can take them from you and you alone can share them, the more you share, the more you will have.
... Unknown.
12. Keep spreading rumours about your past because they hate to see how amazing you are now.
... Unknown.
13. Don't forget that kind words cost nothing and mean everything.
... Unknown.
14. Do more of what makes you awesome but positive.
... Eckobig Anthony

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

15. Some people are going to leave but that's not the end of your story. That is the end of their part in your story.
... *Unknown*.
16. Broken crayons still color.
... *Shelley Hitz*.
17. Always begin anew with the day, just as nature does. It is one of the sensible things that nature does.
... *George E. Woodbury*.

LIFE IS A STORY ... TELL IT!

22

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

Avase shatters, brushed by a careless elbow, buy a toys that breaks, handled roughly by young fingers, fabrics ribs pulled by strong and angry hands. Spills and rips take time to clean up, effort to repair and money to replace, but for more costly are shattered relationships, marriages. Unfaithfulness, untruth, hateful words and forsaken vows, all these tear apart delicate personal bonds and inflict wounds not easily healed.

Most tragic, however is a broken relationship with God. God loves perfectly and completely and His love is love of action - giving, guiding and guarding. He's all together faithful, truth to His promises to His chosen people. But consistently they spurn their loving God, breaking the covenant, following other gods and living for themselves. So, their relationship with God is shattered. But the breach is not irreparable, all hope is not lost. God can heal, mend and reweave the fabric. Forgiveness is available and that is grace. Heart - rending scenes of nature's devastation are hard to forget. Victims caught in the path of hurricane, floods and earthquakes are tossed around like matchsticks. But those prepared in advance escape destruction. There is no such thing as storm-free life! (*Proverb 10:25*). The word when (**not if**) a storm strikes, teaches us that we all go through times of heart ache and trouble. The question is; are you prepared? - You can be. God protect you in times of loss, sickness, divorce, unemployment, loneliness and

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

depression. You may not be able to predict life's storms or prevent them, but you can prepare for them and be protected in them by doing the following things:

- (1) **Locate your storm shelter:** Mid storm is no time to be caught in confusion, seeking refuge for yourself and your family. You must know in whom and where your protection lies. The bible says "*The name of the Lord is strong tower; the righteous runneth into it and is safe*". (Prov. 18:10). God's name speaks of His character, His reliability and His faithfulness. A man or woman without God is forced to be their own god, what a fearful thought! But those who love God can say, God is a safe' place to hide, ready to help when we need Him. We stand fearless, courageous in sea storm, and earthquakes, before the rush and roar of oceans, the tremors that shift mountains, (Psalm 46:1-3). The old Irish preacher had his own take on the hymn. He would say, on Christ the solid rock I stand - all other rocks are sham-rocks! Trust God, He is the only shelter you'll ever need.

To be prepared for life storm you must (Isa. 25:4);

- a. **Know your life storm manual:** The hymnist wrote: standing on the promises that cannot fail, when the howling storm of doubt and fear assail, standing on the living word I shall prevail, standing on the promises of God. Emotion-based faith is like a broken crutch, it won't support in life's storm. It's fair weather Christianity and it doesn't work. God's word stands sure; its greater than surrounding conditions and will enable you outlast any storm. Let the word of Christ dwell in you: richly (Colossian 3:16) keep a rich

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

deposit of scripture within you all times, so you can make a withdrawal when you need it. Withstanding life's storm depends on your willingness to hear these words and put them into practice (*Matthew 7:24*). So, memorise the scriptures, read them until, if you are cut, you bleed scriptures. Meditation on God's word until it fills and shapes your consciousness. When the storm came, Job said, "*I have treasured the word of His mouth more than my necessary food*" (*Job 23:12*).

- b. **Storm-proof yourself through prayer:** Many of us treat prayer like a visit to the emergency room; until then we neglect it. Imagine where Daniel would have been if he had held off praying until he was staring down the lions throat? That would not have been a smart move. Instead, in his time of crises, Daniel drew on faith built by a lifestyle of daily prayer. And in your time of crises, you too can make withdrawal from your account as long as you have been faithful to make regular deposits.

To prepare for life's storms, you must:

1. **Practice self-control:** Storms are much harder on the indisciplined and self-indulgent. The illusion that life should be easy, painless and air-cushioned ride, make you vulnerable to discouragement, disillusionment and defeat in hard times. The truth is, tough times don't last but tough people do! And tough people practice self-denial and self-control. It's their spiritual muscle for handling life's hardships. The bible says, the fruit of the spirit is self-control (*Galatians 5:22-23*). God's spirit will make you tough enough to control your greatest

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

weakness - yourself - the thing that ultimately defeat you in tough time. Paul lived by this example and principle. *"I disciplined my body and keep it under control". (1 Corinthian 9:27)* Great athletes know that it's their conditioning, not the conditions, that determine their victory.

2. **Depend on God, not people:** It better to trust in the Lord than to put confidence in man (*Psalms 118:8*). Yes, people can go so far, only God will go all the way with you. God gives you *"move grace"* when you walk through fiery trials. One bible teacher says, *"our perspective changes when we catch a glimpse of the purpose of Christ"*. Take that away, and it is nothing more than a bitter, terrible experience. Suffering comes in many forms, but His grace is always there to carry us beyond it. I've endured a sufficient number of trials to say without hesitation that only Christ's perspective can replace resentment with rejoicing. Jesus is the central piece of suffering's puzzle. If we fit Him into place, the rest begins to make sense. Donna Vanliere writes; *when life blindsides us and the diagnoses, abuses, foreclosures, broken marriage, death or financial collapse bring us to our knees, grace says there is more love after infidelity, more joy after the diagnoses, and more life after financial ruin, grace is real, an indomitable gift with power to change your life. But it comes with one condition, like any gift, you have to reach out and take it.*

Overcoming obstacles, challenges and tragedies is what develops in us the qualities needed to fulfil God's will for our lives. The truth is it can't happen any other way. **In 2 Cor. 1:3-10**, Paul spells out the benefits of going through hard times, heart breaking moments, difficulties, natural disasters, even

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

loss of loved ones. Yes there are actually benefits! Let's take a moment and look at some of them.

1. So that we will be able to comfort those who are in any affliction (**2 Cor. 1:4**): When people know you are qualified to speak, especially from personal life experience on how you encountered some challenges and tragedies of life and overcome, they listen. Otherwise they politely turn you out. Building into every problems that forces you to grow are the answers those around you need. When you can say, I have seen it all, I have been there, I have experienced it, people respect you and pay attention. Experience is one of your greatest assets and God will use it.
2. **That we should not trust in ourselves, (2 Cor. 1:9):** Anything that causes us to turn to God and lean harder on Him is an assets, not a liability. It is when we lose a job, marriage, a loved one, our health or peace of mind that we turn to God and discover what he can do.
3. **That thank may be given (2 Cor. 1:11):** Do you remember what your life was before you met the Lord? The psalmist wrote, *"He brought me up out of a horrible pit, out of the miry clay, and set my feet upon a rock. (Psalm 40:2)* come on! Lift up your voice and begin to praise God for all that he has done for you, after all, where would you have been without him? It doesn't bear thinking about, does it?

Life is a tragedy, never face it without God.

Life is a Tragedy ... Face It!

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

QUOTES FOR ACTIONS

1. Ignorance is always afraid of change.
... Jawaharlal Nehru
 2. Beware of false knowledge, it is more dangerous than ignorance.
... George Bernard Shaw
 3. The soul would have no rainbow had the eyes no tears.
... Unknown
 4. We cannot tell what may happen to you in the strange medley of life, but we can decide what happens to us, how we can take it, what we do with it, and that is really what counts in the end.
... Joseph F. Newton.
 5. You either ride life or it rides you, your mental attitude determines who is the rider or the horse.
... Napoleon Hill.
 6. Our tears can be seeds that will grow into a harvest of joy because God is able to bring good out of tragedies.
... Eckobig Anthony
 7. History has demonstrated that the most notable winners usually encountered heart breaking obstacles before they triumphed.
... T. S. Elliot
 8. The bitterest tears shed over graves are for words left-unsaid and deeds left undone.
... Harriet Stone
-

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

9. Many a man has finally succeeded only because he has failed after repeated efforts, if he had never met defeat, he would, never know great victory.
... Orison Swett Marden.
 10. If we put God aside for anything, even education, family, career or pleasure, we are abandoning Him in the same way.
... Eckobig Anthony.
 11. People with dreams are never enslaved by economic or social limitations. Instead, they shine through adversity and create new records.
... Unknown
 12. Difficulties mastered are opportunities won.
... Unknown.
 13. Adversity reminds us that life is short, teaches us to live wisely and refines our character
... Eckobig Anthony
 14. If you see zero, you will see nothing but look through it you will see the world
... Robert Kaplan
 15. God allows both adversity and prosperity to come to all, He blends them in our lives in such a way that we can't predict the future or count on human power.
... Unknown.
 16. Remember the tragedy of life is not that it ends soon, but that we wait so long for it.
... Unknown.
-

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

17. When life seems uncertain and uncontrollable, don't despair, for God is in control and will bring good result out of your struggles.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

18. You are the handicap you must face; you are the one who must choose your place.

...*James Allen.*

19. Do not look at the shape of your life and call it zero, for beyond it is a world of your own yet undiscovered.

... *Unknown.*

20. Those who sacrifice their families, reputation, health, everything for money are failures in life, regardless of how much money they may accumulate.

... *Eckobig Anthony.*

21. We realize our dilemma goes deeper than the shortage of time.

...*Charles Hummal*

22. There is no room for God in him who is full of himself.

... *Martin Buber.*

23. His grace is great enough to meet the great things - the crashing waves that overwhelm the soul, the roaring winds that leaves us stunned and breathless, the sudden storm beyond our life's control.

... *Annie Johnson Flint.*

24. The man full of himself can never proclaim the Christ who emptied himself.

... *Jacquelyn Heasley.*

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

25. God will never forsake those who trust in Him, to forsake someone is to abandon that person, God's promise does not mean that if we trust in Him we will escape loss or suffering; it means that God Himself will never leave us no matter what we face.
... *Eckobig Anthony*
26. A proud monk needs no demon; he turned into one, an enemy to himself
... *John Climacus*
27. Beware of endeavouring to become a great man in a hurry; one of such attempts in ten thousand may succeed.
... *Benjamin D' Israel.*
28. Never forget that circumstances are the rulers of the weak, but they are the weapons of the wise.
... *Unknown*
29. For certain is death for the born, and certain is birth for the death, therefore over the inevitable thou shouldest not grieve
...*Bhagavad Gita*
30. God washes the eyes by tears until they can behold the invisible land where tears shall come no more.
... *Henry Ward Beecher*
31. Give thanks in all circumstances, for this is the will of God for you in Christ Jesus.
... *1 Thess. 5:18.*

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

32. We can rejoice too when we run into problems and trials, for we know that they are good for us, they help us to learn to be patient. And patience develops strength of character in us and helps us trust God more each time we use it. Until finally our hope and faith are strong and steady.

... *Romans 5:3-4*

33. Face your deficiencies and acknowledge them, but don't let them master you. Let them teach you patience, sweetness, insights. When we do the best we can we never know what miracle is wrought in our life or in the life of another.

... *Helen Keller.*

34. Peace with God brings the peace of God. It is peace that settles our nerves, fills our mind, floods our spirit. And in the midst of the uproar around us, gives us the assurance that everything is all right.

... *Bob Mumford.*

35. Be careful how you treat people. The things you do have a funny way of coming back to you.

... *Unknown.*

36. Be careful who you trust, if someone will discuss others with you, they will discuss you with others.

... *Unknown.*

37. Life is thickly sown with thorns, and I know no other remedy than to pass quickly through them. The longer we dwell in our misfortunes the greater their power on us.

... *Voltaire*

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

38. It's equally unfaithfulness on your path to use your worldly wealth to enslave fellow citizens of heaven.
...*Gbile Akanni.*
39. Any life lived in this world that is not an investment for eternity, is a waste.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
40. Corruption in the world seems prevalent because the culprits are usually celebrated by our national televisions and newspapers rather than being incarcerated behind our prison bars.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
41. God's Kingdom principles; give freely and become wealthier, be stingy and lose everything.
... *Eckobig Anthony.*
42. Once a man steps into eternity, he cannot change his location, he cannot change his choice, he cannot change anything.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
43. If you enter into eternity with regret, you will forever live in regret. If you enter into eternity with a sense of unfinished assignment, you will forever keep living with that sense of unfinished assignment.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
44. Whatsoever I do at each point here on earth has an eternal consequence, it is only in eternity it will be played back. Each of my actions and choices here on earth will serve to either jeopardize or enhance my position in eternity.
... *Gbile Akanni*
-

LIFE IS A TRAGEDY ... FACE IT!

45. There's just a step between life and death. You need to pray not to step into eternity unprepared.
...*Gbile Akanni.*
46. The glory of the earth is exciting but it's superficial.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
47. The glory of the world puts more emphasis on appearance than the quality within. It is impressionable, beautiful but fluffy.
... *Gbile Akanni.*
48. Those who live for the world will pass away with the world. You become earthly if you only follow the earthly. Even if a preacher is excited about the glory of this world, he will also fade away with it.
... *Gbile Akanni*
49. The glory of the world is competitive and comparative, not necessarily absolute
... *Gbile Akanni*
50. In the world the durable are not attractive, but the dispensable are packaged with so much beauty that it overwhelmingly attracts the worldly.
... *Gbile Akanni*
51. This is the deception of earthly goods. It gives you a false confidence that you can make your way through anything once there is money.
...*Gbile Akanni.*

23

LIFE IS A QUESTION ... ANSWER IT!

From innocent childhood queries to complex university, life is filled with questions. Asking; **How? Why? and When?** we probe beneath the surface to find satisfying answers: But not all questions have answers wrapped and neatly tied. The unanswered interrogations create more questions and nagging, spirit-destroying doubts. Some choose to live with their doubt, ignoring them and moving on with life. Others become cynical and hardened. But many reject these options and continue to ask, looking for answer. Eckobig Anthony is a man who sought answers. Troubled by what he observed, he asked difficult questions. The question is not merely intellectual exercise or bitter complaints. He saw a dying world, and it broke his heart.

Why is there evil in the world? Why do the wicked seem to be winning? We should boldly and confidently take our complaint and questions directly to God (**Heb. 4:16**).

Asking is our approach to God, and answering is His response to us, and we are to come '**boldly**' and '**confidently**'. Some Christian, individuals approach God meekly with heads hung low, afraid to ask Him to meet their needs. Others pray flippantly, giving little thought to what they say, **Ask, seek and knock with boldness, and confidence, come with reverence because He is your king, counsellor, and friend.**

LIFE IS A QUESTION ... ANSWER IT!

Do you have a compulsive need to find a solution to every problem, and to control everything? Do you always have a back-up plan in case things don't go the way you think they should? Have you noticed that the more you try to fix things, the more anxiety you experience? The bible says "*the mind governed by flesh is death, but the mind governed by the spirit is life and peace*". (Rom. 8:6). Fixing is the opposite of 'trusting'. Now God does not want you to be mindless or helpless, He just wants you to live by faith and not head knowledge. When you learn to trust God and operate in the mind of the spirit, you experience peace even when you are surrounded by tough circumstances. One of the pitfalls of human reasoning's is that it causes you to become double minded and stuck.

A man of double minds is unstable and unreliable and uncertain about everything. What frame of mind do you live in? Instead of always trying to always figure everything out, learn to be comfortable not knowing and trust the one who does. Decide that each time you feel anxious you will stop and pray, *Lord I am not going to try to figure this out myself; I'm bringing it to you, trusting you for the answer*. When you stop struggling with the **when's, where's, why's and how's** you start experiencing God's peace in a way you never have before. You can also put yourself in a position where God can intervene on your behalf. So, stop trying control everything.

When someone comes to you with a personal problem, ask them the following question;

1. What do you think caused the problem?
2. What have you done about it?
3. What scriptures are you standing on?
4. What do you think I might be able to do, that you haven't already done?

LIFE IS A QUESTION ... ANSWER IT!

These questions will help you weed out those who genuinely want help, from those who want attention. Some people see prayer as a magic wand; they think you can wave it over them and their problem will not go away, they can go back to living their lives the way they please.

He's another situation: Someone may say "*the doctor had suggested surgery. What should I do*"? Unless you're a doctor, be careful what you advise? If God has spoken to someone and they have faith that He will heal them, don't throw cold water on them.

So what should you do? Jesus Christ said "*if two of you agree on earth concerning anything that they ask, it will be done for them by my Father in heaven*" (Matt. 8:19).

The real question is, are they standing on their faith or yours? You can teach people God's word, but you can't force them to come up to your level of faith until they are ready. Sometimes people may be ready and all they are seeking is confirmation. The bible says: "*you have an anointing from the Holy-one, and you know all things*" (1 John 2:20). But, unless God has let you know, you know nothing! And be careful what you advise.

Life is a Question Answer It!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. What we already know is in the past, what we have yet to discover is the future. Always make your questions bigger than your answers, and you'll keep drawing yourself into a bigger future with new possibilities.

... Gary Blair.

LIFE IS A QUESTION ... ANSWER IT!

2. Let my soul take refuge beneath the shadow of your wings. Let my heart, in this sea of restless wave, find peace in you Oh God.
... Austine
3. The fruit of placing all things in his hands is the presence of His abiding peace in our hearts.
... Hannah Whithall Smith.
4. When you are concerned about the future, talk with God who knows the generations of the future as well as the generations of the past.
...Unknown
5. He is right here, with an unyielding desire that is willing to trust, we may call out to our Heavenly Father and know that he will answer, filling our hearts with bright joy and freshness of life.
... Unknown.
6. I don't think there is anyone who needs God's help and grace as much as I do. Sometimes I feel so helpless and weak. I think that is why God uses me. Because I cannot depend on my own strength, I rely on Him twenty-four hours a day.
... Mother Theresa.
7. You can trust God right now to supply all your needs for today. And if your needs are more tomorrow, His supply will be greater also.
... Eckobig Anthony.

LIFE IS A QUESTION ... ANSWER IT!

8. A man may fulfill the object of His existence by asking a question he cannot answer, and attempting a task he cannot achieve.

... Oliver Wendell Holmes.

9. It is the simple truth that holds you together in the most complex situations. Not simplistic but simple. The profound truth that the bible gives us is like a warm blanket wrapped around us on a cold night.

... Charles R. Swindell

10. Always be in a state of expectancy and see that you leave room for God to come in as He likes.

.... Oswald Chambers.

LIFE IS A QUESTION ... ANSWER IT!

24

LIFE IS A WAR ... FIGHT IT!

An earthquake shakes the foundation of our security, a tornado blows away a lifetime of treasures, an assassin's bullet changes national history, a drunk driver claims an innocent victim, a divorce shatters a home, terrorism frightens a nation. International and personal tragedies make our world seem a fearful place, overflowing with evil and seemingly out of control. And the litany of bombings, coups, murders, and natural disasters could cause us think that God is absent or impotent.

"Where is God?"

We cry engulfed by sorrow and despair in the bible times when an attack was launched against a city, a first strategy was to bring in a battering ram, demolish the gates and defeat the inhabitants.

Today you are at war with Satan! Only when you recognize that, is victory possible. And the good news is "*the weapon we have to fight with have the power to demolish strongholds*". But you must put on the whole armour of God (Eph. 6:11). It's not something you pick up and wear when you feel like it. And you have got the power to keep it on, because the enemy never lets up, he wants you to think that he is equal with God.

He's not! God is omnipotent, omniscient, and omnipresent. He can do anything, anywhere, and anytime. No question, Satan

LIFE IS A WAR ... FIGHT IT!

is a formidable foe, but there are limits on what he's permitted to do (*Job 1:12*). Your mind is command central; it's where victory or defeat is decided. Paul told the Corinthians, I fear, lest your mind be corrupted (*2 Cor. 11:13*). Satan knows Christ return is imminent and he's racking up the opposition (*Rev. 12:12*). The way you win the war or you win the battle is through;

- (1) Praise, the garment that protects you (*Isa. 61:3*)
- (2) Abiding in Christ your source of spiritual growth and fruitfulness (*John 15:8-10*)
- (3) God's word is designed to defeat the enemy: When satan comes against you, combat his lies with what God says, *"His word is living, active, sharper than any two-edged sword" (Heb. 4:12).*
- (4) Walking in love towards others: It's impossible to be victorious when you are wrapped up in yourself. When the first bomb hit the world trade centre in September 2001, we thought it was accidental. When another plane hits it, we knew New York was under attack. Dr. Robert Jeffries says; *knowing the source of the problem is very crucial, a navigational accident demands ones response.*

A hostile strike requires a complete different strategy. Every of our world is invaded by what we consider random events, couples divorce, so we develop what we called **"Marriage guidance"**; drug use increases, so we **educate our children to just say no!**

Pornography among Christians rises, so we **organize accountability groups**; Churches threatens to split, so we **employ arbitrators to help with conflict resolution**; Christians battle depression and suicidal thoughts, so we **medicate them with the latest drugs.**

LIFE IS A WAR ... FIGHT IT!

Please understand I'm not against such programmes, but what if the source is more than random events and we are under enemy attack? Would we change our strategy? Through the scripture we discover that there is an unseen world and it is at war. Paul writes, *"our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against spiritual forces of the wickedness (Eph. 6:12).*

You can't just shrug your shoulder and say; the enemy's determined to destroy everything and everyone important to you. And those who dismiss such words as being over the top – do so to their own detriment. Martin Lloyd Jones said, *not realize you are in a conflict, means you are so hopelessly defeated and you don't even know it.*

We are in a very real war, the stakes are high, the enemy is skilled, armed and determined. The possibility of losing is real. But not possible, because I am not fighting for victory, I am fighting from victory via the excellent power that is in Jesus Christ alone. You must be aware of what's happening and be prepared to fight. Victory is assured.

Life is war ... Fight it!

QUOTES FOR ACTION

1. King David quoted Jesus Christ saying, *"I know the Lord is always with me, He is helping me. God's mighty power supports me. No wonder my whole heart is filled with joy and my tongue shouts His praises! For I know all will be well with me till death.*

... Acts 2:25-26

LIFE IS A WAR ... FIGHT IT!

2. Expect the dawn of a new beginning in the dark night of life.
... Lloyd Ogilvie
3. Hope is both the earliest and the most indispensable virtue inherent in the state of being alive. If life is to be sustained, hope must remain, even where confidence is wounded, and trust impaired.
... Erik Erikson
4. Never become a spectator in the grand stand of life, instead risk the arena of conflict to wear the crown of victory
... Unknown.
5. Battle are guns sent to fire you to the top, while your attitude is the bullet in the gun.
... Unknown.
6. In life what counts is not necessarily the size of the dog in the fight, but the size of the fight in the dog.
... Unknown.
7. Words are weapons and it is dangerous to borrow them from the arsenal of the enemy
... George' Santayana
8. I prefer freedom with war, rather than servitude with tranquility.
...Kwameh Nkrumah

LIFE IS A WAR ... FIGHT IT!

9. Viewing impossible situations from God's point of view helps us put giant problems in proper perspective. Once we see clearly, we can fight more effectively.
... Eckobig Anthony
10. No man is fit to command another that cannot command himself.
... William Penn
11. A made up mind attunes itself to tremendous extra power.
... Unknown
12. We overcome fear when we cry out to God for His protection in our darkest hour
... Eckobig Anthony.
13. When the chances of success appear slim remember that anyone can obey God when the task is, easy and everyone is behind it, only those with persistent faith can obey when the task seems impossible.
... Eckobig Anthony.
14. If you can keep your head while others are loosing theirs, then you are a man.
... Rudyard Kipling
15. We can trust God and act in spite of our fear.
... Eckobig Anthony.
16. One person's bold action can stem a tide of evil.
... Unknown.

LIFE IS A WAR ... FIGHT IT!

17. God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble. Therefore we will not fear. The Lord Almighty is with us.
... Psalm 46:1-2,7.
18. God often protects us by guiding us through circumstances, not by helping us escape them.
... Eckobig Anthony.
19. If the Lord be with us, we have no cause to fear. His eyes is upon us, His arm over us, His ears open to our prayers, His grace sufficient, His promise unchangeable.
... Andrew Murray.
20. We become captivated with fear when we see only frightening circumstances and crumbling foundations.
... Eckobig Anthony.
21. Faith in God keeps us from losing hope and helps us in resisting fear.
... Eckobig Anthony.
22. When we know that God is greater than anything our enemies could bring, against us, we become comforted and optimistic.
... Eckobig Anthony
23. Do not fear for I am with you, do not be dismayed for I am your God, I will strengthen you and help you. I will uphold you with my righteous right hand.
... Isaiah 41:10

LIFE IS A WAR ... FIGHT IT!

24. God stands fast as your rock, steadfast as your safe guard,
sleepless as your watcher, valiant as your champion.
... Charles Spurgeon.
25. The world is full of suffering; it is also full of overcoming
it.
... Helen Keller.
26. There is a silence into which the world cannot intrude.
There's an ancient peace you carry in your heart and have
not lost.
... Unknown.
27. We walk without fear, full of hope, courage and strength
to do His will, waiting for the endless good which He is
always giving as fast as He can get us able to take it in.
... George MacDonald.
28. Being strong doesn't always mean you have to fight the
battle. True strength is being adult enough to walk away
from the nonsense with your head held high.
... Unknown.
29. My tears may continue to fall, but my strength will
continue to rise.
...Unknown.